WEDNESDAY
October 14, 2026

DELHI
CITY EDITION
20 Pages ₹ 12.00

# THE HINDU

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INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Vol. 16 • No. 244
Regd. DL(ND)-11/6110/2006-07-08
RNI No. UPENG/2012/49940

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## IN BRIEF



### China, India spar over standardising names in Ladakh

**NEW DELHI/BEIJING**
India and China on Tuesday sparred over New Delhi's decision to standardise the names of 28 features in Ladakh, including some along the Line of Actual Control. » Page 12

### Punjab anti-drug activist's murder triggers outrage

**CHANDIGARH**
An anti-drug crusader was shot dead on Tuesday in Punjab's Mansa district, sparking widespread outrage in the poll-bound State. » Page 4

OPPORTUNITIES » PAGE 5

# Battle against 'vote theft' will go on, says Rahul after meeting allies

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha discusses future course of agitation against CEC and SIR over tea; representatives of political parties, civil society activists, and student leaders take part; political resistance will continue and triumph, he says

**Sandeep Phukan**
NEW DELHI



INDIA bloc members, student leaders, and activists with the Leaders of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha, Rahul Gandhi and Mallikarjun Kharge, after a meeting on Tuesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

There are no parallel protests, but only one movement to restore democracy, Rahul Gandhi, Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, said on Tuesday as he hosted Opposition politicians, civil society activists, and student leaders for tea to discuss the future course of the agitation demanding the suspension of the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and the removal of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

Sources told *The Hindu* that leaders of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) were not present at the meeting. Mr. Gandhi's office had tried reaching out to them through an intermediary, but it did not work out. The CJP had been among the groups that issued a call for Saturday's protest, provoking a harsh police crackdown.

Mr. Gandhi, who hosted the discussion a day after a march to the Supreme Court to file a petition to halt the SIR, made it clear that political resistance will continue, regardless of the court's response. "We have extreme respect for the Supreme Court, for the Chief Justice of India, for the judicial system. They have a role to play; we hope they will play that role but we are also political people. No matter what happens, no matter which institution plays a role or not, political resistance will continue, people's resistance will continue, and it will triumph," he said.

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MORE REPORTS ON » PAGES 5, 10, & 11

## Response to pleas needs 'fine-tuning', Centre tells SC

**Krishnadas Rajagopal**
NEW DELHI

The Centre informed the Supreme Court on Tuesday that its response to petitions alleging illegal detentions and shutdown in Delhi on October 10 is "ready" but needs more fine-tuning. The top court also agreed to urgently hear fresh petitions on the continued police action against journalists covering the SIR protests.

FULL REPORT ON » PAGE 10

## 13 children killed in Bihar boat capsize



First responders gather at a local hospital after a boat capsized in the Ganga in Vaishali district, Bihar, on Tuesday night. PTI

**Amit Bhelari**
PATNA

At least 13 children died after a boat capsized in the Ganga in the Raghopur area of Bihar's Vaishali district on Tuesday night.

According to local people, the boat was carrying about 20 passengers from one village to another for a feast. A team rushed to the spot and started rescue operations.

All the deceased children were below the age of 15, Vaishali District Magistrate Varsha Singh said.

"We received the information around 8.30 p.m. that a private boat carrying children overturned. Seven have been rescued and their condition is stable. Rescue operation will continue throughout the night. So far, 13 bodies have been recovered," she said. The SDRF team and divers are also on site.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 10



RESHUFFLE LIKELY
**Murugan exits Union Cabinet and Rajya Sabha**
NEWS » PAGE 12



CALL FOR COOPERATION
**BIMSTEC adopts 'Delhi Declaration' on terrorism**
NEWS » PAGE 12

## Muslims over-flagged in Delhi SIR, data show

**Pon Vasanth B.A.**
**Srinivasan Ramani**
CHENNAI

An analysis of Delhi's draft SIR rolls by *The Hindu* shows that the ECI's software-driven process flagged a disproportionately high number of Muslims for "logical discrepancies".

Muslims made up 13.6% of Delhi's 97.54 lakh draft-roll electors but 20.3% of the 19.33 lakh flagged for "logical discrepancies". In the five reasons for logical discrepancies that are linked to family size such as six or more children naming the same parent, or small age gaps between generations, Muslims were nearly three times as likely as others to be flagged. The logical discrepancies process was first introduced in West Bengal, without any formal announcement.

The ECI, which flags electors through its centralised ERONET software, has not explained the eight reasons behind "logical discrepancies".

FULL REPORT ON » PAGE 11




# Rollout of fee on UPI transactions put off beyond Deepavali on appeal by traders

**T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan**
NEW DELHI



Black ribbon seen across payment codes at a shop in Bhopal last week as traders protested the proposed fee for UPI transactions. ANI

The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has postponed the implementation of the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI transactions, originally scheduled for Thursday, to a date "immediately after Deepavali", without specifying an exact date.

The MDR was to be levied at 0.4% on UPI transactions exceeding ₹2,000 at medium and large merchant establishments. Transactions related to the capital market and those done in strategic sectors will face different MDR rates. According to government sources, the decision to delay the implementation of MDR on UPI was made in the Prime Minister's Office following strong appeals from traders.

The Confederation of All India Traders (CAIT) described the decision to delay the rollout as "timely and pragmatic", particularly during the festive and wedding season, when millions of traders and MSMEs depend on higher business volumes.

### Move welcomed

Praveen Khandelwal, founder and secretary-general of CAIT and a Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) MP, welcomed the decision to postpone the MDR roll-out, saying that it would protect traders' interests and sustain digital payment momentum during the festive season.

"The UPI and Services Steering Committee today decided that, keeping in mind the festive season, Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on select Person-to-Merchant (P2M) UPI transactions shall be implemented immediately post Deepavali at a date to be notified separately," read a statement issued by the NPCI on Tuesday.

The Supreme Court has directed the NPCI, the Union government, and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to file affidavits by late October explaining the rationale for imposing MDR on specified UPI transactions.

CAIT said the decision followed a meeting on September 30, when a delegation of around 20 trade leaders led by Mr. Khandelwal met Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and "highlighted the implications of the proposed 0.40% MDR on UPI transactions exceeding ₹2,000". "Additional transaction costs [during the festive season] could have placed an avoidable burden on merchants operating on thin margins and discouraged the wider acceptance of digital payments," it stated.

# Jantar Mantar denotified as protest site based on SC order: police to High Court

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI




**Stir continues:** Bhim Army members marching through Connaught Place on Tuesday; (right) protesters being pushed into a bus in central Delhi. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP/AFP

The Delhi police on Tuesday told the Delhi High Court that the decision to denotify Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site was taken based on the Supreme Court's directions.

Representing the police, Additional Solicitor General Chetan Sharma told Justice Amit Mahajan, who was hearing a plea by the Indian Youth Congress seeking permission to protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar at Jantar Mantar, that the "entire petition is about peaceful protest at Jantar Mantar. All other prayers flow from it. Today, we have denotified Jantar Mantar pursuant to orders of the Supreme Court". He added that a plea had been filed in the apex court challenging the denotification of Jantar Mantar as a protest site.

Sidharth Luthra, the counsel for the petitioner, said he would amend the plea in view of the development and urged the court to seek the police's stand on the other plea, which is against "automatic, mechanical, unguided or disproportionate prohibition of peaceful assembly".

It also challenges the requirement to apply for a protest at least 10 days before the proposed date.

Meanwhile, hundreds of protesters from several youth organisations staged demonstrations in Connaught Place against the decision to denotify Jantar Mantar as a protest site.

The outfits included Bhim Army, Revolutionary Workers' Party of India and Disha Students' Organisation (DSO).

**'Reclaim Jantar Mantar'**

Two other outfits – the Students' Federation of India and the Democratic Youth Federation of India – condemned the order in a joint statement, denouncing the "blow to democratic dissent and the constitutional right to peaceful assembly". They would mobilise the youth and democratic forces to "reclaim Jantar Mantar", it added.

"Jantar Mantar belongs to people. Denotifying it as a protest site would not stop the public from protesting there. The government wants to send protesters off to places such as Burari far away from Parliament," said Naureen from DSO. "It is time for all organisations to come together on the issue," said Chiranshu from Naujawan Bharat Sabha.

# Delhi gets 150 electric buses, 13 new air monitoring stations

Union Environment Minister, CM unveil new clean-air initiatives, review measures at Anand Vihar; Gupta says her govt. is addressing all aspects of pollution control, including transport, monitoring

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI



Union Minister Bhupender Yadav flagging off 150 new e-buses, along with CM Rekha Gupta and other dignitaries, on Tuesday. PTI

Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Bhupender Yadav, along with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, on Tuesday inaugurated 13 additional air quality monitoring stations and public EV charging stations at five locations, and flagged off 150 new electric buses.

Along with a team of officials, the Ministers also reviewed air pollution mitigation measures being undertaken at Anand Vihar, an air pollution hotspot, and visited an Integrated Command and Control Centre of the Delhi Pollution Control Committee.

An official statement issued by his Ministry quoted Mr. Yadav as saying that with the 13 new stations, the national capital now has 60 air quality monitoring stations at a density of one per 25 sq km.

It added that the network would be expanded to other cities in the National Capital Region (NCR). Mr. Yadav said the monitoring stations provide real-time air quality data through the Central Pollution Control Board server and the SAMEER mobile application.

The Chief Minister said the government is addressing all aspects of pollution control simultaneously, including transport, monitoring and infrastructure.

She also said tackling Delhi's pollution challenge requires a rapid shift towards electric public transport and stronger supporting infrastructure.

"The government aims to provide better transport facilities to Delhi residents and accelerate efforts to make the Capital cleaner and more sustainable. The addition of 150 electric buses and the launch of public EV charging stations at five locations – ISBT Anand Vihar, Nand Nagri depot, Rohini Sector-37 depot, Nangloi depot and Keshopur depot – mark significant progress in this direction," the Chief Minister added.

**Public transport boost**

The new buses are air-conditioned, low-floor vehicles equipped with CCTV cameras, panic buttons, real-time tracking and facilities for persons with disabilities. With the addition of 150 new electric buses, the number of electric buses in Delhi has gone up to 5,238.

The city's overall bus fleet comprises around 6,988 buses, including 1,750 that run on CNG.

The government aims to increase the fleet to around 14,000 buses by 2028-29.

Every winter, air pollution spikes in Delhi-NCR, mainly due to meteorological factors such as lower wind speeds and a drop in temperature. Stubble burning and bursting of firecrackers worsen air quality and add to the emissions from vehicles.

# After route diversions, commuters face reduced DTC services with hundreds of buses pulled for protest duty

**Shrimansi Kaushik**
NEW DELHI



Protest-related restrictions have disrupted traffic and affected bus services. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Commuters in Delhi are facing a twin challenge due to the protest-related restrictions: diversions that have disrupted vehicular movement and reduced Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) services, with hundreds of buses deployed for police duty.

**'600 buses taken off'**

The government has not shared details on how many buses have been withdrawn from regular routes for deployment with security agencies in central Delhi. However, the DTC Ekta Karamchari Union, which comprises contractual and outsourced employees of the public transporter, said at least 600 buses had been deployed to transport security personnel or detainees.

"The bus service has reduced over the past two days. The service is irregular anyway as buses either don't stop or are delayed. If this is due to the protests, then the DTC should have made separate arrangements for passengers," said Ram Gopal, who works at an establishment in Karol Bagh.

Route diversions near Jantar Mantar also caused problems for commuters.

Ankita, a third-year Delhi University student, said she had to walk to reach her destination at Patel Chowk after the DTC bus dropped her 2 kilometre away from the designated bus stop.

Since October 2, specific routes around Connaught Place, Patel Chowk and Janpath have been diverted owing to security restrictions.

The union president, Lalit Chaudhary, said, "Some routes around Jantar Mantar, Bangla Sahib Gurdwara, Patel Chowk, Sansad Marg and Janpath have been diverted. Buses from depots of Rani Khera and Dichaon Kalan in Najafgarh have been pulled in for protests, to transport security personnel and detainees or to be used as barricades in restricted areas where prohibitory orders have been enforced."

**'Own workers affected'**

While the drivers have been asked to work for the police, conductors have been deployed for various other duties.

"Some have been deputed far away from their homes and are facing difficulty in commuting to their workplaces," Mr. Chaudhary said. Major service disruptions have been reported on DTC routes such as 433, 445A, 415, 417, 423 and 930.

# Govt. makes Aadhaar mandatory to avail of power subsidy scheme

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

**The exercise is vital to ascertain details of those receiving benefits, stated the Sept. 30 notification**

The Delhi government has made it mandatory for domestic consumers to share Aadhaar details to avail of the benefits under the power subsidy scheme.

A notification issued by the Power Department on September 30 states that those seeking electricity subsidy must furnish their Aadhaar number through a government portal or any other mode prescribed by the government. Those who don't yet have an Aadhaar can apply using their Aadhaar Enrolment ID.

It directs the implementing agencies to publicise the information so that beneficiaries are aware of the new condition.

The electricity subsidy scheme is administered through five power discoms – BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, BSES Yamuna Power Limited, Tata Power Delhi Distribution Limited, the New Delhi Municipal Council and the Military Engineer Services.

The notification states that the expenditure on the electricity subsidy scheme is met from the Consolidated Fund of Delhi and that Aadhaar-based identification is necessary to establish the identity of those receiving the benefit.

The move is aimed at simplifying the delivery of benefits, reducing the need for multiple identity documents and promoting transparency and efficiency in the subsidy system, the department said.

The notification does not specify a deadline for existing beneficiaries to submit their Aadhaar details nor does it spell out a separate procedure for consumers already receiving the benefit.

In August, the government tabled a Comptroller and Auditor General report in the Assembly on "lapses" in the scheme under the Aam Aadmi Party. The scheme's cost rose from ₹2,405.59 crore in 2019-20 to ₹3,161 crore in 2022-23, accounting for up to 70.39% of Delhi's total subsidy expense, it stated.

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CS (OS) No.325/2017
Urmila Vohra(dead) through LRs & Anr. Plaintiffs
V/s.
M/s Janak Properties Pvt. Ltd. & Ors Defendants
To
**LRS OF DECEASED DEFENDANT NO. 2**
2(C)Mrs. Shruti Malhotra (Daughter)
D/o Late Shri Anil Malhotra,
R/o C-367, First Floor, Saraswati Vihar, Delhi-110034
2(D)Mrs. Kanika Malhotra (Daughter)
D/o Late Shri Anil Malhotra
R/o C-367, First Floor, Saraswati Vihar, Delhi-110034
WHEREAS the plaintiff above mentioned has instituted a **SUIT FOR SPECIFIC PERFORMANCE AND IN THE ALTERNATIVE SUIT FOR RECOVERY OF RS.2,50,00,000/- [RUPEES TWO CRORE FIFTY LAKH] WITH INTEREST @ 24% PER ANNUM AND FOR PERMANENT INJUNCTION** against you, the above named Lrs of deceased defendant no. 2 and whereas it has been shown to the satisfaction of this Court that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way therefore, this notice is given by publication directing you, the above named Lrs of deceased defendant no. 2 to make appearance before the **Joint Registrar(Judicial) of this Court on 08.12.2026 at 11:00 AM.**
Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day before mentioned, the suit and IA will be heard and determined in your absence.
Given under my hand and the seal of this court in terms of order dated 08.09.2026
Assistant Registrar(O)
*for* REGISTRAR GENERAL

TENDERS

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2) Proposal Reference No. HI/50/Broadcast Production/Women's Asian Champions Trophy/2026 dated 13 October 2026.
3) Proposal Reference No. HI/51/Miscellaneous Services/Women's Asian Champions Trophy/2026 dated 13 October 2026.
4) Proposal Reference No. HI/52/LED Perimeter Boards & Replay Screens/Women's Asian Champions Trophy/2026 dated 13 October 2026.
5) Proposal Reference No. HI/53/Sportainment Services /Women's Asian Champions Trophy/2026 dated 13 October 2026.
Further Details & RFPs documents are available at Hockey India
**Website :- https://hockeyindia.org/etender**
Last Dates and Time for Submission of Proposals is **03 November 2026 by 16:00 Hours** & Proposals Opening date is **04 November 2026 at 11:00 Hours**
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Bids must be submitted on or before 6:00 PM on 25.10.2026.
For further details, interested bidders may contact the following:
**Dr. G. Sivabalamurugan**
**President**
**Mobile: 9811118827**
**Sathya Ashokan**
**General Secretary**
**Mobile: 9811518596**

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Bids must be submitted on or before 6:00 PM on 25.10.2026.
For further details, interested bidders may contact the following:
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**President**
**Mobile: 9811118827**
**Sathya Ashokan**
**General Secretary**
**Mobile: 9811518596**

TENDERS

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**General Secretary**
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PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE
NOTICE OF DISSOLUTION OF MARRIAGE BY MUTUAL CONSENT
It is hereby notified to the general public that the marriage solemnized between Ms. Bamali Roy Chowdhury, Daughter of Late Sh. Parimal Kumar Roy Chowdhury, resident of H-50, Old Som Bazar Road, Mahavir Enclave, New Delhi-110045, also residing at K-2122, Chittaranjan Park, South Delhi, New Delhi-110019, and Mr. Piyush Chakraborty, Son of Sh. Bijoy Chakraborty, resident of K-2122, Chittaranjan Park, South Delhi, New Delhi-110019, on 16.02.2020, has been legally dissolved by a decree of divorce by mutual consent under Section 13B(2) of the Hindu Marriage Act, 1955, passed by the Hon'ble Court of Ms. Savita Rao, Principal Judge, Family Courts, South-East District, Saket Courts, New Delhi, in HMA No. 1580/2026, vide decree dated 19.09.2026.
Accordingly, the parties stand divorced with effect from 19.09.2026, and are no longer husband and wife in the eyes of law.
This notice is issued for information of the public, government authorities, financial institutions and all concerned parties as well as record purposes.
**Rahul Kumar Jain** (Advocate)
Ch. No. 208, Saket Court, New Delhi-17

# After AMU, Jamia students launch hunger strike over union elections

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

Days after the Aligarh Muslim University (AMU) administration reinstated union elections, two students of Jamia Millia Islamia (JMI) started an indefinite hunger strike demanding the conduct of elections, which have not taken place since 2006. Meanwhile, the JMI administration has said it has never said no to elections but has not received any written representation regarding the same.

On Tuesday, Ebin Basil, one of the two students on hunger strike, said, "We started our hunger strike yesterday [Monday] night for the reinstatement of the student union elections."

The students have said that they will continue the agitation until their demand is met. In 2006, the union was suspended over concerns of discipline and violence.

A university spokesperson said, "We have not received anything in writing from the students. The current administration has never said no to unions, but at the same time, past experiences have shown us that a system of electing department-wise representatives has served us better, as the larger student union tends to get too politicised and lead to clashes."

On October 10, the AMU administration reinstated elections after a 19-day hunger strike by students.

# DU clears ₹5,889-cr. plan for hostels for over 21,000 students

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI



Students protesting against the shortage of hostel facilities.

Delhi University's Executive Council on Tuesday approved a proposal to expand its hostel facilities for 21,895 students at a cost of ₹5,889 crore, according to an official statement. The decision follows growing concerns over student housing safety sparked by the Satya Niketan tragedy and subsequent protests by students demanding hostel facilities for all.

The proposal was approved by the Executive Council, chaired by Vice-Chancellor Yogesh Singh, said the university. It added that the designs for these buildings will be prepared with the requirements of the 21st century in mind, and with a 100-year perspective.

According to the proposal, new hostels will be constructed at an estimated cost of ₹4,027 crore, providing additional accommodation for 15,758 students. A proposal to reconstruct two existing hostels, Jubilee Hall and the PG Men's Hostel, was also passed at an estimated cost of ₹1,862 crore to provide residential facilities for 6,137 students.

The statement added, "Hostels for both boys and girls are to be built at Veer Savarkar College in Roshanpura [Najafgarh]. Additionally, hostels for men and women will be constructed at the university's West Campus in Dwarka [Najafgarh] and at the East Campus in Surajmal Vihar, Karkardooma."

The university has urged all colleges to prepare and submit proposals for new hostels on their premises to the funding agency.

# ₹10-lakh cancer drugs 'missing' from hospital; FIR registered

**Press Trust of India**
NEW DELHI

A First Information Report (FIR) was registered after four boxes containing injections of a cancer drug went missing from the Delhi State Cancer Institute in east Delhi's Dilshad Garden, the police said on Tuesday.

The retail value of the missing medicines is estimated to be between ₹9 lakh and ₹10.8 lakh, said a senior officer.

As per the complaint, four boxes containing nimotuzumab 200 mg injections kept in the refrigerator in the chemotherapy day-care department on October 3 were found missing on October 5.

The institute has constituted a committee to conduct an internal inquiry, the complaint added.

On Monday, the police registered the FIR against unknown persons. The officer added that the medical facility had reported similar incidents in the past, and the police will examine the possibility of an organised network.

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VICTORIS

## INBRIEF



### CM Bhagwant Mann's former OSD joins Congress in Punjab

A former officer on special duty (OSD) to Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann, Manjit Singh Sidhu, on Tuesday joined the Congress in the presence of State unit chief Pargat Singh in Chandigarh. Mr. Singh said Mr. Sidhu played a role in building the Aam Aadmi Party in Punjab, but was later sidelined. Mr. Sidhu had "long been looking for a political platform that prioritises harmony, public welfare and the future of Punjab", Mr. Singh said, welcoming him to the party. Mr. Sidhu said Mr. Mann perhaps prefers to stand by his chair but "I stand by Punjab". PTI

### 'Network Kerala' event held in Delhi to boost tourism in State

The Kerala Tourism Department on Tuesday organised the 'Network Kerala' event in New Delhi in a bid to push the State's tourism sector beyond pre-pandemic levels. The initiative aimed to connect local industry players, including hoteliers, travel agencies, and specialised Ayurvedic centres, with national and international travel agents based in the national capital. Speaking at the event, Additional Director (General) of the Department of Tourism, Sumit Kumar Thakur, said the number of international tourists visiting Keralam is below pre-COVID-19 levels.

# Anger mounts in Punjab after anti-drug crusader killed in broad daylight

Confronted over illegal sale of addictive substances, medical store owner shoots down activist; Mansa residents stage massive protests; family refuses to cremate body; Oppn. corners AAP govt.

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHANDIGARH

An anti-drug crusader was shot dead on Tuesday at a local medical store in Punjab's Mansa district, sparking widespread outrage and putting the ruling Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) on the back foot over the State's "deteriorating" law and order situation.

According to the police, Parvinder Singh Jhota was allegedly shot dead by a medical store owner when he confronted the latter for selling illegal addictive substances to a man.

Though he was rushed to hospital, doctors declared Jhota brought dead. The accused fled the spot soon after the incident and police teams have been formed to nab him.

The police said Jhota was recording the argument on his mobile phone. In a purported video that surfaced online, Jhota could be heard saying that the medical store owner, Ashwani, had taken out his pistol.



Family members of the victim, Parvinder Singh Jhota, outside a civil hospital in Punjab's Mansa district on Tuesday. ANI

Bathinda Range DIG Harjeet Singh said: "The accused appeared to have used a licensed weapon for committing the crime. His accomplice has been arrested. Efforts are on to apprehend Ashwani."

The DIG said the incident could stem from an old personal enmity between the two. "The case is being investigated thoroughly and the accused will be arrested within 24 hours," Senior Superintendent of Police, Mansa, Vaibhav Choudhary said.

A former boxer, Jhota had been running a campaign against drug abuse through the 'Nasha Roko, Rozgaar Do' drive.

After the incident, scores of people staged a protest outside Mansa civil hospital. Shops were also shut down in the town. Protesters vandalised the medical store of the accused. Jhota's family refused to cremate the body, blaming the State government for its "failure" to curb substance abuse.

The Opposition tore into the AAP government even as supporters of the deceased blocked the Barnala-Sirsa road in Mansa.

BJP national president Nitin Nabin said the brazen daylight murder of Jhota, who raised his voice against drugs in Mansa, exposed the "extremely poor state of law and order" in Punjab under the AAP government.

**'CM must resign'**

Demanding Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann's resignation, senior Shiromani Akali Dal leader Harsimrat Kaur Badal said, "The drug mafia has become so emboldened under his [Bhagawant Mann] regime that it is now resorting to daylight killing of anti-drug activists. The manner in which Jhota was killed proves that the drug mafia does not have any fear of the law."

Leader of the Opposition in the Assembly and Congress leader Partap Singh Bajwa said Jhota's murder has "exposed the grim reality" behind the AAP government's much-publicised 'Yudh Nasheyan Virudh' campaign.

# Khandu agrees to withdraw FIRs over Siang dam protest

**Press Trust of India**
ITANAGAR



Arunachal CM Pema Khandu

Arunachal Pradesh Chief Minister Pema Khandu on Tuesday agreed in principle to reduce the number of security personnel deployed in the Siang Valley and withdraw FIRs registered during protests against the proposed 11,200 MW hydropower project in the region – two of the key demands of the agitators.

This is being seen as the government's willingness to take confidence-building measures amid growing tensions over the mega dam that has been projected as a driver of economic growth and a means of strengthening water and energy security for the State and the nation.

In a post on X after a meeting with the Adi Baane Kebang Youth Wing and the Adi Students' Union, Mr. Khandu said his government remained committed to dialogue and finding a way forward over the issue through mutual understanding.

The CM also said he has received requests from the two organisations for a reduction in the number of security forces deployed in the valley and withdrawal of FIRs. "I agree to these proposals in principle as confidence-building measures to facilitate dialogue," he said. Mr. Khandu expressed hope that both organisations would work constructively to create an atmosphere of trust.

The development comes amid heightened tension in the Siang Valley, where sections of the Adi community have been opposing the pre-feasibility report for the proposed hydropower project. The deployment of security personnel to facilitate the preparatory work has further sharpened the differences between the State government and sections of the local populace.

Officials said that Mr. Khandu's announcement was expected to open the way for further engagement, although the broader disagreement over the Siang dam project remains unresolved.

# DSP slaps advocate amid row over parking, apologises after lawyers stage protest in Ajmer

**The Hindu Bureau**
JAIPUR

Lawyers in Ajmer district's Kishangarh town boycotted work and staged a protest after a woman Deputy Superintendent of Police (DSP) and Circle Officer (Traffic) allegedly slapped an advocate during a dispute over vehicle parking in the market.

A video of the incident went viral on social media, prompting lawyers to demand action against the police officer.

Lawyers at the Ajmer district headquarters in Rajasthan took to the streets on Monday, leading to disruption of traffic on the Ajmer-Jaipur road.

The matter was resolved after the police officer, Anju Yadav, recorded a video with the advocate, Babulal Bagaria, and tendered an apology. Mr. Bagaria had parked his car on the roadside in the town's main market over the weekend and gone to buy vegetables. When he returned, Ms. Yadav, who was looking after traffic management, questioned him about parking the vehicle and said it was not allowed at the spot.

**The matter was resolved after the woman officer tendered an apology in a video shot with the advocate sitting beside her**

**'Slapped, threatened me'**

The advocate later, in a statement, claimed that he apologised and assured the officer that he would park the vehicle at the designated space in future.

"Despite this, Ms. Yadav took my car key, slapped me in front of numerous bystanders and threatened me," Mr. Bagaria said.

Following the incident, members of the Bar Association gathered at the market and staged a protest demanding suspension of the police officer.

Meanwhile, Ms. Yadav made an allegedly offensive comment on a social media platform. Later, on the intervention of senior police officers, Ms. Yadav met Mr. Bagaria and expressed regret over the incident. In a video shot with the advocate sitting beside her, Ms. Yadav said she had no malice towards Mr. Bagaria and she should not have behaved in that manner during the argument.

Kishangarh Bar Association president Dinesh Kumar Jat said both sides had reached an agreement and the lawyers accepted Ms. Yadav's apology.

# Shivraj's twin remarks fuel buzz of rift in M.P. BJP

NEWS ANALYSIS

**Mehul Malpani**
BHOPAL

Two statements from former Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Sunday – one a sharp rebuke and the other a soft political reminder – were enough to heat up the State's politics and fuel speculation that all may not be well within the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP). The latest row hints at mounting pressure on Chief Minister Mohan Yadav amid reports of differences between him and other senior party leaders, including Cabinet Ministers and State BJP president Hemant Khandelwal.

Mr. Chouhan, now Union Agriculture Minister, criticised the State government over the demolition of houses of 12 tribal families at Kosmi village in Vidisha, his Lok Sabha constituency. The remarks are being seen as a message of his discontent with his successor's administration. The eviction drive, carried out on grounds of alleged encroachment on forest land, was undertaken despite Mr. Chouhan having intervened in the matter.



Madhya Pradesh CM Mohan Yadav (right) with his predecessor and Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan. FILE PHOTO

However, another statement made by him at an event in neighbouring Raisen district on the same day may hold greater political relevance. Referring to the Ladli Behna scheme that he launched in his final year as Chief Minister in 2023, Mr. Chouhan said, "The Chief Minister has continued this scheme and every government will have to keep it going. *Sabko pata hain ki behenein gussa ho gayi toh phir khair nahi hain* (Everybody knows that if sisters get angry, you are done for)."

**'Calculated move'**

The former CM's remarks came a week after Mr. Yadav said in jest at an event on October 4 that the scheme had proved to be a "very expensive affair".

Political observers who have followed Mr. Chouhan's politics see various women-centric schemes as his legacy, which earned him the sobriquet '*Mama* (maternal uncle)'. Observers and BJP insiders believe that the timing of Mr. Chouhan's twin remarks could be a "deliberate and calculated" move.

A senior BJP leader in Bhopal, on condition of anonymity, said, "Shivraj*ji* is well aware of the current power dynamic in the State BJP and that resentment is rising against the man who replaced him [Mr. Yadav]. So, his statements could be a calculated move to put his weight behind that resentment and add to the Chief Minister's pressure. He also specifically said he spoke to the State [BJP] president [on the tribals' issue] because he knows of the recent rumours of differences between him and the Chief Minister."

The leader also pointed out that Mr. Chouhan's "unusually harsh words" for Forest officials over the eviction drive hold significance as Mr. Yadav himself heads the department.

Senior journalist and political observer Rashid Kidwai also linked Mr. Chouhan's recent remarks to his efforts to remain "relevant in the State while growing his stature in the national BJP". "Shivraj knows that he is only important in Delhi as long as he remains relevant in Madhya Pradesh," he said.

Mr. Kidwai also pointed out that while the BJP has many regional satraps in Madhya Pradesh, Mr. Chouhan could be the only leader with a pan-State appeal. "And he wants to keep it that way."

"Mohan Yadav's relevance will depend on the U.P. poll results, whether they are in the BJP's favour or not. Till then, he may continue to enjoy Delhi's backing as he has these past three years," he said.

The Opposition Congress, meanwhile, has linked the Kosmi incident to a "power tussle". "This action is a new chapter in the open conflict brewing between the Chief Ministers of the BJP," State unit president Jitu Patwari said.

# Waqf Board takes U-turn on uniform Friday sermons in J&K mosques after facing flak

**Peerzada Ashiq**
SRINAGAR

In the face of opposition by Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah, Kashmir chief cleric Mirwaiz Umar Farooq, and Peoples Democratic Party (PDP) president Mehbooba Mufti to the J&K Waqf Board's move to introduce uniform Friday sermons in mosques, senior BJP leader and chairperson of the board Darakshan Andrabi on Tuesday took a U-turn and said "such decisions will be taken by preachers and not politicians".

"There is no order to have uniform sermons. In a meeting on Sunday, religious scholars and preachers suggested to fight social evils collectively. *Ulemas* (scholars) and *khateebs* (preachers) will decide the topics for Friday sermons through a board. It's them (preachers) and not politicians who get to decide on such matters," she said.



> This is an unacceptable attempt by the BJP to interfere in the religious affairs of Muslims and won't be accepted under any circumstances
>
> **OMAR ABDULLAH**
> Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister

Ms. Andrabi said the idea was to "forcefully and unitedly raise voice over social issues like drugs, late marriages, waywardness, and recent cases of damaging of orchards".

The U-turn came two days after Ms. Andrabi proposed to have a core committee of preachers to predecide topics for sermons in J&K mosques.

**Public outcry**

Ishtiyaq Mohi-ud-Din, an executive magistrate on the board, had informed the preachers about the board's directive that "only one topic will be highlighted [in the sermons]".

The move, however, evoked public outcry and drew criticism from the regional parties. "This is an unacceptable attempt by the BJP to interfere in the religious affairs of Muslims and will not be accepted under any circumstances. The BJP-appointed chairperson must immediately halt this misplaced attempt to please her masters," Mr. Abdullah said.

Mr. Farooq, who also heads a pan-J&K conglomerate of religious bodies, Mutahida Majlis-e-Ulema, said, "Even the suggestion that a statutory body could determine or regulate what is to be preached from the pulpit is ridiculous, and will never be accepted by the Muslims of Jammu and Kashmir."

PDP president Mehbooba Mufti termed the move "totally unacceptable".

# Madras HC upholds Speaker's decision to accept resignation of 6 AIADMK legislators

**Mohamed Imranullah S.**
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court on Tuesday upheld the decision of Tamil Nadu Assembly Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar to accept the resignation of six AIADMK MLAs, who later joined the ruling TVK, between May 26, 2026 and June 29, 2026. But it directed him to decide within two months the disqualification proceedings pending against four of them.

The First Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan said the Speaker was duty-bound to rise above his individual predilections and respect the robe which the Constitution had gifted to him. "The Speaker is expected to respect the sensitive constitutional trust by acting on the said disqualification proceedings with utmost expedition," it added.



J.C.D. Prabhakar

The judges expressed surprise over the disqualification proceedings kept pending for the last four months against the four resigned MLAs – Esakki Subaya (Ambasamudram), S. Jayakumar (Perundurai), Maragatham Kumaravel (Maduranthakam) and P. Sathyabama (Dharapuram) – with the last two having been re-elected to the Assembly recently from the same constituencies.

**The Speaker has been asked to decide in two months the disqualification proceedings pending against four of them**

The court directed the Speaker to prepare a timetable within seven days providing specific timelines and deadlines for various stages of the proceedings such as filing of replies by the defecting MLAs, receiving the complainant's objections to those replies, finalisation of pleadings, and hearing the final arguments. Such a timetable must be made public for the benefit of all stakeholders, it ordered.

The Bench also directed the Speaker not to allow any of the defecting MLAs to unnecessarily delay the proceedings by seeking adjournments on flimsy grounds. In any case, not more than two adjournments should be given to the defecting MLAs since the proceedings were pending at the stage of issuance of notices to them for the last four months, the Bench reiterated.

Published by Nirmala Lakshman and Printed by S. Ramanujam at HT Media Ltd. Plot No. 8, Udyog Vihar, Greater Noida Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P. 201306, on behalf of THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., Chennai-600002. Editor: Suresh Nambath Chandrasekar (Responsible for selection of news under the PRP Act).
ISSN 0971 - 751X

# Shivakumar seeks report on police action at SIR protest

Will take action if there was 'unnecessary use of force', says Karnataka CM; assurance comes a day after police manhandled protesters; 'people can hold peaceful protests without fear'

**The Hindu Bureau**
BENGALURU

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar said he had taken note of the police action against protesters and members of the media on Monday, and had sought a full report on the circumstances that led to it. "If there has been any unnecessary use of force or excess, accountability will follow," he said.

This comes a day after the Bengaluru police detained over 100 persons for attempting to march to the office of the Chief Electoral Officer, Karnataka, to protest against the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. The police also manhandled journalists and photographers, apart from protesters, on a day Mr. Shivakumar was participating in an anti-SIR rally in New Delhi, drawing widespread criticism.



**Dissent hour:** A protest under way in Bengaluru on Tuesday against SIR and the assault on protesters. K. MURALI KUMAR

"The right to peaceful protest is fundamental to our democracy. We cannot demand that right for ourselves in Delhi and deny it to others in Bengaluru. Karnataka must hold itself to the democratic standards that we expect from the rest of the country. There will be no double standard," the Chief Minister said on Tuesday. "Let me be clear: disagreement with the Election Commission, disagreement with my government or disagreement with me personally does not diminish anyone's right to peacefully express it," he added.

Home Minister Priyank Kharge said he had issued instructions to the police to ensure that no peaceful demonstration is disrupted. "Our responsibility is not merely to maintain law and order, but to create an environment where every citizen can express dissent freely, peacefully and without fear. In a democracy, peaceful dissent is not a threat to law and order. It is a right that law and order must protect," Mr. Kharge wrote on X.

# Keralam did not stand up to ED like other non-BJP States, alleges CPI(M)'s Govindan

**The Hindu Bureau**
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The CPI(M) on Tuesday accused Keralam Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan of "slyly playing second fiddle" to the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh's agenda to weaken the secular Opposition by using the Enforcement Directorate (ED) to foist false charges against Leader of the Opposition Pinarayi Vijayan and others in the CMRL-Exalogic case. CPI(M) State secretary M.V. Govindan told a press conference that Mr. Satheesan's statement on not to appeal the HC order on FIR against Mr. Vijayan and others was the latest corroboration of Mr. Satheesan's "symbiotic association" with the Sangh Parivar.

# 'Permission not taken': police stop Mamata's rally against CEC in Kolkata

**Shiv Sahay Singh**
KOLKATA

Leaders and supporters of the Mamata All India Trinamool Congress on Tuesday were not allowed to take out a march against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and the special intensive revision (SIR), with the police saying that no permission was obtained for the rally.

Senior party leaders Rajya Sabha MP Dola Sen, MLA and former Minister Sobhandeb Chattopadhyay and spokesperson Kunal Ghosh reached Rajabazar with their supporters and raised slogans against the CEC. However, after some time the police stopped the protesters from marching forward and the crowd dispersed.


Mamata All-India Trinamool Congress MLA Kunal Ghosh during a protest against the CEC in Kolkata on Tuesday. ANI

This was the first major attempt by the Mamata Banerjee-led faction to organise protest over the issue.

Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari had directed the police not to allow the protesters to march ahead. Commissioner of Kolkata Police Ajay Kumar Nand told mediapersons that they had not received any official notification or application for the procession.

"The police are not aware of from where the procession will start, where it will end... The police administration cannot work by looking at social media posts or posters," he said.

## 'Knife attack bid' on Mamata

**The Hindu Bureau**
KOLKATA

A complaint was filed with the police alleging that a woman carrying a knife attempted to approach former West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee when she was going to inaugurate a Durga Puja near her residence on Tuesday.

## Court issues gag order on airing videos on Siddaramaiah

A Bengaluru civil court on Tuesday issued an ad-interim ex parte temporary injunction restraining further circulation of two videos telecast on two private YouTube channels making allegedly defamatory remarks against former Karnataka CM Siddaramaiah. The interim order restrains 42 media houses from disseminating the impugned videos.

**Timings**
**DELHI**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **WEDNESDAY, OCT. 14** | | | |
| RISE | 06:21 | SET | 17:53 |
| RISE | 09:45 | SET | 20:01 |
| **THURSDAY, OCT. 15** | | | |
| RISE | 06:22 | SET | 17:52 |
| RISE | 10:41 | SET | 20:49 |
| **FRIDAY, OCT. 16** | | | |
| RISE | 06:22 | SET | 17:51 |
| RISE | 11:35 | SET | 21:41 |

| Delhi Weather | max | min |
|---|---|---|
| Delhi City | 32 | 21 |
| Safdarjang | 32 | 21 |
| Palam | 31 | 21 |

**Delhi Palam Today**
**34°C** The weather will be warm. Night will be pleasant. Spell of light to moderate rain and thundershower with gusty winds to occur.

**Delhi Palam Tomorrow**
**30°C** Fall in temperature. Day will be slight warm. Night will be pleasant. Spell of moderate rain and thundershower with gusty winds to occur.

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# OPPORTUNITIES

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| S. No | Name of the Post | No. of Posts | Type of Employment | Consolidated Pay for Contract / Deputation* (Per Month) | Min Exp. (Yrs) | Max Age (Yrs) | Required Qualification |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
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| 4 | Manager (Electrical Traction) | 1 | | | | | BE / B.Tech (Electrical) |
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iii) Age, qualification & experience stipulated for the above posts should be as on **14-10-2026.** Age will be relaxed for deserving & experienced candidates.
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| 3 | Manager (Hull) | 1 Post |
| 4 | Deputy Manager (Electrical Design) | 1 Post |
| 5 | Deputy Manager (Quality control) | 1 Post |
| | **OFFICER ON CONTRACT BASIS FOR CHENGALPATTU** Ref No. UCSL/IMS/HR/VN/F/11- AM/FIN/CPT/VN98 dated 07 October 2026 | |
| 6 | Assistant Manager (Finance) | 1 Post |
| | **SUPERVISORS ON REGULAR BASIS FOR MALPE** Ref No. UCSL/IMS/HR/VN/F/11-SUPs(Mech/Nest)/97 dated 07 October 2026 | |
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| 8 | Supervisor (Mechanical) | 1 Post |

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MANAGER (HR&IR)

Khadi India
Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Govt. of India

No. SOA/GVY/Tender/ 2026-27

**Tender Notice**

The Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC), a statutory organization functioning under the administrative control of the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises, Government of India, has invited bids through the Government e-Marketplace (GeM) portal for the procurement of Paper Conversion Machines (HMPAFI) under the Gramodyog Vikas Yojana, for distribution to beneficiaries through all offices in the Northern Region (Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8087649).

Interested bidders may participate in the tender through the GeM portal. For further details, please visit the official website of the Khadi and Village Industries Commission at **https://www.kvic.gov.in** or contact this office at telephone number **0171-2630334** or via email at **soambala.kvic@gov.in.**

The last date for submission of bids is as indicated on the GeM portal.

**KHADI AND VILLAGE INDUSTRIES COMMISSION**
**Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises Govt. of India**

| State office, KVIC Ambala | राज्य कार्यालय, के.वी.आई.सी अम्बाला |
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## Spiralling food prices

### Rural households have felt the greatest impact of rising inflation

September's retail inflation, at 5.54%, an almost two-year high, marks the fourth consecutive month that price increases have kept headline CPI above the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) 4% target. The impact has been particularly severe for rural Indians, whose inflation rate reached 6.08%. Rural food inflation rose almost two percentage points between August and September, touching 8.06%. Onion (108.09%), garlic (54.62%) and ginger (62.85%) drove the surge, even as potato (-11.50%) and tomato (-8.62%) prices remained below year-earlier levels. The festive season ahead will be expensive for rural households already facing the uncertainties of a deficient monsoon, El Niño-related risks to harvests and incomes, and unusually high temperatures. Headline CPI is now just 0.46 percentage points below the RBI's upper tolerance limit of 6%. The Monetary Policy Committee raised the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50% in October, ending a pause that began after its previous increase in February 2023. Another increase in December cannot be ruled out if price pressures continue to broaden. Chief among the factors driving inflation since the U.S.-Israeli war on Iran have been fuel, food and transport, compounded by a depreciating rupee.

The Indian crude basket, according to the Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell, rose from $82.04 a barrel in July to $116.09 in September – a 41% increase – with economy-wide implications for freight, production and distribution. The RBI's special dollar facility for oil marketing companies may ease spot-market pressure on the rupee, but only temporarily if the underlying import dependence and geopolitical risks persist. The crucial subgroup, transport services for goods, recorded inflation of 14.73% in September, up from 14.64% in August. Restaurant and accommodation services inflation has reached 9.36%, while inflation in personal care, social protection and miscellaneous goods and services, which include precious metals, has moderated to 13.75%. Core inflation, excluding food and fuel but including precious metals, rose to 4.6% in September from 4.16% in August, suggesting that price pressures are broadening. Foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) have pulled a record ₹3.08 trillion ($32.73 billion) out of Indian equities in the nine months ending September this year, which is almost double that of the whole of CY2025. FPIs have been net sellers in six of the past nine months as they seek safe havens, stronger dollar-denominated returns, and bond yields. Selling resumed in October, adding to pressure on the rupee, which weakened by about 7% against the dollar over the year to early October, despite RBI interventions such as direct dollar sales and attracting foreign-currency inflows. The central bank's latest steps have helped the rupee recover, but cannot resolve the underlying pressures. With crude prices elevated, the rupee vulnerable and no clear end to the West Asia conflict, imported inflation is likely to continue shaping domestic prices in the months ahead.

## Sound and fiery

### Green crackers do little to curb air and noise pollution

As Delhi and the National Capital Region (NCR) head into another winter, they must brace for the return of a foe kept on a leash that is alternately loosened or tightened. In November 2016, the Supreme Court of India suspended licences for the sale of fireworks in the NCR after Deepavali celebrations pushed $PM_{2.5}$ levels above 700 µg/m³. The Court relaxed the suspension in September 2017, partly to protect existing licence holders and livelihoods, but restored the suspension for Deepavali in October. In 2018, in its judgment in *Arjun Gopal and Others vs Union of India and Others*, the Court allowed only reduced-emission and "green" crackers, banned joined firecrackers or *laris*, and imposed a two-hour window. The latest order permits specified next-generation joined green crackers, while declining a total ban on fireworks, invoking public sentiment. Fire crackers are far from the smoking gun of Delhi's air-quality crisis. Construction dust, vehicles, stubble burning and stagnant, cold air all contribute to winter pollution. But when these push the air towards "severe" levels, crackers can produce an acute spike. In 2025, the first Deepavali after the Court permitted limited use of green crackers, Delhi's post-Deepavali $PM_{2.5}$ average reached 488 µg/m³, the highest since 2021, while hourly concentrations peaked at 675 µg/m³.

There is no gainsaying that green crackers are a pyrrhic green. The Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (CSIR-NEERI), which promoted them, says the newer generation promises a 45%-60% cut in $PM_{10}$. These figures, however, do not reflect real-world conditions, and when "cleaner" crackers are burst in greater numbers, the savings in particulate pollution evaporate. This is without accounting for noise pollution. There is also the difficulty of enforcement. The Commission for Air Quality Management has stated that QR codes had been sold to unregistered manufacturers – registered manufacturers reportedly sold them, allowing unauthorised firecrackers to be passed off as certified green crackers. The explosives regulator had no testing facility in Delhi. In 2018 and 2019, the police could not distinguish green crackers from conventional ones. Unless fireworks manufacturing moves into the formal sector, regulations are followed in practice, and awareness of the toll on public health spreads among those who love the sound and fury of crackers, air and noise pollution are here to stay.

# *India's problem of overtreatment, overmedication*



**Chandrakant Lahariya**

A practising physician and the author of 'Pill-Free: You Don't Need Everything You Have Been Prescribed' (2026)

Modern medicine has never been more capable than it is today. Tests detect illness earlier, scans reveal invisible abnormalities, medicines prevent and treat diseases, and interventions and procedures can save lives within minutes. Yet, the same system that can do more is increasingly tempted to overtreat and overmedicate.

Overtreatment and overmedication are not simply the use of an unnecessary medicine but often a chain: a test detects an incidental abnormality, which leads to another test, a diagnosis and then a prescription that may become permanent. What begins as prevention can end in long-term medication or surgery. Then, in India, overtreatment coexists with undertreatment: unnecessary interventions are offered to some, while many others still lack essential primary care, affordable medicines and timely treatment.

**Health packages and tests**

The rise of overtreatment is the result of a convergence of several factors. The first driver of overtreatment is unnecessary and excessive testing – both screening and diagnostic – which creates a cascade of care. A review article in the prestigious *National Medical Journal of India* in 2016 found that routine health-check packages often include unwarranted tests that can lead to false-positive results, anxiety, further investigations, overdiagnosis and overtreatment. The truth is that the ability to test has expanded faster than our ability to decide who actually needs testing.

The second driver is the fragmentation of health and medical care. Its most visible manifestation in India is an excessive focus on specialist and super specialist care. A person with a common health problem often goes directly to a specialist or superspecialist. A person with chronic conditions may consult several specialists, each optimising one part of care without necessarily paying attention to the person's other health problems. The patient is treated in parts, while the human body does not live in specialties.

This matters particularly in older adults. A systematic review and meta-analysis of Indian studies, published in *Frontiers in Pharmacology* in 2021, reported polypharmacy in about 49% of older adults. Another study, published in Scientific Reports in 2025, found that roughly one-third of older adults were taking five or more prescribed medicines (polypharmacy), with potentially inappropriate medicines identified in 28.8% of cases.

These figures do not mean that everyone taking several medicines is being overtreated. They do, however, show why medication reviews and deprescribing must become routine.

Unnecessary tests, prescriptions and procedures are part of the growing overtreatment problem

A third force is the transformation of health care into a marketplace. Laboratory tests, radiological investigations, procedures, supplements and monitoring devices have become products to be sold – sometimes products in search of potential customers. As a result, the boundaries between those who genuinely need these interventions and those who do not can become blurred. A linked aspect is that much of health care and medical care in India operates on a fee-for-service model, which can reward activity rather than restraint. Many patients consider a medical consultation complete only when several medicines and investigations have been prescribed.

Health insurance is a proven solution for financial protection from health-related expenses, as the cost is borne by the insurer. However, it can create both 'ex-ante' and 'ex-post' moral hazards, discouraging preventive care and encouraging hospitals and patients to favour costlier interventions. What is forgotten is that while someone else may bear the financial cost, it is the patient's body that undergoes the intervention. Paying insurance premiums for years does not mean that one must 'recover' the money by undergoing a relatively unnecessary procedure or surgery.

Fourth, patient beliefs and expectations arising from advances in medical care where people want certainty when they are worried and may feel that something tangible should follow a consultation. Reassurance can look like inaction; observation can feel inferior to a scan; lifestyle advice can appear less serious than medication. Doctors may respond to these expectations, particularly in crowded clinics where explanation requires time.

The fifth driver is the rise of 'defensive medicine', in which clinicians, fearing that they might miss a rare diagnosis, may consider ordering another test as the safer option. What is often forgotten, however, is that every test carries potential risks, both from the test itself and from the discovery of abnormalities that may never have caused harm.

**Choosing wisely**

India is not alone in facing this problem. Overtreatment first became widely recognised in high-income countries and is now increasingly visible across many middle-income nations. This gave rise to the global Choosing Wisely movement, which encourages people to choose health-care interventions more carefully. It is against this backdrop, between 2012 and 2023, that nearly 80 specialty societies worldwide published close to 700 recommendations identifying hundreds of tests and treatments that clinicians and patients should question. The message is that medicine requires stronger mechanisms for self-correction. The solutions are about practising better medicine. Halting and reversing overmedicalisation requires the engagement of all stakeholders, including individuals, communities, professional societies and health policymakers.

First, India needs to rebuild stronger and functional primary care and restore the family physician as the first point of contact for most non-emergency health needs. A general physician can decide which problems require specialist expertise, reconcile multiple prescriptions and recognise when treatment can safely be reduced. Initiation of care by a general physician, followed by continuity through the referral pathway, protects patients against overmedication and excess surgeries.

Second, every medical prescription should carry a review date and, where appropriate, a possible stop date. Medicines should not become lifelong simply because nobody asks whether they are still needed. Older adults and people taking five or more medicines should periodically undergo a structured medication review assessing indication, benefit, duplication, interactions and opportunities for deprescribing.

**Develop India-specific lists**

Third, professional medical societies and the Indian Council of Medical Research should develop Indian lists of low-value tests, treatments and procedures – similar to Choosing Wisely – and embed these principles in medical training, accreditation and quality-improvement programmes. Hospitals should measure not only whether recommended care was provided, but also whether unnecessary care was avoided.

Fourth, before starting any test or treatment, patients should note that these four questions matter: Why do I need this? What happens if I wait? What are the possible benefits and risks? What are the alternatives? These questions can substantially improve clinical conversations and outcomes.

Fifth, payment systems and health insurance must reward outcomes, clinical reasoning and continuity of care rather than volume alone. A health-care system should not make it financially easier to order a scan than to explain thoughtfully why that scan may be unnecessary.

Medical advances will continue – and they should. However, the next stage of medical progress will come not only from discovering more tests, medicines and procedures, but also from learning when not to use them. Good medicine requires action when action helps. In an age of medical abundance, it increasingly requires something more difficult – restraint.

# *India-U.S. ties and the hurdle of American unilateralism*



**Rajeev Agarwal**

A retired colonel and a strategic affairs expert. He is the author of the book, 'Between Tehran and Tel Aviv – Gaza's Story of Unending War'

Have ties between India and the United States reached a breaking point? Where do they go from here? These and many other questions are being intensely debated following the U.S.'s announcement on October 8 that it had suspended the Permanent Labour Certification (PERM) programme for eight global IT companies, including some Indian-headquartered companies, accusing them of misusing immigration and labour-certification systems. The Indian companies named were Infosys, Tata Consultancy Services, Wipro, Cognizant and HCL.

The PERM programme allows tech companies to hire non-U.S. professionals to work in the U.S. and is a step in a employer-sponsored green-card application. According to the U.S. government, tthe companies had received more than 2,30,000 H-1B visa approvals and over 1,00,000 permanent labour certifications since 2009. Indian professionals account for more than 70% of approved H-1B petitions annually.

This episode, however, is not an isolated incident but part of a series of actions and decisions taken by the U.S. in recent years, including the ill-treatment of Indians and racist attacks against them that are placing bilateral ties under severe strain.

**Trade ties, visible discord**

Trade has emerged as a visible source of discord and asymmetry for three main reasons. First, India recorded a trade surplus of $33.8 billion in bilateral trade exceeding $140 billion in FY 2025-26. Second, the U.S. is seeking access to India's dairy and agriculture sectors in ongoing trade negotiations, which India cannot afford to concede. Third, India has refused to halt Russian oil imports despite additional U.S. tariffs and sanctions.

Despite a framework for an interim agreement on reciprocal and mutually beneficial trade announced in February 2026, the strain in trade ties persists. Last week, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said that trade talk negotiations had "plateaued", with little scope for give-and-take.

Washington wants a subservient India, but New Delhi must draw the line

Defence and security cooperation has emerged as a key pillar of relations. Over the past two decades, India and the U.S. have expanded military exercises, logistics arrangements and intelligence-sharing. American weapons platforms have also become increasingly important to India's military modernisation.

Since 2002, India has acquired over $22 billion worth of American military hardware, but meaningful co-production and technology transfer remain elusive. During Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Washington in February 2025, the U.S. agreed to expand defence sales and co-production in India, including Javelin anti-tank guided missiles and Stryker infantry combat vehicles. The two countries subsequently signed a 10-year Framework for the U.S.-India Major Defence Partnership on October 31, 2025.

However, a strategic defence partnership of this magnitude must be assessed by what it delivers, not merely the number of agreements signed. Prolonged delays in the supply of GE F404 engines for India's Tejas fighter aircraft highlight the risks of relying on foreign suppliers for critical military components and the strategic cost of supply-chain vulnerabilities. Despite initiatives such as the India-U.S. Defence Acceleration Ecosystem (INDUS-X), launched in 2023, co-development and technology transfer remain an issue.

**The Pakistan factor**

Pakistan has always been a politically sensitive source of friction between India and the U.S., particularly since Operation Sindoor (May 2025). U.S. President Donald Trump's repeated claims that he ended the conflict have irked India, although New Delhi has refrained from direct confrontation. The U.S.'s courting of Pakistan's top leadership, especially its Chief of Defence Forces, Asim Munir, has also been a major irritant. The signing of the Mecca Pact between Saudi Arabia, Pakistan and Türkiye, reportedly with Washington's blessings, has raised further security concerns for India.

High-end technology is another area in which India has often been forced to look to the U.S. – a situation that Washington has sought to exploit. Although the 2008 India-U.S. civil nuclear agreement was a historic breakthrough, its commercial promise of American-designed nuclear reactors in India remains largely unrealised. The Initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology (iCET), launched in 2023, was cited as an attempt to deepen cooperation in artificial intelligence, semiconductors, defence innovation, space and other advanced technologies, but much remains on paper. The India-U.S. Transforming the Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology (TRUST) Initiative, signed on February 13, 2025, also raised hopes of greater technology transfer and integration. The key challenge, however, remains translating declarations into measurable outcomes.

**Need for mutual respect**

India-U.S. relations are entering a phase in which India's strategic restraint and efforts at accommodation are increasingly met with American pressure, unilateralism and outright disregard for India's strategic interests. Whether this is a difficult phase or a deeper structural problem remains to be seen. The relationship between the world's oldest democracy and the world's largest democracy can flourish only through equality, respect and trust, not unilateral imposition of will. External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar's recent observation that the U.S. is "deliberately becoming a lonelier power" may convey more than what the words suggest.

## LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

**Young voices, new politics**

What the stir over the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls has achieved is the emergence of several charismatic young faces whom Gen Z can rally around. This could well shape the political narrative of the future. Staying relevant will be a formidable challenge for all political parties, particularly the Bharatiya Janata Party. What is remarkable about these young voices is the depth of their leadership pool. Detain one set of leaders and another steps forward to address the media. That kind of a resilience is remarkable. Their clarity of thought, confidence in expression and ability to articulate their concerns suggest that this is not merely a moment of protest but potentially the beginning of a new political narrative.

**Pavan Kumar N.R.,**
Shivamogga, Karnataka

**Visual indictment**

*The Hindu*'s illustrator deserves compliments for a brilliant and piercing visual (Inside pages, 'On the draw', October 11). The depiction of the Chief Election Commissioner of India, Gyanesh Kumar, as a fly ruining a glass of milk has captured public anger directed at the Election Commission of India (ECI) and the controversy around the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. The cartoon reminds us that democracy cannot function when the very umpire tasked with keeping the pitch clean is seen as the contaminant. The Supreme Court of India's recent questions on voter roll modifications only add weight to this powerful visual.

Instead of clamping down on dissent, the government and the ECI must answer why a routine exercise has instead left lakhs of genuine voters out in the cold.

**R. Sivakumar,**
Chennai

**A day for dam safety**

The Srisailam dam across the Krishna river experienced an unprecedented peak inflow of about 25.50 lakh cubic feet per second during the October 2009 floods, with high inflows for nearly 78 hours. On October 3, 2009, the reservoir level reached 896.50 feet, 11.50 feet above the Full Reservoir Level of 885 feet. This extraordinary event underscores the importance of dam safety and resilience. October 3 should therefore be observed every year as India's National Dam Safety Day.

**Y. Abdul Basheer,**
Hyderabad

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the full postal address and the full name or the name with initials.

# Why Congress must not smear CJP



**Vanya Vaidehi Bhargav**

Historian at the National Law School of India, Bangalore, and the author of 'Being Hindu, Being Indian: Lala Lajpat Rai's Ideas of Nationhood'

Something unprecedented is afoot. India's opposition parties and thousands of ordinary citizens are finally galvanised against the Modi government. They are speaking in one voice against voter suppression and for India's democratic future. The staggering police counter-mobilisation suggests the once-invincible government feels threatened. Yet, Opposition parties may squander this opportunity. Hints are evident on Twitter, where some Congress supporters are attacking the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP).

The conspiracy theory being peddled is that the CJP was created by the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)-Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), and their supposed 'B-team', the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), to draw youth support away from Rahul Gandhi. This ignores the fact that Abhijeet Dipke, CJP founder, has accused Amit Shah of turning the Delhi Police into a 'bunch of criminals', and called Prime Minister Modi a "psychotic dictator" lacking the *aukaat* (worth) to become greater than Nehru, and who became Prime Minister due to vote theft. The unprecedented police repression of CJP's October 10 protest too contradicts this theory. However, this attempt by some Congress supporters to discredit the CJP is significant; it reveals their insecurity, that CJP leaders, some of whom had previous affiliations with the AAP, will repeat AAP's history of undercutting Congress's support base in Delhi and Punjab. They intend to discredit the CJP in order to keep youth support safe for Mr. Gandhi. It will instead erode it.

The youth had grown frustrated with India's education system, economy and infrastructure. This was worsened by relentless propaganda denying people's reality, a stifling atmosphere of fear, and the closure of all channels of democratic dissent. The CJP's call to assemble at Jantar Mantar came as a new lease of life to a dying democracy. The youth expressed relief at the opening of a democratic space after years of oppressive silence to which many had resigned. The increased freedom to speak, disagree, and criticise was palpable and contagious. The CJP provided a common platform for a diverse coalition of dissenters to coalesce, and express dissent in personalised, creative ways under one banner.

**Need to stand together**

This does not deny Rahul Gandhi's work on paper leaks, institutional capture and voter suppression. Yet, the Congress would be deceiving itself if it believed that – after the Bharat Jodo Yatra in 2022 – it has consistently prioritised calling a cross-section of ordinary citizens onto the streets under its banner and organising India's diverse dissenters into a popular coalition. The CJP, in doing that, has punctured the BJP's aura of invincibility, creating a juncture pregnant with opportunity for the Opposition. If the CJP is a plot to undercut Mr. Gandhi, it is currently achieving the opposite. That his decency, fearlessness and ideological commitment had had an impact is evidenced by several Gen Z youth expressing support for Mr. Gandhi during the CJP's July protest. His *Chhatron Ki Goonj* rallies have been boosted by the CJP's youth galvanisation.

But the obsessive attacks by some Congress supporters on the CJP threaten to squander this opportunity. The CJP is popular because it is perceived as prioritising people's interests. Mutual criticism is democratic, but smear campaigns will be read as reflecting the petty insecurity of Congresspersons, and as disregarding the agency and intelligence of dissenters to judge who inspires and represents them authentically. This threatens the goodwill Mr. Gandhi has earned by prioritising people's causes and platforming citizens galvanised by the CJP. While he has not smeared the CJP, such impressions may attach to Mr. Gandhi. The protestors' independence of mind make it clear that they will reject anyone suspected of placing personality cult or partyism over authentic concern for India's dissenting people. In his own interest and his party's, Mr. Gandhi must rein in his social media supporters.

Rahul Gandhi must accept the challenge of his youth support being undermined. No party is entitled to the support of India's dissenting citizens. It must be earned. If Congress claims to represent the youth, it must persuade them it does so best. The CJP resonates because it offers an open, accessible space that amplifies rather than dwarfs ordinary citizens' voices. Mr. Gandhi will similarly win goodwill by inspiring dissenting citizens and non-party opposition groups to treat Congress as an umbrella platform for expressing their dissent creatively.

The CJP is popular because it is perceived as prioritising people's interests. Mutual criticism is democratic, but smear campaigns will be read as reflecting the petty insecurity of Congresspersons

# Nobel lesson: value of stabilisation models



**Sushanta Kumar Mahapatra**

Associate Professor of Economics at the ICFAI School of Social Sciences, IFHE, Hyderabad

Economic fluctuations, in addition to being reflected in GDP numbers, inflation, and unemployment rates, impact household budgets, hiring decisions of companies, and the ability of families to save money. This year's Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel (2026), given to Robert E. Hall and Michael Woodford for "microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation", highlights an essential concept – successful economic policies require an understanding of how individual households and businesses make their economic choices.

**Importance of their work**

Governments have spent many years attempting to reduce the size of both the 'peaks' (highs) and 'troughs' (lows) that occur in the business cycle. In times of low economic activity (which is characterised by weak demand), central banks use their power to cut interest rates; in times of strong economic activity (characterised by strong demand), policy changes may need to be made to restrict further growth.

However, the oil crises of the 1970s demonstrated that there were weaknesses in the models that were being utilised at that time. It became clear that the relationships between inflation, unemployment, consumption, and production were far more variable than had previously been believed. During this period, inflation continued to rise with unemployment levels also rising. Additionally, growth rates were declining. Therefore, stimulating an economy at the wrong time could result in even greater problems.

Mr. Hall and Mr. Woodford advanced macroeconomic stabilisation through their focus on placing household and business decisions at the centre of economic studies.

Mr. Hall's research demonstrated how consumption patterns reflect people's expectations of future earnings. However, he acknowledged that many households are unable to smooth out their spending due to a lack of savings and credit. In India, then, policymakers should consider the variations among households with different levels of financial security (that is high-income vs. low-income), instead of making decisions based upon what is considered to be the "average" consumer.

John Maynard Keynes was the first to recognise the importance of stabilising an economy. Following a similar line, Mr. Woodford developed his ideas within a practical new Keynesian model which links consumer spending, inflation and the overall level of economic activity. It allows policymakers to analyse how changes in interest rates could impact the economy. An important part of the model is that prices are "sticky", which means that firms do not immediately change their prices when there is a change in demand or cost. Firms set prices based upon what they believe their future costs, demand and competitors' prices will be. Therefore, expectations set for the future can affect today's inflation.

Central banks' credibility and communication is important because a central bank's decision on interest rates does more than explain what its policy rate is today. Such announcements will affect people's expectations for future interest rates and inflation which will again ultimately influence their decisions today. Clear and consistent communications from central banks allow households and businesses to make plans.

On the other hand, unpredictable signals from central banks or announcements of policies that are not followed through with actions can reduce the effectiveness of monetary policy.

**Supply issues too**

The model warns that not all shocks should be viewed as being caused by demand. Disruptions to supply may also lead to higher prices, lower levels of output, and an increase in unemployment at the same time, which would need to be tackled with other available policy options than just adjusting interest rates. Stabilisation models for India must take into account what is happening within the country, as well as be backed up with a strong monetary policy, responsible fiscal management, access to reliable data and specific assistance provided to those who are the most at risk of losing their jobs.

In the end, the value of the Nobel prize is in encouraging disciplined policymaking that takes into consideration the context in which it operates, while protecting price stability, job security and people's livelihoods.

The reason why central banks' credibility and communication is important is because a central bank's decision on interest rates does more than explain what its policy rate is today

# Legal aid cuts jail time for undertrials, but help often arrives late

Reaching prisoners soon after arrest is key if free legal aid is to reduce the human and economic costs of pre-trial detention

DATA POINT

**Indulekha Guha**
**Trisha Chanda**

India jails fewer people than most countries – about 41 for every 1,00,000 people – yet more than three-quarters of its prisoners in 2022 were awaiting trial. That places India fourth in the world in the share of undertrials in its prison population. Many of them are poor, poorly educated, or from marginalised communities and remain in jail not because they have been convicted but because they cannot navigate the system or afford a lawyer.

Free legal aid is meant to close this gap. The Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987 created the National Legal Services Authority to provide free legal services to weaker sections of society. But three decades on, limited outreach, low awareness and uneven quality mean that many undertrials still go without timely help.

A legal aid programme run since 2018 across eight prisons in Maharashtra offers insights into what such help can achieve. Implemented by Prayas (Tata Institute of Social Sciences) and the Fair Trial Fellowship (National Law University, Delhi), and funded by the Azim Premji Foundation, it targets those least able to secure representation: casual workers, women abandoned by their families, minorities, or migrant workers.

By analysing the records of over 22,000 undertrials assisted between 2018 and 2023, it was found that the typical participant is 29 years old, and that close to half have studied only up to primary school. Further, 18% are women and 57% are casual wage workers. By comparing their outcomes with the district court records in Maharashtra and used national labour force and time use surveys, the costs of detention were estimated.

To begin with, programme participants obtain bail far more often than the average applicant. Across 29 districts, 84% of participants' bail applications succeeded, compared with 26% of all applications in the same district courts between 2015 and 2020. Participants did better in 28 of the 29 districts. The gap persists even within categories of offence severity, so it is not simply because the programme serves people accused of minor crimes. Within the programme, bail outcomes change sharply at intake. Before intake, the share of participants granted bail ranged from about 1% to 6% across groups by gender, income, education and occupation. After intake, it ranged from 61% to 92%.

Timing, however, matters a great deal. Participants spent on average 171 days – more than five months – in jail before they entered the programme. Those released on bail spent a further 115 days in custody on average, taking the total from arrest to release to about eight months. In 2018, about 37% of Maharashtra's 26,898 undertrials had been held for more than a year **(Table 1)**.

**The cost of detention**

Detention before trial is costly for people who mostly live on daily earnings. The wages participants lose in custody was estimated by matching them to similar workers in the Periodic Labour Force Survey and multiplying their daily wage by the number of days they were detained. The losses are large relative to their incomes. From arrest to release, average losses reach up to about ₹2 lakh for some age groups, while more than 60% of participants earn less than ₹80,000 a year. Losses rise with age and peak among workers in their 50s **(Chart 2)**.

Losses also vary by group. After intake alone, those facing the most serious charges lose about ₹80,000 on average, nearly four times the ₹21,000 lost by those accused of the least severe offences. This is driven mainly by longer detention rather than higher earnings. Graduates and regular wage workers also lose more, since their wages are higher **(Chart 3)**.

The uncomfortable question this raises is: why do so many undertrials wait months for help that is already their right? Legal aid is usually seen as a matter of rights. These findings suggest it is also an intervention with economic returns. By helping undertrials file bail applications, coordinate with advocates, gather documents and meet release conditions, the programme appears to cut through the procedural frictions that prolong detention.

Shorter detention can ease prison overcrowding, lower public spending on prisons, and limit income losses for vulnerable households. The most actionable lesson concerns timing. Legal aid can improve outcomes after intake, but it cannot recover the months already spent in jail. Identifying eligible prisoners at or soon after arrest could substantially raise its impact. Better data would also help. Caste, religion, income and migration status are missing for much of the sample, which limits what can be said about who benefits most.

Comparing participants with similar defendants in court records would allow a rigorous evaluation of the programme's effect, and tracking people after release would show whether the gains last. As governments seek to widen access to justice, legal aid works best when it reaches undertrial prisoners early enough to prevent unnecessary detention.

Note: Programme participants are not randomly selected, so the comparisons are descriptive rather than causal. Wage and time losses are accounting estimates of the value of time spent in custody: predicted daily wages from the PLFS 2017-18 multiplied by days detained. Since undertrials differ from the general population, they should be read as upper-bound estimates. Each period is averaged over participants with valid dates for that period.

## Cost of delayed justice

Data for the charts were sourced from authors' calculations using Azim Premji Foundation programme records and the Periodic Labour Force Survey 2017-18



**Table 1:** Time spent in custody by programme participants (in days)

| Period | Participants | Average | Maximum |
|---|---|---|---|
| Arrest to programme intake | 18,093 | 171 | 1,843 |
| Intake to release on bail | 8,987 | 115 | 1,122 |
| Arrest to release on bail | 8,921 | 239 | 2,039 |

*Durations after intake are for participants with a recorded release date*

**Chart 2:** Age-wise predicted wage loss of participants during their detention for the period between intake to release. After intake alone, those facing the most serious charges lose about ₹80,000 on average, nearly four times the ₹21,000 lost by those accused of the least severe offences.

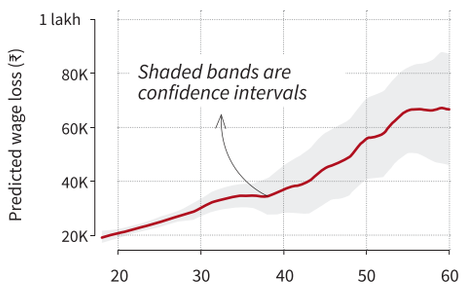
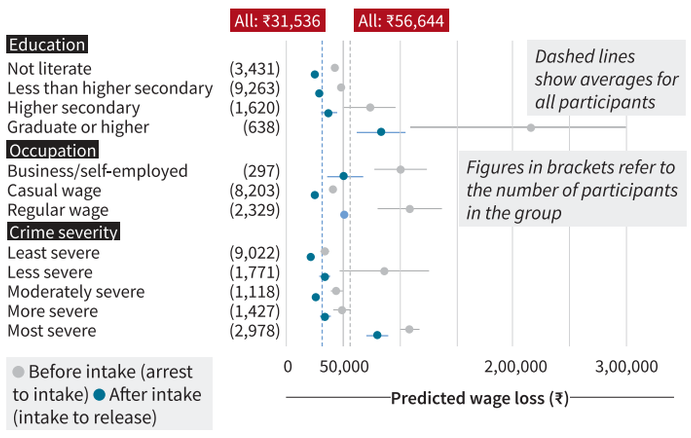



**Chart 3:** Predicted wage loss before and after programme intake by group. Each participant is counted once, by their most serious case. The chart excludes unemployed participants and those outside the labour force




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FROM THE ARCHIVES
The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 14, 1976

## Inadequate library services in Asia and Africa

Lusaka, October 13: The Pro Vice-Chancellor of the University of Zambia, Mr. Moses Musonda has underlined the need for greater efforts by developing countries in Asia and Africa to develop their information systems to get over the woefully inadequate situation in this field.

The state of libraries and information services in Africa – and indeed in developing countries – are appalling, he said, in a closing speech to the six-day standing conference of Eastern, Central and Southern African librarians here yesterday.

Equally frightening, he told the delegates, was the paucity of trained and qualified personnel to man these services which made the running of the libraries and information systems poorly co-ordinated. The main reason for this situation developing, Mr. Musonda said, could be attributed to the fact that some governments had not recognised the importance of these systems. Mr. Musonda said, another reason was that personnel training has not been encouraging since there were very few people who understood or appreciated the importance and implication of developing information systems for the benefit of developing countries.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 14, 1926

## Astronomical research and industrial development

The extensive use which is now being made of research facilities for testing materials destined for industrial use was recently illustrated in the sending of samples of rubber from England to Switzerland to be tested for moisture absorption.

This was undertaken by Dr. Kollieker, the Swiss Government astronomer, at the observatory situated over 11,000 feet above sea-level 2,000 feet or so beneath the crest of the Jung-frau mountain in the Bernese Oberland. Here weather conditions and atmospheric effects are studied, the station being fitted with a high-power telescope for astronomical research.

During the summer this is frequently used for sweeping the mountain side in search of belated travellers, thousands visiting the Jung-frau observatory to obtain the view which extends beyond the French Vosges mountains and to the Black Forest in Germany.

# Text&Context

THE HINDU

## NEWS IN NUMBERS

### Healthy life-years saved by limiting global warming

**1.89** billion years. Limiting global warming to around 1.8 degrees Celsius, instead of allowing it to reach 4.4 degrees Celsius, could prevent the loss of 1.89 billion years of healthy life to causes such as extreme heat and air pollution, according to new Lancet Commission. PTI

### Increase in power demand in T.N. due to El Niño heat

**30** in per cent. Rejecting the allegations of high-cost power purchases, Minister R. Nirmal Kumar defended the government's decision to call for short-term power tenders. He attributed the strain on the grid to a 30% spike in demand driven by El Niño-induced heat. PTI

### IMF's lowered forecast of China's economic growth this year

**4.5** in per cent. The International Monetary Fund (IMF) lowered its forecast for China's economic growth this year to 4.5% on Tuesday, as higher energy prices due to the West Asia conflict and a domestic spending slump weigh on activity. AFP

### The value of hydrocarbons Russia exported to Europe

**320** in $ billion. Russia said it has sold European countries over $320 billion worth of hydrocarbons since 2022. "For the period from 2022 to today, this figure amounts to $320.7 billion. This is the volume of energy resource deliveries to European Union countries," Russia said. AFP

### Farmers on third list for Maharashtra crop loan waiver

**3.51** in lakh. The Maharashtra government has released the third list of 3,51,192 farmers eligible for benefits under the Puneashlok Ahilyadevi Holkar Loan Waiver Scheme, State Cooperation Minister Babasaheb Patil said. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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# What is preventive detention?

What does the law permit, and where must the State draw the line? What safeguards does the Constitution provide against arbitrary detention? How has preventive detention evolved in India? What is the difference between preventive detention and prohibitory orders?

EXPLAINER

Rizmi Lia M.

**The story so far:**

The Delhi Police detained more than 5,000 protesters as they tried to reach Jantar Mantar for the protest demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and a rollback of the SIR. In the lead-up to the protests in Delhi, there was a nationwide crackdown on protesters by the police force. Among those detained and brutally manhandled by the Delhi police were leaders of various political factions, former Chief Ministers, the Leader of the Opposition, lawyers, journalists, students, activists, and reportedly people who were not even part of the protest. Police detained people at representatives' residences even before the protest started, and en route to the protest site. However, the Supreme Court on October 11 directed the Centre and the Delhi Police to ensure free movement of people 'subject to law and order'.

This prompts an understanding of what preventive detention is, how it can be imposed, and how it came into practice.



AISA's Neha Bora during a protest march at Connaught Place in New Delhi. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

**What is preventive detention?**

'Preventive detention' means detention of a person without a trial or conviction by a court. The primary objective of preventive detention is not to punish an individual for a past offence but to prevent him from committing an offence in the future.

Power of preventive detention can be exercised by the authorities on the grounds of public order, security of the State, and law and order.

The National Security Act, 1980 (NSA) allows for preventive detention if the government is satisfied that a person's activities are prejudicial to the defence of India, the relations of India with foreign powers, or the security of the State.

**What is a prohibitory order under the BNSS?**

Section 163 of the BNSS largely retains the spirit of its predecessor, Section 144 of the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973. It empowers a District Magistrate, a Sub-Divisional Magistrate, or any other Executive Magistrate specially empowered by the State Government, to issue orders when there is sufficient ground for proceeding and immediate prevention or speedy remedy is desirable. The primary objective is to prevent obstruction, annoyance, or injury to any person lawfully employed, or danger to human life, health, or safety, or a disturbance of the public tranquillity, or a riot, or an affray.

The provision is preventive in nature, designed to avert potential harm rather than to punish past acts. The Magistrate must be satisfied that there is an urgency that necessitates an immediate order, even without prior notice to the affected parties.

The power is extraordinary and is intended for situations where the normal course of law enforcement might be too slow to prevent immediate harm. The order must clearly state the material facts upon which it is based, ensuring transparency and providing grounds for potential challenge.

Furthermore, orders under Section 163 BNSS are subject to judicial review by the High Courts under their revisional jurisdiction. The Supreme Court, in cases like *Babulal Parate v. State of Maharashtra* (1961) and *Madhu Limaye v. Sub-Divisional Magistrate* (1971), has consistently emphasised that these powers must be exercised judiciously, proportionately, and only when there is an imminent threat to public order, and not as a routine measure.

**How has preventive detention evolved?**

Preventive detention in India has evolved from a colonial tool used to suppress political dissent into a legal mechanism intended to protect national security and public order. During British rule, laws such as the Rowlatt Act, 1919, and the Defence of India Act, 1939, allowed the authorities to detain individuals without trial, often targeting freedom fighters and political opponents.

After Independence, India retained preventive detention, introducing the Preventive Detention Act, 1950, which remained in force until 1969. The Maintenance of Internal Security Act (MISA), 1971, further expanded detention powers and was widely used against political opponents during the Emergency (1975-1977). It was repealed in 1978.

The National Security Act (NSA), 1980, subsequently established a continuing legal framework for preventive detention. Other laws, including the Conservation of Foreign Exchange and Prevention of Smuggling Activities Act (COFEPOSA), 1974, also authorised preventive detention for specific purposes.

Meanwhile, amendments to the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA), 1967, expanded the state's powers to address terrorism and unlawful activities.

Over time, the Supreme Court's interpretation of personal liberty has also evolved. *Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India* (1978) established that procedures restricting personal liberty must be just, fair and reasonable. However, concerns over prolonged detention without trial, inadequate judicial oversight and the potential misuse of these laws continue to raise questions about the balance between national security and fundamental rights.

**What did the Supreme Court order on October 11?**

With respect to the Delhi protests, the Supreme Court convened what it called an "extraordinary, exceptional" Sunday (October 11, 2026) hearing to direct the Union government and the Delhi Police to stop illegal detentions and allow free and smooth movement of people and traffic, as well as the operations of Metro and rail services, but "subject to law and public order".

The Supreme Court directed that Delhi Metro and railway services operate normally, and that internet services remain available in accordance with the law. It said the movement of people and vehicles across Delhi must not be unnecessarily obstructed and that barricades must be reviewed based on law-and-order and traffic requirements. The court said there must be no unlawful detention and that all detentions must follow the procedure established by law. It also directed that peaceful assemblies be allowed in accordance with the law, except in areas where prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) are in force. Any notice board announcing Section 163 restrictions near the Supreme Court must be removed, if still in place, to ensure access to the Supreme Court and other courts. The court also recorded the assurance that lawyers, journalists and other professionals would not be prevented from performing their duties.

The court issued notice in contempt proceedings alleging violation of its October 9 order and directed the authorities to submit a compliance report by October 13, including details of Metro restrictions and railway advisories. Habeas corpus petitions alleging mass detentions will also be heard with the main cases on October 13. The court said the State must explain the circumstances, manner and legal justification for the alleged detentions, emphasising its duty under Article 32 of the Constitution to protect and enforce fundamental rights.

**What have the courts said about preventive detention?**

Earlier, in *Babulal Parate v. State of Maharashtra* (1961), the Supreme Court upheld the constitutional validity of Section 144 CrPC but said it could be used only in emergencies to prevent specific threats to public order. The court held that the power was not "unlimited or untrammelled" and had to be exercised within the limits set by law.

In *Khudiram Das v. State of West Bengal* (1975) Supreme Court observed that the requirement of communication of grounds of detention acts as a check against arbitrary and capricious exercise of power. The detaining authority cannot whisk away a person and put him behind bars at its own sweet will. It must have grounds for doing so and those grounds must be communicated to the detenu, so that, not only the detenu may know what are the facts and materials before the detaining authority on the basis of which he is being deprived of his personal liberty, but he can also invoke the power of judicial review, howsoever limited and peripheral it may be. The detenu has to be afforded an opportunity of making a representation against the order of detention.

In 2012, the Supreme Court criticised the government for imposing Section 144 against a sleeping crowd at Ramlila Maidan in New Delhi during protests against the Congress-led UPA government. "Such a provision can be used only in grave circumstances for maintenance of public peace. The efficacy of the provision is to prevent some harmful occurrence immediately. Therefore, the emergency must be sudden and the consequences sufficiently grave," the court said.

In *Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan v. Union of India* (2018), the Supreme Court set aside a National Green Tribunal order banning all protests along Jantar Mantar Road. The court said a complete ban was excessive, observing that the "solution was not to ban the demonstrations altogether". It directed the authorities to create a system to regulate protests and grant permissions.

The Supreme Court in the case of *Shaik Naznen v. State of Telangana* (2022) observed that powers to be exercised under the preventive detention laws are exceptional powers which have been given to the Government for its exercise in an exceptional situation as it strikes hard on the freedom and liberty of an individual, and thus cannot be exercised in a routine manner.

According to *Ameena Begum v. State of Telangana* (2023), Supreme Court observed that to unchain the shackles of preventive detention, it is important that the safeguards enshrined in our Constitution, particularly under the "golden triangle" formed by Articles 14, 19 and 21, are diligently enforced.

Article 14 ensures equality before the law, Article 19 provides important freedoms such as freedom of speech, expression, assembly, and movement, and Article 21 guarantees the right to life and personal liberty.

**What are the safeguards against preventive detention in the Constitution?**

Article 22 of the Constitution provides safeguards against arbitrary preventive detention. Under Article 22(4), a person generally cannot be detained for more than three months without an Advisory Board reviewing the case, subject to the constitutional requirements and exceptions. Under Article 22(5), the authorities must communicate the grounds of detention to the detainee as soon as possible and give them an opportunity to make a representation against the order. The grounds must be communicated in a manner that allows the detainee to effectively challenge the detention.

Preventive detention orders are also subject to judicial review. Courts can examine whether the authorities followed the law, considered relevant material and complied with constitutional safeguards. Therefore, the power must be exercised carefully and cannot be used arbitrarily.

## THE GIST

- Preventive detention allows authorities to detain a person to prevent anticipated threats to public order or security, but it must be distinguished from prohibitory orders and other police action against protesters
- Article 22 of the Constitution provides safeguards for detained persons, while laws such as the National Security Act set out the grounds and procedures for detention
- Courts can review state action to protect individual liberty, emphasising that restrictions on protest and preventive detention must remain within legal and constitutional limits

CACHE




Elon Musk claimed that Starlink has not been licensed in India, in spite of spending five years complying with the government laws and requirements. REUTERS

# Why is Musk taking on Mukesh Ambani over Starlink in India?

Elon Musk has accused Mukesh Ambani of using his influence to keep Starlink out of India to protect Jio's market dominance, even as Starlink awaits security clearances to begin operations; the spat comes as Jio prepares for an IPO, raising questions about competition and regulatory hurdles

Sahana Venugopal

**The story so far:**

SpaceX owner Elon Musk has never shied away from starting a social media spat, be it with his own family members or U.S. President Donald Trump.

Mr. Musk has now taken aim at India's billionaire Mukesh Ambani, accusing the chairman and managing director of Reliance Industries of being the real "boss" of India and playing a role in keeping Starlink's satellite internet out of the Indian market to favour Jio.

**What has Mr. Musk said about Mr. Ambani?**

On October 9, Mr. Musk posted on X a mockingly subservient tweet addressed to "Prime Minister Ambani," apologising for "not realizing that you are the real boss of India," and accused him of wanting to maintain his "monopolistic exploitation of the great people of India," before asking him for permission to allow Starlink to compete in the market. Mr. Musk claimed that Starlink would help close Internet connectivity gaps across the country and could help save lives during natural disasters.

Critics of Mr. Musk were infuriated by what they felt was the undermining of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, as well as the accusation that India's government is under Mr. Ambani's influence. Others flagged that the price of Starlink's service, both hardware and subscriptions, was



Elon Musk. REUTERS

many times more than the services offered by India-based Internet service providers.

On October 11, Mr. Musk posted that competition would benefit Indian customers by giving them more choices and that prices would be adjusted accordingly.

"Ambani's profits will be lower, but he is not going out of business. And, obviously, if Starlink is too expensive in India, no one will buy it, so SpaceX will need to make pricing affordable," stated Mr. Musk.

**What is the status of Starlink's licence in India?**

Mr. Musk claimed that Starlink has not been licensed in India, in spite of spending five years complying with the government laws and requirements.

In March 2025, SpaceX announced that it had partnered with Jio Platforms to offer Starlink broadband Internet service to customers in India, subject to SpaceX receiving separate authorisations to offer Starlink in India. (A similar agreement was also signed with Bharti Airtel.)

Under the 2025 agreement, the two companies were set to explore service collaborations so Jio Platforms would make Starlink solutions available through its own retail channels.

It is unclear whether that agreement will hold after Mr. Musk's gibe against Mr. Ambani and the Indian government.

Apart from the deals between the two companies, SpaceX has a Global Mobile Personal Communications by Satellite (GMPCS) authorisation from the Department of Telecommunications (DoT), *The Hindu* reported this month, but security clearances are pending.

Similarly, ANI reported that licensing was complete for Starlink, Reliance Jio Satcom, and Eutelsat OneWeb, while security checks are in progress.

**Why is the timing of this clash significant?**

The timing is crucial as Jio Platforms is preparing for an initial public offering (IPO), which is expected to take place later this month, per media reports; a company at this stage likely prefers a stable regulatory environment and positive media coverage.

A world-famous billionaire attacking an IPO-bound company by accusing it of undermining India's market sovereignty could make the situation tenuous. Mr. Musk's intimacy with the White House could potentially escalate the online spat.

Mr. Trump has in the past threatened penalties when other countries – such as Australia and the U.K. – slowed the foreign operations of U.S. tech giants.

Another factor to consider is the ongoing protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over allegations of irregularities in the electoral rolls vetting process. Delhi residents have been affected by one of the largest Internet shutdowns in the capital's history.

By contrast, Starlink has been used to access the Internet during times of war and civil unrest, such as (legally) during Ukraine's defence against Russian invasion and Iran's anti-government protests (illegally). For the Indian government, ensuring that all telecom companies comply with its Internet blackouts is a serious priority.

Mr. Musk has stressed that Starlink beams are turned off over India, and that illegal use is not possible.

For the time being, the Starlink app remains available for download in the country, advertising a starting price of $55 per month for 100Mbps and unlimited data.

Meanwhile, the Indian government denied that it allowed monopolies to form in any sector.

THE DAILY QUIZ

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

## A quiz on the much-loved bear and his world on the centenary of the publication of the evergreen children's classic 'Winnie-the-Pooh'

V.V. Ramanan

**QUESTION 1**
It is well-known that the name Winnie was derived from Winnipeg, the name A.A. Milne's son gave to his teddy bear. Where does Pooh come from?

**QUESTION 2**
The Winnie-the-Pooh stories are set in Hundred Acre Wood, also referred to as 100 Aker Wood. Name the beautiful landscape that inspired this setting of his beloved stories.

**QUESTION 3**
In the original stories, what name is painted in gold letters over the door of Winnie-the-Pooh's house?

**QUESTION 4**
Where can one now see the original stuffed animals that inspired Milne's stories, and which character was added by Queen Camilla in 2026 to complete the set?

**QUESTION 5**
Name the nook close to Pooh's best friend Piglet's home where the two consider the day's possibilities.

**QUESTION 6**
Name the other two books featuring the lovable bear and his friends, and which hyperactive character debuted in the final work.

**QUESTION 7**
What is the contribution of Ernest Howard Shepard to the success and legacy of the Winnie-the-Pooh series of books?

**QUESTION 8**
Who played the role of an adult Christopher Robin in the eponymous 2018 film in which he is reunited with Winnie-the-Pooh?



**Visual Question:**
What is the setting for this illustration from one of the original works? AFP

**Questions and Answers to the previous day's daily quiz:** 1. Considered the oldest Indian club in existence, this team made history in 1911, becoming the first Indian club to win the IFA Shield. Name the club and the nickname given to the winning squad. **Ans: Mohun Bagan, 'Immortal Eleven'**
2. Name the first club from South India and the State in which it was set up. **Ans: RB Ferguson FC, Keralam**
3. The Durand Cup was won by a domestic club for the first time in 1940. Name the club that beat the Royal Warwickshire Regiment 2-1 to end the British monopoly. **Ans: Mohammedan Sporting**
4. This club was named the best in India by the English FA in 1951 after it won the IFA Shield three times in a row. Name the club. **Ans: East Bengal**
5. Name the team of under-15s who defeated its corresponding squad of European powerhouse Liverpool 6-0 this year. **Ans: Minerva Academy**
Visual: Name the club, which recently went through a management crisis, and the UAE-based group that acquired its ownership last month. **Ans: Kerala Blasters, Al Fursan Group**
**Early Birds:** K.N. Viswanathan | Arun Kumar Singh | Tamal Biswas | Erfanally Oosmany | Sudhir Thapa



FROM THE ARCHIVES

## *Know your English*

S. Upendran

**Is it ok to say, "hook, line, and bait"? (Dr. S. Jayaraman, Chennai)**
The correct expression is "fall for something hook, line, and sinker". The word "fall" here means "to believe". So when you fall for a story "hook, line, and sinker", you believe the story completely, although it sounds pretty far-fetched. The expression means the same thing as "lock, stock, and barrel". When you say that someone fell for something hook, line and sinker, you are passing a judgment on the individual. You are indirectly saying that he/she is pretty gullible; he/she is willing to believe anything somebody tells him/her. One can also say "swallow/buy something hook, line, and sinker".

*Shyam expected his students to swallow his explanation hook, line, and sinker.*

Another common expression is, "fall hook, line, and sinker in love with someone/something".

This is an expression that comes from the sport of fishing. I understand that sometimes a fish not only swallows the hook to which the bait is attached, but also some of the "line". The sinker is the weight that is used to take the fishing line to the bottom. It is, however, very uncommon for a fish to swallow the "sinker". So, if someone swallows your story hook, line and sinker, he/she believes your tall tale.

**What is the difference between "cost" and "price"? (Usha Karthikeyan, T.N.)**
Most people tend to use these words interchangeably when they want to mean the amount of money required to buy something. For example, we can say, "What is the price of the car?" or "How much does the car cost"? In business, however, the two words have a different meaning. When you talk about the "cost" of something, what you are referring to is the amount of money that you spent to make that particular thing. For example, when businessmen talk about the cost of a car, they are referring to the amount they spent manufacturing it. "Price", on the other hand, refers to the amount of money that the car is sold for. It is the amount that the customer pays. A toy may cost Rs. 200 to manufacture, but it may be priced at Rs. 500.

The word "cost", unlike the word "price", is normally used with services. For example, one talks about the cost of getting one's car repaired, and the cost of going on holiday. "Cost" is also used with abstractions; one talks about the "cost of living", the "cost of war", etc. When you wish to use an adjective, then it is "price" that is used. For example, you talk about "exorbitant" prices, "great prices", and "bargain prices". As everyone knows, every politician has his/her price. Yes, the word price is normally used when you wish to bribe someone. You can tell the individual to name his/her price.

**Is it ok to say, "All classes are suspended in the aftermath of the All India elocution competition"? (V. S. Uday, Sringeri)**
The word "aftermath" was first used to refer to the second crop; that is, the crop that grew after the first crop was cut. These days the word is figuratively used to refer to the period that follows an event. But what is important to remember is that the preceding event is usually associated with something terrible - an earthquake, an explosion, a war, etc.
*Published in The Hindu on April 2, 2002*

## Word of the day

**Dilettante:**
an amateur who engages in an activity without serious intentions and who pretends to have knowledge

**Synonyms:** inexperienced, unskilled, unprofessional, inexpert

**Usage:** *He is a dilettante who paints for fun.*

**Pronunciation:** newsth.live/dilettante

**International Phonetic Alphabet:** /dɪlɪtænti/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'

From Page One

## Resistance to go on, says Rahul after hosting allies

Sources said it was decided at the meeting that though there may be breaks in large-scale protest actions because of the Navratri and Durga Puja festivities, the agitation will continue, with Delhi remaining the main focus. Parties belonging to the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) will coordinate every day among each other for joint action.

Opposition leaders from 16 parties attended, including M.A. Baby (CPI-M), D. Raja and P. Sandosh Kumar (CPI), Tejashwi Yadav and Manoj Jha (RJD), Mahua Maji (JMM), Harender Malik, Anand Bhadauria, and Mohibullah Nadvi (SP), Sanjay Raut (Shiv Sena-UBT), Sagarika Ghose and Mahua Moitra (Mamata Trinamool Congress), G. Deverajan (Forward Bloc), and Dipankar Bhattacharya (CPI-ML)L. AISA chief Neha Bora and advocate Prashant Bhushan also attended the tea party at Mr. Gandhi's No. 5 Sunehri Bagh Road residence. Top Congress leaders, including party chief Mallikarjun Kharge, Sonia Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and K.C. Venugopal, were also present.

Mr. Gandhi said that people who "destroy India's Constitution and the election system" could not be allowed to get away with it, vowing that action will be taken against those who have indulged in alleged "vote *chori* (theft)".

"It is our commitment that the people who have done this – [Prime Minister Narendra] Modi, who is the main architect, [Union Home Minister] Amit Shah, who is implementer, [CEC] Gyanesh Kumar and others – they need to understand that the net is closing around them... We assure you that all would be brought to justice," he asserted.

**'Will fight to regain Jantar Mantar'**

Several leaders objected to the government denotifying the designated protest site at Jantar Mantar and vowed to reclaim it. "Earlier, they [BJP] were indulging in vote *chori* but now they are resorting to protest site *chori*," said Mr. Baby. Mr. Raja also strongly condemned the decision to denotify Jantar Mantar, saying, "We will fight to regain it."

Mr. Raut said the government had kept the country in "fear and intimidation, but now it's their turn to be afraid". The Sena (UBT) leader added, "Gyanesh Kumar is a mafia, he is such a mafia who has criminalised the [electoral] system. We know how to fight and deal with such mafias."

## 13 children killed in Bihar boat capsize

Prime Minister Narendra Modi expressed pain over the incident and announced ex gratia of ₹2 lakh each to the families of the deceased and ₹50,000 to those injured.

"The loss of lives in the boat capsizing in Vaishali is deeply painful. My thoughts are with the bereaved families," the Prime Minister said on X.

Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary also expressed grief and announced ₹4 lakh ex gratia for each of the deceased's families. "The news of the lives lost in the boat accident in Raghopur is extremely heartbreaking and soul-wrenching," Mr. Choudhary wrote. "...Instructions have been given to the administration to swiftly complete relief and rescue operations and ensure better treatment for the injured," he further wrote.

Raghopur MLA and Leader of Opposition in the Legislative Assembly, Tejashwi Yadav, expressed his condolences in a video message posted on X.

# SC gives Centre more time to reply to pleas against detentions, transport shutdown

Bench headed by CJI Surya Kant allows govt. to file reply affidavit on Thursday; Solicitor-General says the affidavit is ready but needs fine-tuning; top court also agrees to urgently hear petitions for probe and contempt proceedings against police action on journalists covering anti-CEC-SIR protests

**Krishnadas Rajagopal**
NEW DELHI

The Union government informed the Supreme Court on Tuesday that its response to petitions alleging illegal detentions, shutdown of public and rail transport, including Metro service, in Delhi on October 10 is "ready" but needs more fine-tuning.

A three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant extended the time for the government to file the reply affidavit till Thursday. Multiple petitions, including ones seeking contempt proceedings, were adjourned to October 15 as one of the judges on the Bench was unwell.

Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta, for the Centre, said he had gone through the prepared affidavit. It was final, but he wanted to make it "more comprehensive". On the petitioners' request, the court asked him to share the affidavit, if possible, by October 14, a day before the hearing so that the lawyers of the petitioners were suitably well-versed with the contents of the affidavit and the hearing would be a meaningful one.

The court also agreed to urgently hear fresh petitions seeking independent probe and contempt proceedings against authorities on the continued police action against journalists, especially women media professionals, covering the anti-CEC/SIR protests despite an apex court order against it on October 11.

Chief Justice Kant asked the petitioners to cure defects, after which the pleas would also be put up for a comprehensive hearing on Thursday.



**Police action:** A protester being detained during the anti-CEC demonstration in New Delhi on Saturday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

The court asked for a senior police officer to be present during the next hearing, when allegations of assault on women are raised in the courtroom.

Members of the Supreme Court Bar Association and Supreme Court Advocates-on-Record Association, of which petitions were adjourned on Tuesday, gathered at the Supreme Court lawns to express solidarity with the advocates who were assaulted and detained by the police during the October 10 and 11 protests.

A separate petition was orally mentioned by senior advocate Gaurav Bhatia about the "sad" incident which happened in the Supreme Court on Monday.

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and other Opposition leaders had come to the Supreme Court Registry after filing a petition seeking a probe into SIR and allegations of arbitrary functioning and misconduct against CEC Gyanesh Kumar.

Mr. Gandhi's arrival had drawn a crowd of lawyers within the court premises, and the participants of his 'March for Democracy' converged in large numbers at the outer gates of the court.

Mr. Bhatia said a plea by advocate Divyansh Bisht has sought initiation of criminal contempt against Mr. Gandhi and other Opposition leaders for obstructing justice, a ban on political demonstrations inside court premises, a "neutral framework" to regulate protests near courts, and safeguards against political interference in *sub judice* cases.

The court also saw the urgent mentioning of petitions by organisations of media professionals, including Free Speech Collective and Network of Women in Media, India, which said the violence visited upon journalists were "not merely isolated obstruction, but an asserted course of police action comprising unlawful detention, forcible removal, physical assault, manhandling, intimidation, disregard of press credentials and the calculated exclusion and removal of journalists from places where public power was being exercised".

Senior advocate Nitya Ramakrishnan said "documentary proof of students being abused in police stations" have been placed on record before the top court and should be taken up for hearing on Thursday.

# Shah slams SIR protests, tells Rahul to be ready for defeat in 2029 polls

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

The Congress will suffer its fourth consecutive defeat, while the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) will return to power with an overwhelming majority in the 2029 Lok Sabha elections, Union Home Minister Amit Shah said on Tuesday, following the Bharatiya Janata Party's (BJP) victory in Gujarat's local body elections.

"The trust of the people cannot be earned through manufactured media events and the echo of falsehoods. Gathering 8,000 people within a 1.5-km area by bringing together cadres from 14 parties cannot be described as voice of the nation," he said.

The Congress, he said, should recognise that the voice of the nation also resonated in farms, villages, remote hills, forests and



Amit Shah

along riverbanks, where the principal Opposition had "little or no reach". He cited Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Tamil Nadu as States where, according to him, voters had repeatedly rejected the Congress over several decades.

**'Negative politics'**

The Home Minister questioned Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi's allegations concerning the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process, asking whether the BJP's victory in Gujarat was also attributable to the SIR.

"Ever since Rahul Gandhi became the principal leader of the Congress, then its president, and now the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, the Congress has continued to lose elections. He needs to introspect," Mr. Shah said.

The Home Minister said the Congress's continued pursuit of "negative politics" would not benefit the party and urged Mr. Gandhi to understand public sentiment and establish direct contact with voters.

He also accused the Congress of attempting to protect illegal infiltrators on the pretext of opposing the SIR, saying people understood what he described as the party's "strategy" and would no longer be misled by it.

"The BJP's resounding victory in the local body elections in Gujarat and the recently concluded by-elections and local elections in other States has once again proven that the people have completely rejected the lies of Rahul Gandhi and the INDIA bloc," Mr. Shah said.

In the elections to three municipalities and municipal corporations in Gujarat, the BJP won 90 of the 104 seats. In the Gandhinagar corporation, which falls under Mr. Shah's constituency, the party secured 38 of the 44 seats.

Responding to Mr. Shah's statement, Congress communications chief Jairam Ramesh said, "The co-architect of 'vote *chori*' has, not surprisingly, 'predicted' the 2029 Lok Sabha election for which undoubtedly he has already begun the rigging process. But it is not going to happen."

# Congress is living in denial over election defeats: BJP, JD(U)

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and its ally, the Janata Dal-United (JD-U), on Tuesday accused the Congress of undermining constitutional institutions and creating disorder in an attempt to regain power. The BJP and JD(U) alleged the principal Opposition questioned the Election Commission of India (ECI)'s credibility after electoral defeats but accepted the process whenever it won.



Piyush Goyal

In a joint press conference at the BJP headquarters, Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh of the JD(U) shared the platform with senior BJP leader and Union Minister Piyush Goyal. Both the Ministers condemned the alleged mistreatment of a pregnant journalist covering the Congress-led protest on Monday.

Mr. Goyal said if the Congress genuinely doubted the impartiality of the ECI and the integrity of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process, the six Chief Ministers of States where the party was in power or part of the ruling coalition should resign. He referred to Karnataka, Telangana, Himachal Pradesh, and Keralam, besides Jharkhand and Tamil Nadu.

**'Double standards'**

Accusing the Congress of double standards, Mr. Goyal said the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, and his party had a "delulu is the solulu" ("delusion is the solution") mindset, suggesting that they were living in denial over electoral setbacks.

Mr. Goyal asked Mr. Gandhi why he had repeatedly been alleging "vote theft" without submitting an affidavit or evidence; and why the Congress opposed the SIR when some of its own leaders had demanded electoral roll purification and even acknowledged its benefits.

The Congress and Mr. Gandhi were questioning the impartiality of the ECI, Mr. Goyal said, but had forgotten their own track record of allegedly rewarding former election officials with political appointments. The Modi government, in contrast, introduced a law in 2023 providing for a selection panel, which includes the Leader of the Opposition, to decide on the appointment of Election Commissioners, he said.

"I don't think Rahul Gandhi, the Congress party, or the Aam Aadmi Party, by sending its B-team [an apparent reference to the Cockroach Janta Party], can undermine Indian democracy," Mr. Goyal said, claiming the protests had drawn a limited number of participants.

Alleging Mr. Gandhi wanted "institutions that remain loyal to him", the JD(U) Minister cited two instances of former judges during the Congress regime. He alleged the Congress was now trying to discredit institutions and pressure them through protests.

## Top court registers Rahul's plea on SIR, CEC

**Krishnadas Rajagopal**
NEW DELHI

A petition filed by Opposition leaders led by Rahul Gandhi in the Supreme Court for a complete disclosure of records and decisions of the Election Commission of India (ECI) on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) and an independent probe into allegations of unilateral exercise of power by Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, which led to voter deletions and modifications, was successfully registered on Tuesday for judicial hearing.

The Supreme Court Registry cleared and numbered the petition within 24 hours of its filing on Monday. The petition was filed on Monday evening by Mr. Gandhi's legal team even as the Congress leader led a march to the Supreme Court.

Leaders across the Opposition political spectrum had walked to the court to mark their presence as petitioners in the case.

## Use of Form 6 to re-enlist voters is an anomaly, says plea

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

**'It requires people to state that they are applying to be voters for the first time, even for re-inclusion'**

A petition has been filed in the Supreme Court over a "fundamental anomaly" in requiring people whose names were deleted from electoral rolls during the special intensive revision to fill Form 6 if they want re-inclusion in voters' list.

The form, the petition pointed out, requires every applicant to affirm they are applying for inclusion in the rolls for the first time.

During the enumeration phase of the SIR in Delhi, 47,56,722 electors were excluded from the draft roll under the 'absent, shifted, dead or duplicate entry' (ASDD) category. For them, the only mechanism to have their name restored is through Form 6.

The plea says this creates a fundamental anomaly as they were earlier enrolled, but are now required to submit Form 6 and declare they are seeking inclusion in the electoral roll for the first time, which is factually incorrect and wholly inapplicable to their circumstances.

Further, such persons also become liable to face a fine or even imprisonment for giving a false declaration under Section 31 of the Representation of the People Act (RPA), 1950.

It also points out that an additional declaration that maps a voter's links with the previous SIR rolls, and which is required to be submitted along with the form, is without the force of law and should be struck down.

The petition was filed by transparency activists Anjali Bhardwaj and Amrita Johri, who also have another petition challenging the procedures on discrepancies in the Delhi SIR, pending before the court.

# India and Canada together contributing to prosperous, stable world: Modi to Carney

**Suhasini Haidar**
NEW DELHI

India and Canada are together contributing to a "more stable and prosperous world", said Prime Minister Narendra Modi after a call with Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney, during which they agreed to conclude a trade agreement soon.

The phone call on Tuesday night came even as senior Canadian Ministers, including Foreign Minister Anita Anand and Minister of International Trade Maninder Sidhu, are in Delhi for talks with their counterparts – External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar and Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal – and to firm up plans for Mr. Modi's visit to Ottawa in December.

Last week, National Security Advisor Ajit Doval also hosted Canadian Senior Diplomatic and International Affairs Advisor David Morrison, during which the two sides discussed cooperation on "security and law enforcement", without mentioning the Nijjar killing case that had led to the suspension of relations between the two nations from 2023 to 2025.



Narendra Modi and Mark Carney shake hands during the 2025 G20 Summit. FILE PHOTO

On Wednesday morning, Ms. Anand and Mr. Jaishankar will be part of a panel discussion to discuss the "Middle Power Moment", along with former British Prime Minister Rishi Sunak and former Australian Prime Minister Kevin Rudd.

**'Warm talks'**

Mr. Modi said his conversation with Mr. Carney had been "warm and productive". "We agreed to build on the positive momentum in India-Canada ties and work towards concrete outcomes across key areas of our Strategic Partnership, including trade, energy, technology, security and people-to-people ties," Mr. Modi said in a post on social media.

The Canadian Prime Minister's office put out a more detailed readout of the conversation, adding that the two leaders had discussed defence and security as well as reaffirmed their commitment to conclude negotiations on the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) at the "earliest opportunity," and to double two-way trade, at about $23 billion in 2025, by 2030.

According to officials, the two sides are expected to announce the trade agreement in mid-December, when Mr. Modi will travel to Canada for his first bilateral visit in more than a decade.

**APPEAL**



Sastidharan is one year old baby suffering from "B - cell Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia". He needs Chemotherapy at Meenakshi Mission Hospital & Research centre, Madurai. The total expenditure is Rs.7,00,000/-. His father is a farmer on daily wages. The family is very poor and cannot afford this huge cost. Please support him for the treatment. Donations sent by Ch/D.D. favouring **Meenakshi Mission Hospital & Research Centre, Madurai will be acknowledged.** The donations sent through Ch/D.D/NEFT Transfer & GOOGLE PAY (Canara Bank, Nungambakkam Branch, **A/C.No:60182010063310**, IFSC No: CNRB0016018) favouring **WOMEN'S WELFARE SYNDICATE** is exempted under 80G IT. Your **mail id** is requested.

All correspondence is done through **WWS**, Regd. Public Charitable Trust, Flat No. GF 1, Corddel Apartments, O.No.13 N.No.29, Pycrofts Garden Lane, Chennai - 600006. Ph: 044-42137401/31523781/7338978027.

**Email ID: womenswelfaresyndicate@gmail.com.**
**Website: www.womenswelfaresyndicate.org**

**WWS**

# Muslims disproportionately flagged in Delhi SIR

**Muslims, who form 13.6% of electors on Delhi's draft roll amid the SIR process, made up 20.3% of those flagged for 'logical discrepancies' and 30% of those flagged under five reasons indicative of family size by the Election Commission's ERONET software; in Bihar, which didn't have 'logical discrepancy' checks, Muslims accounted for 18.4% of deleted electors, in line with their 17.7% share in population**

**Pon Vasanth B.A.**
**Srinivasan Ramani**
CHENNAI

An analysis of Delhi's draft electoral rolls released as part of the special intensive revision (SIR) process showed that the software-driven "logical discrepancies" check is flagging a disproportionately higher number of Muslims.

Muslims, who form 13.6% of electors on Delhi's draft roll, made up 20.3% of those flagged for "logical discrepancies", and 30% of those flagged under five reasons indicative of family size. Who got flagged was decided not by the Electoral Registration Officers (EROs), the statutory custodians of the rolls, but by the Election Commission of India's (ECI's) centralised ERONET software.

### Delhi's draft roll

*The Hindu* digitised Delhi's draft SIR rolls, which had 97.54 lakh voters, of whom 33.12 lakh were flagged for notices by the ECI, to study patterns. The latter set included two distinct sets of electors: 13.79 lakh flagged for being "Unmapped with Last SIR" and another 19.33 lakh for "logical discrepancies" based on eight reasons.

Our analysis shows that Muslims accounted for 13.6%, or roughly 13.3 lakh, of the 97.54 lakh electors (refer to the box for methodology). This is not much higher than the 12.9% representation of Muslims in the 2011 Census.

Among the 13.79 lakh who were "Unmapped with Last SIR," members of the community accounted for only 7.6%, which meant that higher proportion of Muslims than non-Muslims were able to map themselves with the last SIR.

But among the umbrella category of "logical discrepancies" featuring 19.33 lakh electors, Muslims accounted for 20.3%, which is 12.8 percentage points higher than their share among unmapped electors and 6.7 percentage points higher than their share among total electors in the draft roll.

To put it another way, for every 1,000 Muslim electors in the draft roll, 318 were flagged for "logical discrepancies", while the corresponding figure for the rest of the non-Muslim electors was 197 per 1,000. This means that Muslims were 60% more likely to be marked for "logical discrepancies" than non-Muslims.

Interestingly, a similar data analysis for Bihar's draft rolls showed that Muslims accounted for 18.4% of deleted electors, not much higher than their 17.7% share of the adult population as per the 2011 Census. The "logical discrepancies" checks were not used in the Bihar SIR.

The eight reasons for flagging under "logical discrepancies" could be broadly classified into four categories. One, name mismatches with self or with parent. Two, five reasons based on family size or children. Third, "parents marked ineligible in the last SIR," which only had a miniscule number of 183 names. And a strange fourth, "no reasons mentioned", in which nearly 60,000 electors were flagged. In this category, too, the share of Muslims was disproportionately higher at nearly 20%.



BLOs conduct door-to-door enumeration during the SIR exercise in West Delhi in July. FILE PHOTO

In the first category, though the share of Muslims was higher when compared with their share among electors, the difference was of a lesser magnitude. About 15.5% of all electors flagged for mismatches in names were Muslims, which is 1.9 percentage points higher than their 13.6% share in the draft rolls.

It is in the second category, namely, "progeny >= 6", "parent age difference >50", "grandparent age difference <40", "progeny age gap <9 months", and "parent age difference <15", where the proportion of Muslims among those flagged is much higher. These reasons are also indicators of family size.

Of the 6.75 lakh electors who were flagged for one or more of these reasons, 30% were Muslims, which is more than double their 13.6% share in the draft electoral rolls. Of the 1.4 lakh electors flagged with "Progeny >=6" as reason, the share of Muslims went to 58% – over four times higher than their share among electors.

If one were to look at the rate among Muslims and non-Muslims flagged for one or more of these five reasons, it turns out that Muslims were nearly three times more likely to get flagged. The numbers showed that while 152 out of every 1,000 Muslim electors got flagged for these reasons, the same was only 56 for every 1,000 non-Muslim electors.

These patterns indicate that the reasons could have been designed in a manner that predominantly overlapped with the fact that the fertility rate is higher among Muslims. Yet, these higher rates are observed to be consistently falling, as per recent National Family Health Survey (NFHS) reports.

NFHS reports show that the total fertility rate for Muslim women came down from 4.41 to 2.36 between 1992-93 and 2019-22. The same for Hindu women came down in the same period from 3.3 to 1.94, with the gap between Muslim and Hindu women narrowing.

It is unclear how the software does these age-specific calculations collated for the discrepancies, considering that a large number of older people in India did not precisely remember their birth date owing to home deliveries being more common earlier. Even assuming that all electors accurately mentioned their ages and dates of birth for these calculations to be right, it is unclear if these reasons, per se, disqualified a person from being an elector or if it was the ECI's responsibility to scrutinise these.

### Not in the orders

Neither the ECI's order for SIR in Bihar (dated June 24, 2025) nor its subsequent direction to conduct SIR in 12 more States and Union Territories (U.T.s) as part of Phase 2 (dated October 27, 2025) had any mention of issuing notices for "logical discrepancies" to electors who managed to find a place on the draft SIR rolls by submitting duly filled enumeration forms.

ECI's directions for Phase 2 had only mentioned that EROs would issue notices to those added to the draft rolls, but could not be linked with the previous SIR rolls – which many States now report as the "unmapped" list of electors.

The ECI introduced the flagging of "logical discrepancies" first in West Bengal, midway during Phase 2 of the SIR, without any formal announcement.

The issue of notices to electors for "discrepancies" found a mention for the first time only in ECI's direction issued on May 14, 2026 for the ongoing Phase 3 of SIR – in 19 States and U.T.s. Adding an additional clause, it said, "ERO to issue notice to those persons who could not be linked or there is discrepancy in their linking with the electoral roll of the last revision."

Till date, the ECI has not explained the reasons for which an elector on the draft rolls could be flagged for "logical discrepancies".

Moreover, though it directed EROs to issue notices, the decision on who would be flagged was not theirs, but decided by the ERONET software that has come under scrutiny. This was confirmed by a senior election official who did not want to be identified.

A detailed questionnaire was sent to the ECI, seeking responses on what each of these reasons meant, how they were decided, whether any orders were issued in this regard, were any changes made to the reasons between Phase 2 and Phase 3 of SIR and whether the software used any artificial intelligence or deep learning methods. The ECI did not respond till Tuesday night.

*(With inputs from Sreeparna Chakraborty)*

## Over-flagged

Muslims' share among those flagged for 'logical discrepancies' in Delhi's SIR was 20.3%, much higher than their share in the draft rolls, which was 13.6%

*Share in %*

| Headline numbers | How many? | Share of Muslims | Share of non-Muslims |
|---|---|---|---|
| Electors in draft SIR rolls | 97,53,577 | 13.6 | 86.4 |
| Electors in draft SIR rolls who were issued notices | 33,11,746 | 14.3 | 85.7 |
| Unmapped with last SIR | 13,78,661 | 7.6 | 92.4 |
| Logical discrepancies | 19,33,085 | 20.3 | 79.7 |

**Reason-wise breakdown**

*Share in %*

| Reasons used for "logical discrepancies" | Share of Muslims | Share of non-Muslims |
|---|---|---|
| **Name mismatch** | 15.5 | 84.5 |
| Parent name mismatch | 18.2 | 81.8 |
| Self name mismatch | 11.8 | 88.2 |
| **Reasons indicative of family size** | 29.9 | 70.1 |
| Progeny age gap <9 month | 26.7 | 73.3 |
| Parent age difference <15 | 16.7 | 83.4 |
| Progeny >= 6 | 58.2 | 41.8 |
| Parent age difference >50 | 26.0 | 74.0 |
| Grandparent age difference <40 | 19.7 | 80.3 |
| **Parent marked ineligible in last SIR** | 86.3 | 13.7 |
| **No reason mentioned** | 19.3 | 80.7 |

**Methodology:** *The Hindu* downloaded Delhi's draft SIR rolls for all ACs, used optical character recognition (OCR) to extract text, and made a database. We downloaded the lists of electors who received notices for different reasons and mapped them with the roll database using EPIC IDs. To estimate religion, we used an open-source classifier built by Rochana Chaturvedi and Sugat Chaturvedi (Political Analysis, 2023). The model breaks names into short sequences of characters and learns which patterns go with each religion, so that it can classify names. We ran it on each elector's name combined with their relative's name for better accuracy. The authors trained it on about 1.15 lakh households across 17 States, and in their tests this combined-name version separated Muslims from non-Muslims with an accuracy of about 97%. Our manual check of a random sample of electors also found this to be accurate

***Explaining reasons:*** *Interpretation of the "logical discrepancy" reasons, based on conversations with field-level officials. "Progeny >= 6" — six or more electors named the same person in the 2002 rolls as their parent; "Parent age difference >50" and "Parent age difference <15" — the parent was over 50 or under 15 when the child was born. "Grandparent age difference <40" — elector and their grandparent are less than 40 years apart. "Progeny age gap <9 month" –siblings were born less than nine months apart.* ***Note:*** *A minor share of Muslim and non-Muslim electors flagged for logical discrepancies were marked with more than one reason. The rate and shares are calculated by counting every reason for every flagged elector. Similar trend held even if only the reason mentioned first for every elector is counted*

# Injured protesters denied medico-legal case details by police

**Ashna Butani**
NEW DELHI

A number of protesters injured during the weekend protests and subsequent detentions by the Delhi Police were left with swollen fingers, bruised bodies, and bleeding necks and heads. They said that when the police took them to hospital for treatment, they were denied copies of their medico-legal case (MLC) details and patient summaries.

The denial of medical records to injured protesters can have serious consequences, as seen in the case of those hit by pellet guns in the July 20 protest. *The Hindu* has reported that hospital records had confirmed pellet gun usage, even as the Delhi police denied it.

Hospitals usually make three copies of the MLC, of which two are given to the police, and one is kept in the hospital. The hospital is supposed to share a case summary with the patient, who can also ask the police for a copy of the MLC. However, lawyers say that due to grey areas in the law, a patient has to run from the hospital to the police to get access to their MLCs and case summaries.

A doctor at one of the hospitals which treated protesters said, on the condition of anonymity, "The usual protocol is that an MLC is registered and copies are provided to the police. The patient can ask the police for the MLC [copy]. We usually give the patients a case summary highlighting the injuries." A source at one of the hospitals that denied records to patients said that they are pressured not to share any information during protests.



People carry an injured protester during a march to the Supreme Court on Monday.

Saurabh, a Jamia Millia Islamia student associated with the All India Students' Association (AISA), alleged that he was beaten up with *lathis*, and dragged by the collar during his detention following his participation at the Dilli Haat protest on October 10.

"Some of us were taken to separate cells and beaten up, our phones were snatched...," he said.

Later that night, he and three others were taken to the Pt. Madan Mohan Malviya Hospital, in the presence of the police. "We asked the doctors to document the injuries and they did. But we were not given copies of the MLCs or any medical summaries...," he said.

Sooraj Elamon, an activist with the Students' Federation of India (SFI), alleged that he was slapped and pushed against the iron bars of the prison vans that he was detained in. "I was taken to the Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital with six other protesters. Initially, the hospital was ready to treat us and give us the papers, but refused to do the same after police involvement," he said.

# 'Meticulous planning' helped Congress mobilise massive crowd for INDIA bloc march

**Sobhana K. Nair**
NEW DELHI

On Saturday, as viral images of protests across Delhi flooded social media, with Jantar Mantar out of bounds and the Delhi Police carrying out mass detentions, Congress workers across the country received an appeal from top leaders, including Rahul Gandhi, to travel to the capital on Monday and to show up for the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance's "March for Democracy".

By Monday afternoon, even before the buses carrying INDIA bloc leaders rolled out of the Constitution Club, Congress flags and their bearers were waiting at intersections along the route expected to be taken by the procession. Many of them, like former Haryana Youth Congress working president Mayank Chaudhary, arrived just in time for the march, dodging police barricades.

The Congress claimed that 2.5 lakh people participated in the march. It took "meticulous planning" and a refreshed party machinery to pull off the feat, party general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal said. "We had instructed everyone to arrive in Delhi in their private vehicles and not display flags or banners. Despite all precautions, many workers were detained at the Rajasthan and Haryana borders, while others were picked up by the police from lodges in Delhi at night. We kept the doors of the party offices open for workers to stay and asked every parliamentarian to do the same," he said.



INDIA bloc leaders proceed in a bus during the 'March for Democracy' on Monday.

All Congress MPs were instructed to help workers find accommodation. Many parliamentarians, including Pramod Tiwari, Phulo Devi Netam, Jai Prakash, Karti Chidambaram, Jebi Mather and Dr. Kirsan Namdeo, threw open the doors of their Delhi residences for workers to spend the night.

Over the last year, under the Sangathan Srijan programme, 1,000 new district Congress committee (DCC) presidents have been appointed. Around 130 DCCs within driving distance of Delhi, across Haryana, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Uttarakhand, and Himachal Pradesh, mobilised people from their areas for the protest. The Congress organisation, Mr. Venugopal said, has changed drastically. "Within 48 hours, we can mobilise our workers," he added.

Sachin Pilot, the Congress general secretary in charge of Punjab, sees Monday's march as a "turning point" in the narrative of "how India's politics will move forward". "It is no longer just about SIR or seeking Gyanesh Kumar's resignation. It is about the future of the country," Mr. Pilot said.

# PCI slams crackdown on journalists

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

Journalists from a large number of media organisations gathered at the Press Club of India here on Tuesday condemning the police crackdown on media professionals during the protest by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) during the weekend of October 10 to 11.

Among the journalists who narrated a first-person account on the occasion were reporters from the BBC, Newslaundry, The Quint, *Caravan*, and The Wire. Narrating his experience of getting detained by the Delhi Police, Sarthak of The Quint recounted how he was treated in an aggressive manner by the police.

Press Club of India president Sangeeta Barooah Pisharoty said the incidents of attacks showed that the "right to work" is under attack. Sreenivasan Jain described the crackdown on the media as a "very concerning escalation".

# WhatsApp polls used for surveillance, say protesters

**Lavpreet Kaur**
NEW DELHI

As protests called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) continue, participants have raised concerns over the alleged infiltration of WhatsApp groups by the police, citing suspicious "attendance polls" that they fear could be used to identify potential protesters and track their movements.

Several members of CJP-related WhatsApp groups told *The Hindu* that they received polls asking whether they intended to attend protests, followed by messages directing participants to specific locations where, they alleged, no protesters had assembled, but people were being detained. They feared that their identities and responses were being used to facilitate preventive detentions.

The concerns come days after *The Hindu* reported that Delhi Police personnel were monitoring at least 200 WhatsApp and Telegram groups ahead of the CJP's October 10 protest call.

"We started receiving these polls. One of them asked, 'Up for surgical strike on JM?' I responded yes, but no protest was decided on later and nobody reached the spot," a participant said, requesting anonymity.

### Journalist 'detained'

A technology journalist based in Gurugram alleged that the Haryana Police placed him under house detention for 48 hours on October 10, ahead of the planned protest, solely because he was a member of a CJP WhatsApp group.



CJP spokespersons Saurav Das, Ashutosh Ranka and others after being detained for entering Jantar Mantar on Tuesday. PTI

# Delhi Police book 14 CJP members after Jantar Mantar entry

**Lavpreet Kaur**
NEW DELHI

Fourteen members of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), including leaders Saurav Das, Ashutosh Ranka, and Ajinkya Shinde, were detained by the Delhi Police on Tuesday while attempting to enter Jantar Mantar, a day after the police denotified the long-established protest site.

The New Delhi district police registered a first information report (FIR) against the detained individuals on charges including trespassing, unlawful assembly and disobedience of an order promulgated by a public servant, and initiated an investigation, an official close to the development said.

The detentions came amid a widening dispute over access to designated protest venues in the capital, with activists criticising removal of Jantar Mantar as a move that could distance demonstrations from the political establishment and make it harder for citizens to press their demands.

Hours after the detention, CJP member Abhijit Dipke posted a video on X showing party members carrying the national flag near Jantar Mantar. "Cockroaches with the Tiranga sneaked into Jantar Mantar early this morning before they were picked up by Delhi Police," the post said. It added: "You cannot denotify the resistance, Narendra Modi."

A senior Delhi Police officer told *The Hindu* that the protesters had entered the area through eateries and food stalls near the protest site.

"The shops serve as regular eating places for employees working in nearby offices and remain open and accessible to the public, except on days when major protest calls are made, such as October 10," the officer said.

With Jantar Mantar no longer notified as an authorised protest venue, demonstrations there would be illegal, the officer said.

### FIRs against march

Separately, the Delhi Police registered at least two FIRs in connection with the INDIA bloc's march through central Delhi on Monday, citing the absence of permission for the demonstration and alleged damage to barricades and public property.

## INBRIEF




### Don't give nod to Starlink, RSS affiliate urges Centre

Citing the need to curtail Internet services during riots and other law-and-order situations, the Swadeshi Jagran Manch (SJM), the economic wing of the RSS, on Tuesday urged the Union government to deny Elon Musk-owned Starlink permission to launch commercial satellite broadband services in India. In a statement, SJM national co-convener Ashwani Mahajan said Internet services sometimes need to be suspended and questioned whether Starlink's technology would allow services to be restricted in specific areas at the government's direction. The statement comes amid protests in Delhi over alleged irregularities in SIR exercise.

### Sitaram Yechury Foundation invites abstracts for essays

The Sitaram Yechury Foundation (SYF) has invited undergraduate and postgraduate students to submit abstracts for essays on "Imperialism in the Present Age", not exceeding 600 words. The Foundation is a registered not-for-profit trust set up in memory of the late CPI(M) general secretary. It aims at engaging youth in spreading progressive ideas through academic and public programmes. Entries must be emailed to syfessays@gmail.com by Monday, October 26. Eight entries will be shortlisted, following which their authors will be asked to write 3,000-word essays. All eight authors will be invited to present their essays at a day-long programme in Kolkata on November 22.

# China says 'never recognised' U.T. of Ladakh; India hits back

Beijing opposes Survey of India move to standardise names of specific features in Ladakh, calls it 'illegal and void'; New Delhi says 'no amount of denial by Chinese side' can change established fact

**Suhasini Haidar**
**Ananth Krishnan**
NEW DELHI/BEIJING

India and China on Tuesday sparred over New Delhi's decision to standardise the names of 28 features in Ladakh, including some along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) that had seen skirmishes between the Indian Army and the People's Liberation Army during a four-year stand-off.

The Chinese Foreign Ministry on Tuesday said it has "never recognised" the Union Territory (U.T.) of Ladakh, which was created in 2019, and called the naming of the areas by the Survey of India as "illegal and void", a charge that New Delhi rejected.

"The U.T. of Ladakh is an integral and inalienable part of India. No amount of denial by the Chinese side can change this established fact," said External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal. "Identifying these [28] places formally on the Survey of India map of the U.T. of Ladakh is aimed at facilitating their accurate recognition and better awareness among the public at large," he explained.

> The U.T. of Ladakh is an integral and inalienable part of India. No amount of denial by the Chinese side can change this established fact
>
> **RANDHIR JAISWAL**
> Spokesperson, External Affairs Ministry



> This move by India is illegal and void, and does not change the fact that the western sector of the China-India boundary belongs to China
>
> **MAO NING**
> Spokesperson, Chinese Foreign Ministry



The spokesperson was responding to comments made by the Chinese Foreign Ministry earlier in the day. To a question at the Chinese Foreign Ministry briefing, spokesperson Mao Ning said that China has "never recognised the so-called 'Union Territory of Ladakh' unilaterally and illegally established by India, and firmly opposes the so-called 'standardised names' publicised by India."

"This move by India is illegal and void, and does not change the fact that the western sector of the China-India boundary belongs to China," she added, referring to the August 5, 2019 decision by the Indian government to bifurcate the State of Jammu and Kashmir into two Union Territories and dilute Article 370 of the Constitution.

At the time, Beijing had issued a sharp statement accusing India of undermining "China's territorial sovereignty by unilaterally changing its domestic law." Beijing had also made such a claim in September 2020 reacting strongly to an Indian project to construct high-altitude roads in eastern Ladakh

**A first in two years**

This is the first such spat in the past two years, however, since the two sides re-established diplomatic and travel links between the two countries in an effort to normalise relations after the meeting between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping in 2024, indicating that the map remains a major point of contention.

The comments came 10 days after the Survey of India announced the standardisation of the names of specific relief features in Ladakh, including 11 peaks, five mountains, six land areas, two glaciers, two passes, one valley, one river, one lake, and one other waterbody.

Both features abut Patrolling Point 15 (PP-15), which had seen heavy mobilisation during the India-China tensions at the LAC after the deadly clashes at Galwan in June 2020. The two armies agreed to stand down from the PP-15 point in September 2022, as part of a series of disengagement negotiations.

Both India and China have been reinforcing their territorial claims in both the Western and Eastern sectors by naming features in official maps and creating administrative jurisdictions in a series of cartographic tit-for-tat measures going back many years.

# Murugan's exit from Ministry intensifies Cabinet rejig buzz

**Nistula Hebbar**
NEW DELHI


L. Murugan

Union Minister of State for Parliamentary Affairs L. Murugan resigned from the Council of Ministers and his Rajya Sabha seat on Tuesday, setting off speculation about a Cabinet reshuffle in the near future.

Mr. Murugan hails from Tamil Nadu, but represented Madhya Pradesh in the Upper House. His term as an MP was not set to end till 2030. The BJP's strength in M.P. ensures that his vacated seat will be won by a party MP, paving the way for a new inclusion into the Council of Ministers.

**Slew of vacancies**

Two other Union Ministers of State, George Kurian and Ravneet Singh Bittu, had already tendered their resignations at the end of their respective terms in the Upper House earlier this year. The Rajya Sabha terms of Union Ministers Hardeep Singh Puri and B.L. Verma are also set to end next month, even as the BJP got eight new faces into the Upper House from Uttar Pradesh, along with one each from West Bengal and Uttarakhand. Also, over the summer, Dharmendra Pradhan was forced to resign as Education Minister, and that post is now being held as an additional charge by Consumer Affairs Minister Pralhad Joshi.

There are also rumours that two more Ministers of State, Pankaj Chaudhary and Harsh Malhotra, may put in their papers after being appointed the chiefs of the BJP's Uttar Pradesh and Delhi units respectively, but BJP sources said that "nothing has been finalised yet".

Thus, there are at least half a dozen Ministerial berths lying vacant. BJP sources said that a Cabinet reshuffle may take place before Deepavali. This would be the first reshuffle of the Union Cabinet since Narendra Modi was sworn in as Prime Minister for his third successive term, along with 71 Ministers.

# BIMSTEC adopts 'Delhi Declaration' on terrorism

**Vijaita Singh**
NEW DELHI



**Diplomatic mission:** Amit Shah with other delegates during the first meeting of Home Ministers of the BIMSTEC countries. PTI

India hosted the first-ever meeting of the Home Ministers of the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC) countries on Tuesday, where the regional bloc adopted a declaration to counter radicalisation, violent extremism conducive to terrorism, prevent the misuse of new and emerging technologies for terrorist purposes, and tackle terrorist recruitment.

Bangladesh, the chair of BIMSTEC, was represented by Manzur Morshed Chowdhury, Senior Secretary in its Home Ministry, instead of Home Minister Salahuddin Ahmed, a key member in Prime Minister Tarique Rahman's Cabinet.

The "Delhi Declaration" signed by Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Thailand, also called for curbing terror financing through adherence to internationally agreed counter-terror financing and anti-money laundering standards, consistent with domestic and international laws.

The declaration said the member states "strongly condemn terrorism and violent extremism in all its forms and manifestations, including cross-border terrorism, wherever, by whomsoever and for whatever purposes committed; reiterate our determination to prevent, combat and eliminate terrorism and violent extremism conducive to terrorism in a comprehensive and sustained manner, in accordance with the UN Charter and international law; and in this context, call for effective implementation of the sanctions measures of the UN Security Council, including of the 1267 Sanctions Committee".

The grouping expressed condolences and solidarity with victims of terrorist attacks in member states and their families, as well as the governments of the affected states. It called for those responsible to be brought to justice in accordance with applicable domestic and international law and relevant UN Security Council resolutions.

**Areas of cooperation**

Union Home Minister Amit Shah highlighted five key areas of cooperation: drug control, counter-terrorism and legal cooperation, repatriation of fugitive criminals, cybersecurity and cybercrime investigations, and institutional cooperation and capacity building. He called for a coordinated regional approach to combating illicit financial transactions and terror financing and stressed the need to strengthen cooperation among law enforcement, intelligence, and border management agencies.

"India has always believed in sovereignty and peaceful resolutions to any dispute. We are committed to cooperating to face challenges emanating from International terrorism, organised crime and narco-trade," Mr. Shah said.

He said criminal networks run their operations beyond international borders and take advantage of regional lacunae.

"This is why regional cooperation is a must. Their strategy is changing; they are using encrypted communication, social media, drones, cryptocurrency and the dark web to recruit and propagate illegal activities. This is why real-time intelligence-sharing and cooperation is required to check these crimes. None of the member countries should shelter such criminals. We should cooperate in the extradition of such criminals," he added.

Mr. Shah flagged "human trafficking and cyber slavery" as grave concerns". "Sharing of actionable intelligence should be a priority among BIMSTEC countries," he said.

# 'To prevent leaks, generate exam papers at last minute'

**Maitri Porecha**
NEW DELHI


Nandan Nilekani

Challenged with a slew of question paper leaks that have threatened the credibility of India's examination system, Infosys cofounder Nandan Nilekani has suggested a solution: create "a massive bank of questions", and only generate the final paper at the last minute.

He added that artificial intelligence could also be used to generate the question paper on the day of the examination itself. For any of this to work, of course, examinations will have to be held in computer-based test mode, abandoning the traditional pen-and-paper format.

Mr. Nilekani is the chairman of a six-member high-powered task force on exam reforms set up by the Union government in July.

He was responding to a question on the security issues and weaknesses of the exam system observed by the task force, posed at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum 2026 on Tuesday.

"The issue that led to this committee is that of question paper leaks. Why do we need to have something called 'a question paper'? Because that creates an economic incentive for it to be sold. One way to look at how to solve it is to have a massive bank of questions, and only at the last minute generate the question paper for the day," Mr. Nilekani said.

The panel is studying the feasibility of conducting all exams using CBT, Mr. Nilekani said. "The committee is looking at how to make sure all exams are done on CBT. That requires a network of locations. We have 1,50,000 locations where young candidates can take a test and that needs to be expanded," Mr. Nilekani emphasised.

**The AI option**

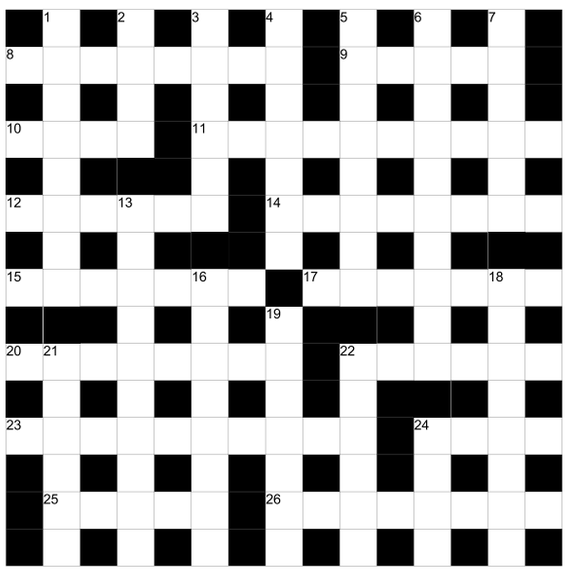
Asked whether artificial intelligence could be used to spontaneously create a question paper on the day of the exam, Mr. Nilekani responded saying, "Yeah sure." He added: "If you look at it systematically, go to the root cause of why it is happening and use technology to solve it they are solvable issues."

## TH CROSSWORD + 14923

(set by Gridzilla)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



**ACROSS**

8. Bored by country song in party? (8)
9. Way, reportedly, to get to big house (5)
10. European has half Polish name (4)
11. What's seen in hands of orthodontists, etc? (3,2,5)
12. Overwhelmed by arthritis sometimes? Yes! (2,2,2)
14. The University dean's building is cool (8)
15. Heartbroken chaps continue to sigh? (7)
17. Hip and leg operation basically pending (2,5)
20. Wretched fellow's killing time inside (8)
22. Play fine puzzle right away (6)
23. Ones you can bank on, to get serious? (2,8)
24. OK to pester for repayment of a loan, we hear (4)
25. One of the best violinists ever from Russia, enthralled millions, for starters (5)
26. Even lower? (8)

**DOWN**

1. Support staff for flights? (8)
2. Either way, it's lunch time (4)
3. Up in Saratoga, I sampled some cheese (6)
4. Lids came off easily? (4,3)
5. Even in those days, dogs primarily scavenged meals on occasion (8)
6. Ordinary and OK? Fine and fantastic? Or exceptional? (3,2,1,4)
7. Jerk starts to expose his tummy in restaurant, when getting a tip (6)
13. Spooner's hound got a ride (10)
16. Fine day to board carriage back from office (8)
18. Cat is able to jump around corner (8)
19. Full day, one dude's getting fleeced in city (4-3)
21. What's set up quickly, at the conclusions of some trials? (6)
22. Strong fellow gets hurt unloading piano (6)
24. Flower placed on top of policeman's grave (4)

## SUDOKU

| | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5 | | | 6 | | | | | |
| | 4 | | | | 1 | | 8 | |
| 6 | 8 | | | 3 | 9 | 7 | | |
| 2 | | | | | 6 | | | |
| 3 | 5 | | 2 | | 8 | | 6 | 4 |
| | | | 5 | | | | | 8 |
| | | 9 | 3 | 6 | | | 1 | 5 |
| | 3 | | 9 | | | | 2 | |
| | | | | | 7 | | | 6 |

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DIFFICULTY RATING: ★☆☆☆☆

**Solution to previous puzzle**

| | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| D | V | S | S | A | I | C | | |
| D | E | T | E | N | T | I | O | N |
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| P | N | R | F | H | T | I | | |
| F | A | C | I | L | I | T | A | T |
| E | A | C | M | E | | | | |
| R | C | N | N | G | I | | | |
| S | T | R | E | N | G | T | H | |
| I | N | L | A | N | D | | | |
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| E | L | E | C | T | O | R | A | L |
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**Solution to yesterday's Sudoku**

| | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | 6 | 1 | 8 | 9 | 5 | 7 | 3 | 2 |
| 2 | 7 | 9 | 1 | 3 | 6 | 4 | 8 | 5 |
| 3 | 8 | 5 | 2 | 7 | 4 | 9 | 6 | 1 |
| 1 | 4 | 7 | 5 | 6 | 2 | 8 | 9 | 3 |
| 5 | 9 | 3 | 4 | 8 | 7 | 2 | 1 | 6 |
| 8 | 2 | 6 | 3 | 1 | 9 | 5 | 7 | 4 |
| 6 | 3 | 2 | 9 | 4 | 8 | 1 | 5 | 7 |
| 9 | 1 | 4 | 7 | 5 | 3 | 6 | 2 | 8 |
| 7 | 5 | 8 | 6 | 2 | 1 | 3 | 4 | 9 |

## FAITH

### Efficacy of Purattasi

Discipline is key to every aspect of life, be it work, health, accumulating and managing wealth, in raising a family etc. It is of utmost importance in one's devotional quest. In human life one will chase material wealth but will never forget that he has to discipline his mind and grow spiritually as well. This is evident from the austerities followed by a devotee in Purattasi, the Tamil month which is also very dear to Venkatachalapthy (Srinivasan, Balaji, Ezhumalaiyan), who beckons devotees to His abode in Tirupati in order to shower His blessings upon them, said Damal S. Ramakrishnan. Lakhs of devotees undertake yatra to Tirumala during this holy month, chanting the Govinda namam, seeking His darshan, divine gaze, and everlasting compassion that makes Him accept the surrender of devotees. It is the time when devotees get closer to divinity.

Saturdays falling in this month are considered efficacious for visiting various temples and gaining the darshan of Vishnu's numerous archa avatars. Devotees voluntarily opt for a sattvic diet, shun ostentatious events, observe fasts as a way of disciplining the senses, attend discourses and offer annadhanam (free offering of food preparations).

Preparing the *mavilakku*, an edible 'mountain' prepared with flour, jaggery and cardamom, is another feature undertaken in many homes on any one of the Saturdays during the month of Purattasi. The centre of the mound is filled with ghee and a cotton wick is inserted and lit. Many of the devout see the image of Srinivasa when the wick is lit and seek His blessings from their respective homes.

## INBRIEF



### Hyundai Motor to invest $15.5 bn in India by 2032

Hyundai Motor Group said it will invest $15.5 billion in India between 2026 and 2032, expanding manufacturing capacity, research and development (R&D) infrastructure and localisation of components as it seeks to strengthen the country's position as a global automotive hub. The investment plan was discussed at a meeting between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Hyundai Motor Group Executive Chair Euisun Chung at the PMO in New Delhi on Tuesday. The seven-year investment will span manufacturing expansion, future technology development, local supplier partnerships and infrastructure development, the South Korean automotive major said in a statement. The Group plans to expand production capacity across Hyundai Motor India Ltd. (HMIL) and Kia India Pvt Ltd. to cater to rising demand and improve localisation.

### Vantrock unveils warehousing, industrial, logistics parks plan

Vantrock Real Assets Private Ltd. (VRAPL), an operator-led real assets platform, plans to develop 11.5 million sq. ft of warehousing, industrial and logistics parks, with a gross development value (GDV) of ₹4,200 crore upon completion. The first phase, spanning 3 million sq. ft. and valued at ₹1,100 crore, will be spread across NCR, Bengaluru and Pune. Construction is scheduled to begin in 2027, with rental income expected to commence in 2028. Land for these projects is at advanced stages of negotiation, documentation and regulatory approvals, the company said. The remaining 8.5 million sq. ft will be acquired across the same markets and the Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR). These assets will be operationalised in phases over the next 12-18 months, it added. The company also plans to upgrade existing warehousing facilities to improve safety and operational standards. In subsequent phases, Vantrock plans to expand into global capability centres, suburban office campuses, data centres and infrastructure assets.

# Adani defers Mumbai to Navi Mumbai plan

The Group's proposed shifting of 30% of international flight slots has been deferred to the summer schedule that begins on March 28, 2027

**Jagriti Chandra**
NEW DELHI



The move follows a stand-off over the 'forceful' transfer of 30% of Mumbai's international airport slots to Navi Mumbai. REUTERS

The Adani Group has put on hold its plan to shift 30% of international flight slots at Mumbai's Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport to Navi Mumbai International Airport, with no transfers planned for the upcoming winter schedule.

The proposed shift has been deferred to the summer schedule, which begins on March 28, 2027.

The move was the outcome of a consultative meeting between Adani Group and airlines on Tuesday, after the Centre was forced to intervene in the stand-off. "They have assured the airline community of minimisation of disruption and have assured them of fully respecting historical slots allocations. They have further given a commitment not to disturb any slots for the winter schedule," Adani Airports Holding Ltd. said in a press statement about the message from its Director Jeet Adani and CEO Arun Bansal to the airlines in Tuesday's meeting.

The group said it had secured commitments from international airlines to support the plan for the summer schedule.

The move follows a standoff between the Adani Group and international airlines over what carriers described as a "forceful" transfer of 30% of Mumbai's international airport slots to the Navi Mumbai airport. The International Air Transport Association (IATA), which represents global airlines, had called for a consultative approach and alternatives to cutting existing slots, and sufficient time for making the transition, warning that the move could affect international connectivity to and from Mumbai.

Mumbai International Airport Limited (MIAL) had recently proposed that approximately one-third of each carrier's passenger and cargo air traffic movements be transferred from Mumbai to Navi Mumbai from October 1, 2026.

This was to ostensibly cater for redevelopment of Terminal 1 at Mumbai, from where some domestic flights would be shifted to its Terminal 2 (T2), and international flights from T2 be shifted to Navi Mumba airporti.

# 'Will keenly hear views on LTCG, STT'

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI



Nirmala Sitharaman

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Tuesday said that she would listen to all views regarding the long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax and the securities transaction tax (STT). However, she refrained from stating whether the matter would be considered during the ongoing discussions in the preparations of Budget 2027.

Just the indication that she would listen to views on the taxation matter led to the stock market jumping 1% soon after she said it. The Finance Minister also said that the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) would continue to take action to prevent volatility in the rupee exchange rate.

"The long-term capital gains tax is something on which a lot of people have been commenting, both the investors within India and also those who meet me occasionally outside in India," Ms. Sitharaman said at an event in Delhi.

She added that several ministers had also raised the issue of the STT, saying that it was running parallel with the LTCG and that India should impose one or the other.

"So, it's healthy to have this debate and I will be keenly hearing them," Ms. Sitharaman said.

However, the Minister also said that since the Budget 2027 preparations have started, she would not comment on whether the issue would be discussed during the pre-budget meetings or not.

"The rupee has reached a low, and the RBI is making a lot of efforts through their regulatory powers to make sure that the rupee stays stable," Ms. Sitharaman said. "They are not trying to fix the rupee, they are trying to stop the volatility." "These efforts from the RBI, I understand, will continue," she added.

"I'm sure there are efforts which the RBI would take further to make sure that rupee doesn't become too volatile."

# India does not grow at anybody's expense: PM

**Saptaparno Ghosh**
NEW DELHI

India does not grow at anybody's expense, instead, it grows with the world and for the world, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said at an event here on Tuesday, underlining India as a steady and trusted pillar for the globe.

"Whenever the world requires a steady pillar, India comprehends its responsibility and extends a hand in support," he said.

The Prime Minister also said that reforms being undertaken in India were not driven by compulsion but conviction.

The PM mentioned that India offered stability and could be relied upon in an uncertain world.

He pointed to the country having clocked a growth rate of 7.8% in the first quarter of the ongoing financial year, emphasising that it rested on strong foundations. Mr. Modi also pointed to India's current account deficit standing at 0.61%, foreign exchange reserves being above $700 billion alongside a strong and resilient banking sector, among other things.

# OPEC cuts India's 2026 oil demand growth forecast to 40,000 bpd

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

The Organisation of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) has lowered its forecast for India's oil demand growth in 2026 to 40,000 barrels per day (bpd), from 60,000 bpd projected in its September report. On a year-on-year (YoY) basis, India's oil demand is expected to rise by around 40,000 b/d to 5.7 million barrels per day (mbpd) in 2026, according to OPEC's latest monthly oil market report.

OPEC has also trimmed its global oil demand growth forecast for 2026 to 0.2 mbpd, down from 0.4 mbpd estimated in its previous assessment. However, it has raised its projection for global oil demand growth in 2027 to 2.6 mb/d, from 2.4 mb/d forecast last month.

**Transportation fuels, particularly gasoline and diesel, are expected to remain the primary drivers**

Its outlook for India's oil demand growth in 2027 remains unchanged.

Transportation fuels, particularly gasoline and diesel, are expected to remain the primary drivers of India's oil demand growth in 2026.

"Gasoline is expected to be supported by heightened road mobility amid robust vehicle sales. Diesel demand is anticipated to gain additional support from strong manufacturing and agricultural activity," OPEC said.

The report also projects an increase in demand for residual fuel during the year, while jet fuel consumption is expected to register marginal growth.

In contrast, demand for liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) and naphtha is expected to ease, OPEC said.

**KERALA STATE ELECTRICITY BOARD LIMITED - TENDER NOTICE**
**OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (COMMERCIAL & TARIFF), VYDYUTHI BHAVANAM, THIRUVANANTHAPURAM**
Inviting Medium term Power procurement of 500 MW for the period from **01.06.2027 to 31.05.2032** during **18.00 to 24.00 hours** (peak hours) on lumpsum tariff basis, through e-bidding portal (DEEP) only.
**DEEP Portal e-Tender No. KSEBL/Medium/Lumpsum Tariff/26-27/ET/95** and **e-reverse auction No. KSEBL/Medium/Lumpsum Tariff /26-27/RA/81** Dated **12.10.2026.** Last Date and time of submission of Application and Bid - (Bid Due Date) - **20.01.2027, 01.30 pm.**
For more details visit **www.kseb.in** Ref : **PR/MC1/F404/2026**

**AHMEDABAD MUNICIPAL CORPORATION**
**MAHANAGAR SEVA SADAN**
**STREETLIGHT/TRAFFIC SIGNAL DEPARTMENT**
**TENDER NOTICE**
**Tender for Comprehensive Operation and Maintenance contract of Street Light Poles and Implementation of Centralized Smart City Management System for Streetlights of Ahmedabad city for Five Years.**

| | |
|---|---|
| Pre-bid Meeting | Date : 26/10/2026 Time:- 11:00 Hrs. |
| Last date of Tender Submission (Online) | Date : 03/11/2026 up to 18:00 Hrs. |
| Last date of Tender Submission (Hard Copy) | Date : 04/11/2026 up to 14:00 Hrs. |
| Detail and Tenders available on | **www.nprocure.com** OR **www.tender.nprocure.com** |

**IndianOil**
**CIN : L23201MH1959GOI011388**
**NOTICE FOR HIRING OF CONTRACTOR FOR CGD PROJECT**
**OPPORTUNITY FOR ANY INTERESTED INDIVIDUAL / PARTY / LOCAL VENDORS / PETTY CONTRACTORS POSSESSING TEAMS OF PLUMBERS & HELPERS**
Indian Oil Corporation Limited (a Maharatna Company under the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas) is seeking applications from prospective bidders for various jobs related to Last Mile Connectivity (LMC), Direct Marketing Agency (DMA) and laying of PE Pipeline Network and associated works for PNG connections in the Coimbatore Geographical area in the state of Tamil Nadu.
**VENDOR DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME:**
**Eligibility and Selection Method:** To engage contractors through the Vendor Development Programme (Any Interested Individual / Party / Local Vendors / Petty Contractors Possessing Teams of Plumbers & Helpers (Minimum of 02 teams, each comprising 1 Plumber/Jointer and 1 Helper) through training and trial orders). Work orders will be issued on a first-come-first-serve basis, subject to fulfillment of requirements and at the sole discretion of IOCL.
**BID SUBMISSION DETAILS:**
**Mode of Submission:** Physical Mode Only. Bids shall be submitted only at the Coimbatore GA Office (address below):
**Indian Oil Corporation Limited,**
Coimbatore City Gas Distribution Office, No. 965, 2nd Floor, Haritha Center, Lakshmi Mills, Avinashi Road, Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu-641037
**Date:** Starting Wednesday, 14 October 2026 | **Time:** 09:00 AM to 05:30 PM
**Cut-off date:** 28th October 2026
The Detailed Tender Document mentioning method of selection, selection criteria, Scope of work and other terms and conditions are available on IOCL website **(https://iocl.com/suppliers-notices)** and CPP Portal **(https://eprocure.gov.in/epublish/app)**.
**Important Notice:** IOCL reserves the right to discontinue the process at any point of time without assigning any reasons. Further, IOCL has the sole discretion to qualify or accept/reject the applications for award of job without assigning any reason whatsoever. Any corrigendum, amendments, or detailed terms & conditions shall be published only on the official IOCL website **(https://iocl.com/suppliers-notices)** and CPP Portal **(https://eprocure.gov.in/epublish/app)** and will not be published in newspapers.
**Contact for any further Information:**
**Phone:** 9894564800,8565835550 | **Email:** ajithkd@indianoil.in

**राजस्थान सरकार**
**कार्यालय अधिशाषी अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग खण्ड तिजारा (खैरथल-तिजारा)**
Email: eepwdtijara@rajasthan.gov.in & eepwdtijara@rediffmail.com
क्रमांक- 771 दिनांक 30.09.2026
**Short term NIT No 12/2026-27**
Bids for Construction of Various Missing Link/ Non-Patchable roads Under PWD Dn-Tijara & Tentage and Safe House work for VIP/ VVIP Visits in PWD Division Tijara (Rate Contract) are invited from interested bidder from 05.10.2026 02:00 Pm up to 27.10.2026 06:00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may on the procurement portal (http:/eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http:/sppp.raj.nic.in) of the state. The approximate value of the procurement is **Rs. 1102.38** Lacs.
NIB No:. PWD2627A3212
1. UBN NO: PWD2627WSOB14541, 2. UBN NO: PWD2627WSOB14542
3. UBN NO: PWD2627WSOB14543, 4. UBN NO: PWD2627WSOB14544
5. UBN NO: PWD2627WSOB14545
**Executive Engineer**
**PWD Div TIJARA**
DIPR/C/17475/26

**BHARAT DYNAMICS LIMITED**
(A Government of India Enterprise)
MINISTRY OF DEFENCE
GACHIBOWLI, HYDERABAD-500 032.
Ref: BDL/CC/OT/GT/03/2026-27 Dt: 14.10.2026
**e-PROCUREMENT ABRIDGED TENDER NOTICE**
**Inviting Indigenous Competitive Bidding**

| Sl. No. | Tender ID | Description | Estimate in Rs |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | 67119 | Construction of collapsed Traverse wall at BDL Bhanur | 245.0 Lakhs |
| 2. | 67120 | Repair and Relaying of internal Roads in Plant and Township at Bhanur | 557.05 Lakhs |

Please visit website **https://bdltenders.abcprocure.com**, select ONLINE tenders on dashboard for further details. Bids should be submitted online only. **"corrigendum if any shall be issued through our e-portal only and not in Newspapers"**
*Bidders are Requested to apply for online Vendor Registration in BDL website **https://bdl-india.in/registration-contractors** prospects.
**DEPUTY GENERAL MANAGER (Corp Comml)**

**Government of Rajasthan**
**(Department of Information Technology & Communication) IT Building, Yojana Bhawan Campus, Tilak Marg, C-Scheme, Jaipur-302005**
**Vacancy Notice**
In continuation to the Vacancy Notice issued vide No. **F5.502 (1442 )/ DoIT&C/2025-13096- 8832250/DoIT/BSDC-299 dated 31.12.2025,** applications are invited from willing and eligible candidates for filling up the following posts in the Rajasthan State Computer Security Incident Response Team (R-CSIRT), Jaipur, Rajasthan:

| S.N. | Name of the Post | Pay Matrix Level | No. of Vacancy |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Director | L-24 | 1 |
| 2 | Technical Lead - Incident Response (IR) | L-20 | 1 |

The last date for submission of applications through email will be 50 days from the date of publication of this advertisement.
Candidates who have already submitted their applications in response to the earlier Vacancy Notice dated 31.12.2025 need not apply again. Their applications shall be considered as per the prescribed eligibility criteria and other terms and conditions of the Vacancy Notice.
For further and complete details, please visit our websites:
**https://doitc.rajasthan.gov.in/, https://risl.rajasthan.gov.in/**
DIPR/C/17552/2026 TD & JS

**WATCO**
**OFFICE OF THE MANAGING DIRECTOR, WATCO**
Ground Floor, Unnati Bhawan,
H.B.Colony, Satyanagar, Bhubaneswar-751007, Odisha, India
Telefax: - +91-674-2571444; E-mail – mdwatcoodisha@gmail.com .
**INVITATION FOR BID (IFB) - Bid Identification No. WATCO(W)-20/2026-27, Dtd.12.10.2026**
**WATCO No. 11547 / Date: 12.10.2026**
- **Name of the work :-**
1. Laying of the 150 mm & 100 mm dia. pipe line for Improvement of Water Supply to the Ward No-1 to 10 at newly developed areas under WATCO Section-II, Baripada under WATCO Division Baripada in Mayurbhanj District.
2. Laying of the 150 mm & 100 mm dia. pipe line for Improvement of Water Supply to the ward No-.21 of Kusta Ashram, Grandgoli, LIC colony, Ward No 22 Raghunathpur area, Ward no.19, Badheisahi area under WATCO Section-III, Baripada under WATCO Division Baripada in Mayurbhanj District.
3. Laying of the 150 mm & 100 mm dia. pipe line for Improvement of Water Supply to the ward No-12, 27,28 & 24 of area Bagdiha, Convent School front, Takatpur under WATCO Section-I, Baripada under WATCO Division Baripada in Mayurbhanj District.

- **Estimated Cost** : Rs.141.14 Lakhs to Rs.284.76 Lakhs
- **Period of completion** : 06 (Six) Months
- **Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal.** : From 5.00 PM of Dt. 16.10.2026 to 5.00 PM of Dt. 02.11.2026
- **Last date / time of receipt of bids in the portal** : 5.00 PM of Dt. 02.11.2026
- **Date & Time of opening of technical bids** : 12.30 PM of Dt. 04.11.2026
- **Name and Address of the Officer Inviting Bid** : MD, WATCO, Telefax:- 0674-2571444. E-Mail : mdwatcoodisha@gmail.com
- **The bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only.**

Further details can be seen from the web site **www.tendersodisha.gov.in** .
**(Managing Director), WATCO**
13001/2157/2627 OIPR-13001/13263/1/26-27/0020

**KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD**
(DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE, GOVT. OF KERALA)
Head Office : Thycaud, Thiruvananthapuram-14,
(Telephone No. 0471-2945600, ),
E-mail : edrugs.kmscl@kerala.gov.in,
website : www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616
No.KMSCL/ED/30/2026 Date : 12.10.2026
**E- TENDER NOTICE**
Online bids are invited from manufacturers/direct importers / loan licensees on behalf of Department of Health, Govt of Kerala for the procurement of Drugs/ Consumable for Thalassemia Management for the year 2026 - 2027.

| Sl. No. | Tender No. and Date | No. Drugs |
|---|---|---|
| 1. | KMSCL/ED/THALASSEMIA /RC/2026/026 dtd. 13/10/2026 | 06 |

Last date and time of online uploading of tender - 26.10.2026, 10.00 am.
Date and time of opening of Technical bid - 28.10.2026 11.00 am.
Tenders shall be downloaded and submitted online through the e-tender portal **www.etenders.kerala.gov.in.**
(Sd/-) MANAGING DIRECTOR (Tender Inviting Authority)

**THE TAMIL NADU CO-OPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS' FEDERATION LIMITED,**
AAVIN ILLAM, No.3A, PASUMPON MUTHURAMALINGANAR SALAI, NANDANAM, CHENNAI-600 035.
TELEPHONE: 044-23464500, FAX :044-23464505, E-MAIL: aavinidms@gmail.com
Ref. No: 6957/IDMS/2026 **NOTICE INVITING TENDER (e-Submission Only)** Date : 14.10.2026
The TCMPF Ltd., invites **TWO PART TENDERS** by way of **e-Submission through the e-Procurement Portal** from the reputed entities/ Vendors for the following items/works for TCMPF:-

| Sl. No. | Name of the works / Items | EMD Value | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Selection of a System Integrator (SI) to operate and maintain the Integrated Dairy Management System (IDMS) Project for three years at various locations | Rs. 6,99,000/- | The Technical Bids shall be opened through the online e-Procurement Portal **(https://tntenders.gov.in)** on the mentioned date at the above-mentioned address. The bidders should submit their bids only through the e-Procurement Portal **(https://tntenders.gov.in).** All other details can be seen in the tender documents, the tender documents can be downloaded at the above website. Corrigendum / Addendum to this publication, if any, would appear only on the above-said website. |

| Tender Documents Availability | E-Submission End Date | Technical Bid Opening Date |
|---|---|---|
| 14.10.2026 to 18.11.2026 upto 02.00 PM | 18.11.2026 Time 2.30 PM | 19.11.2026 Time : 3.00 PM |

DIPR/ 3099 /TENDER/2026
**General Manager (Admin),**
The Tamil Nadu Co-operative Milk Producers' Federation Limited.

**MAHATRANSCO**
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.
**NOTICE INVITING TENDER CPD/57 Corrigendum-I -2026-27**
Tenders are invited through e-Tendering in SRM Two Bid system from the registered vendors for Supply of following:

| Tender No. & Description of Material | Estimated Amount (in Rs. Lakhs) / Tender Fee (in Rs.) | Extended Due Date & Time (Hrs.) Submission & Opening of Tender |
|---|---|---|
| **SP/T-0514/1026 [RFx 5000001621] 2nd Call** for Procurement of 50MVA, 132-110/33kV (07 No.) Power Transformers along with New Uninhibited High Grade Mineral Insulating Oil for Karad Zone | 6299.71 / 25,000.00 | 19.10.2026 Upto 17:00 Hrs / 19.10.2026 Upto 17:15 Hrs |
| **CORRIGENDUM NO.1 Dt.09.10.2026** | Corrigendum due to change in Quantity in the Tender published on SRM Portal viz. **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/** and MSETCL website viz. **www.mahatransco.in.** | |

**Contact Person:** Office of the Executive Engineer (Gr-V)
CPA, C.O. MSETCL, 1st Floor, Prakashgad Building, Bandra (E), Mumbai
Tel. No.: 022-69852712/ 69852720 **Email id:** cecpa@mahatransco.in, secpa@mahatransco.in, eegrp5@mahatransco.in, eepc@mahatransco.in,
For further details visit our website **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/**
Any further amendments/clarifications will be published on the MSETCL website **www.mahatransco.in** & **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/.** Bidders are therefore requested to check these websites for further updates.
Sd/-
**Executive Engineer (P&C)**

PARIS

## French unions say 480,000 people took part in pro-student protests



REUTERS

French unions said that around 480,000 people took part in nationwide demonstrations held on Tuesday to back student protests. French authorities have not yet given their own estimate. The last nationwide rallies supporting the student movement, held on Thursday last week, saw 71,500 people turn out. AFP

JERUSALEM

## Palestinians displaced from refugee camp will not return: Netanyahu



AP

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu vowed on Tuesday that displaced residents of a Palestinian refugee camp would not be allowed to return to their homes, after the supreme court ordered the government to provide a timetable for their return. He also referred to the Tulkarm refugee camp as a "terror stronghold". AFP

LAHORE

## Six killed, 40 injured as passenger train derails in Pakistan's Punjab



AFP

A Peshawar-bound passenger train derailed in Pakistan's Punjab province on Tuesday, killing at least six people and injuring 40 others, police said. The accident occurred at around 5.15 a.m. when the Rehman Baba Express was travelling from Karachi to Peshawar, according to police information. PTI

BEIRUT

## Hezbollah announces aid for those displaced in Lebanon due to war



AFP

Hezbollah announced on Tuesday an aid programme for Lebanese who lost their homes in the war with Israel, with benefits capped at $14,000 per household, despite U.S. and Lebanese sanctions on the militant group. It will pay the assistance in four instalments over the course of a year, the head of Hezbollah's Executive Council said. AFP

# Saudi Arabia strikes oil facility in Yemen's capital, say Houthis

The group threatens to target Riyadh International Airport, a refinery, and an Aramco facility in Dammam if Saudi Arabia proceeds with the strike; Trump accuses Houthis of trying to drive up the oil prices ahead of the U.S. midterm elections

**Agence France-Presse**
SANAA

Yemen's Houthis (Ansar Allah) said Saudi Arabia struck an oil facility in Sanaa on Tuesday, after the Riyadh-led coalition told civilians to leave the surrounding area in its first evacuation order for the Yemeni capital since the war flared up again.

After a series of strikes on the kingdom's airports and energy sites, the coalition's spokesperson said people should leave an oil facility belonging to the Yemen Petroleum Company on the western outskirts of Sanaa before it was attacked.



The Saudi-led coalition's warning was its first evacuation order for Yemen's capital, Sanaa, since the war escalated again. AFP

An *AFP* correspondent in Sanaa reported hearing an explosion, while a breaking news alert on the Houthi-affiliated *Al-Masirah TV* channel said "Saudi aggression targets the oil company in Al-Sabaha, west of Sanaa".

The Saudi-led coalition is yet to confirm the reported strike.

Swiftly responding to the earlier coalition warning, the Houthis had issued a threat to target Riyadh's international airport, a refinery, and an Aramco facility in Dammam if the strike went ahead.

"The Yemeni Armed Forces urge all citizens to immediately evacuate and move away from targets that our forces will strike should the Saudi enemy target," military spokesperson Yahya Saree wrote on X, identifying the three targets.

Saudi Arabia was still weathering fresh attacks on Tuesday, with the coalition saying its forces intercepted three drones north of the kingdom's capital Riyadh.

Many countries have issued travel warnings to their citizens in Saudi Arabia, most recently France, which told its citizens to avoid the airports in Riyadh, Jeddah and Dammam on Tuesday.

Meanwhile, U.S. President Donald Trump on Tuesday accused Houthi militants of deliberately trying to drive up oil prices ahead of the midterm elections and warned that he would "never forget" their attacks on Saudi Arabia.

"The Houthis are behaving very badly," Mr. Trump wrote in a Truth Social post, accusing the group of resuming attacks at Iran's behest after a period of relative quiet following U.S. strikes in Yemen last year.

# Iran trying to hit military sites in U.K., says intel chief

**Associated Press**
LONDON

Iran is trying to hit military sites in Britain and the suspected plot to attack a U.S.-run military airbase in September is "not unique", the head of the MI5 spy agency said on Tuesday, as he warned that both Tehran and Moscow are expanding their attacks against the United Kingdom.




Ken McCallum speaks at Thames House, the headquarters of the U.K.'s Security Service in London on Tuesday. REUTERS

Ken McCallum, who leads the U.K.'s domestic security service, said Tehran is seeking to intensify its attacks in Britain beyond the traditional targets of Iranians opposed to the country's Islamic authorities. That has included arson and sabotage attacks on Jewish sites that Britain says were carried out by Iranian proxies.

Mr. McCallum said another "major shift this year has been Iranian ambitions to come at harder targets, like military sites".

The incident at RAF Fairford "is not unique. There have been other examples, not just in the U.K. but around the world," Mr. McCallum said.

He delivered his annual speech outlining major threats to the U.K. as counterterror detectives investigate a suspected terror plot against the U.S.-run base in western England, which has been used to bomb Iran during this year's war.

Prime Minister Andy Burnham said on Monday that the apparent plot was "almost certainly" directed by Iran's Revolutionary Guard though Iran has denied involvement.

## 11 sailors go missing after drone sinks ship off Bulgaria's coast

**Reuters**
SOFIA

Eleven sailors were missing at sea on Tuesday from a ship sunk by a drone attack off the coast of Bulgaria, the second deadly sinking of a cargo vessel in the area in a week, prompting Bulgaria to summon Russia's Ambassador.

Two cargo ships were hit by drones overnight and one was sunk, Bulgarian officials said. Bulgaria stopped short of explicitly accusing Russia of carrying out the attacks but Prime Minister Rumen Radev said their outcome "benefits Russian Federation".

"This is absolutely unacceptable – another attack in the immediate vicinity of Bulgarian territorial waters," Mr. Radev said.

Bulgarian Defence Minister Dimitar Stoyanov said it would be "illogical for the Ukrainians to strike their own ships".

The attacks were also condemned by Ukraine and the EU.

## Russia hits no energy targets in Ukraine for the first time since Trump's 'ceasefire'

**Reuters**
KYIV

Russia hit no Ukrainian energy targets on Tuesday for the first time since U.S. President Donald Trump's weekend announcement of an "energy ceasefire", while hammering cities' transport and logistics overnight with ballistic missiles and drones.

Russia's Defence Ministry, in its daily summary of overnight strikes, made no mention of Ukrainian energy facilities. A Kremlin spokesperson, asked about the energy ceasefire, would only say that contacts were ongoing, but declined to provide any further details. However, one missile came down just over a kilometre from a plant providing heating to much of the city of Lviv, in the west.



A police officer inspects the engine of a Shahed drone in front of a residential building damaged in a Russian strike in Kyiv. AP

Mr. Trump's ceasefire announcement on Sunday came two days after his declaration of a deal that lifted U.S. sanctions on Russian diesel exports to allow Russia to supply almost 2 million metric tonnes of diesel, a bid to lower U.S. fuel prices.

President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Tuesday that Ukraine had not hit Russian refineries for two days, since Trump announced the ceasefire, but that Russia had continued attacks on energy and critical infrastructure during that time. Russia struck six Ukrainian energy sites on Monday.

## Trump says he does not believe China, Russia helping Iran

**Reuters**
WASHINGTON

U.S. President Donald Trump said late on Monday he did not believe that China and Russia were helping Iran "at all", adding that Moscow and Beijing had "too much to lose" if they enabled Tehran.

Mr. Trump said on Truth Social that he had seen comments from his critics and opponents that China and Russia were helping Iran.

"If they are, it's at a very low level, but I don't believe they are at all. They have too much to lose, and we would know about it, and know about it very fast," Mr. Trump wrote.

Mr. Trump said in July he trusted China and Russia not to help Tehran in the Iran war, but warned that if they did get involved "it would be very bad for them".

The *Washington Post* and the *Wall Street Journal* reported in March that Russia was providing Iran with targeting information.

# Sport

## Delhi HC asks AITA and petitioners to file replies

**Sports Bureau**
VIJAYAWADA

The Delhi High Court has asked the All India Tennis Association (AITA) and the original petitioners led by former player Somdev Devvarman to file replies to the Court-appointed administrator Justice (retd.) Gita Mittal's request to implead the AITA Trust and the Delhi Lawn Tennis Association (DLTA) in the ongoing proceedings to amend the AITA's Constitution.

In the hearing held on September 25, the order of which was released recently, the Court said that rejoinders, if any, to AITA's replies should be filed by November 6, the date when the matter will be heard again.

Justice Mittal, in her report dated September 14, had alleged large-scale financial misconduct and accused the office-bearers of stonewalling requests for documents and information.

The Court has also asked the AITA to respond to the request to produce the complete minutes of the Extraordinary General Meeting held on July 26 to ratify the new Constitution in line with the National Sports Governance Act, 2025.

### Timeline extended

The timeline for the conduct of fresh elections has been extended to November 27 from the previous deadline of September 30.

The AITA had requested the extension to complete the various mandatory administrative processes in the lead-up to the elections, chief among which is the finalisation of the 40-member strong Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit (SOM) roster.

### LIVE TELECAST

**Ranji Trophy:** Day 4, JioHotstar, 9 a.m.

**India vs West Indies**: Fourth T20I, Star Sports 2 & JioHotstar, 7 p.m.

**ISL**: Sony LIV, 7.30 p.m.

**Archery Premier League:** Sony LIV, 7.45 p.m.

**Champions League:** Sony Sports Ten 1, 2 & Sony LIV, 10.15 p.m. & 12.30 a.m. (Thursday).

## Hazlewood bowls Australia to victory

AUSTRALIA IN SA

**Agence France-Presse**
DURBAN

Josh Hazlewood bagged six wickets in the second innings as Australia completed a 214-run win over South Africa on the fifth day of the first Test at Kingsmead Oval on Tuesday.

Fast bowler Hazlewood twice broke promising stands and finished with six for 49, with the home side bowled out for 206 when chasing 421.

Opening batter Aiden Markram defied the bowlers for a minute short of six hours, scoring 75 before being caught behind from an inside edge off Mitchell Starc for the penultimate wicket. The last four wickets fell for five runs in the space of 16 deliveries against the second new ball.



Jansen is undone by a Hazlewood special. AP

**The scores:** Australia 390 & 314/6 decl. bt South Africa 284 & 206 in 86.5 overs (Markram 75, Bedingham 46, Hazlewood 6/49).

## Atal's fighting ton helps Afghanistan save Test

**Agence France-Presse**
ABU DHABI

Sediqullah Atal's marathon century and lower-order resistance inspired Afghanistan to a draw in the one-off Test against Bangladesh here on Tuesday.

Having started the final day on 132 for three, Afghanistan survived to finish on 346 for eight after being set a 479-run target. Opener Atal, playing only his third Test, batted for eight-and-a-half hours for his 332-ball 111 before No. 9 Qais Ahmad hit an unbeaten 49 to save the game.

**The scores:**
Bangladesh 346 & 372/7 decl. drew with Afghanistan 240 & 346/8 in 142 overs (Atal 111, Rahmat 51, Qais 49 n.o.).

## Goalkeeper Pathak returns, Asiad core retained for ACT

HOCKEY

**Press Trust of India**
NEW DELHI

Goalkeeper Krishan Bahadur Pathak returned to the Harmanpreet Singh-led India squad while the core of the Asian Games gold-winning line-up was retained for the Asian Champions Trophy (ACT), to be held in Punjab from October 27 to November 5.

Pathak had missed the Asian Games while young defender Amandeep Lakra and midfielder Aditya Arjun Lalage have also earned an opportunity to strengthen their place in the senior set-up.

"Playing the ACT in Punjab will be something special," chief coach Craig Fulton said. "This squad blends youth with experience, and we can't wait to feed off the crowd. There's nothing like playing a tournament in India, and we've missed it."

**The squad: Goalkeepers:** Suraj Karkera, Krishan Bahadur Pathak; **Defenders:** Sanjay, Harmanpreet Singh (Capt.), Amit Rohidas, Jugraj Singh, Jarmanpreet Singh, Amandeep Lakra; **Midfielders:** Rajinder Singh, Aditya Arjun Lalage, Nilakanta Sharma, Hardik Singh, Manpreet Singh; **Forwards:** Shilanand Lakra, Abhishek, Sukhjeet Singh, Dilpreet Singh, Mandeep Singh. **Reserve/replacement players:** Vishnu Kant Singh, Angad Bir Singh.

# SUSTAINABILITY DIALOGUES

PHOTOS BY J. JOHAN SATHYADAS



**Raising queries:** A participant asking a question during a session at *The Hindu* Sustainability Dialogues 2026 in Chennai.



**Rapt attention:** Students listening to experts speak at an event centred on the theme 'Intelligent healthcare for a sustainable and human-centered future'.



**Interesting event:** Panellists, professors, and others at the event presented by Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences (SIMATS).

## *Medical students, professors should be asked to take AI course: expert*




S. Iniyan, professor and clinical head, department of psychiatry, SIMATS; Abdul Ghafur, senior consultant and adjunct professor in infectious diseases, Apollo Hospitals, Chennai; K. Ganapathy, honorary distinguished professor, IIM, Jammu and distinguished professor, The T.N. Dr. MGR Medical University with Geetha Srimathi, senior reporter, *The Hindu* at the event on Tuesday.

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

How AI is asked a question, who asks it, and what model of AI is being used can all influence the answer you receive, said Abdul Ghafur, senior consultant and adjunct professor in infectious diseases, Apollo Hospitals, Chennai.

Dr. Ghafur quoted an example: he was teaching students that vaccinations are given after a bone marrow transplant, and not before. One student looked this up on ChatGPT and told him he was wrong, and that it was possible to vaccinate before the transplant. Dr. Ghafur said he then looked it up himself and got the correct answer: not to vaccinate before. This, he said, illustrated that the way the question was framed and the model that was being used, could give two different answers.

Dr. Ghafur highlighted this phenomenon across healthcare settings, and stressed that the data fed into the tool made all the difference, along with how a question was asked. "The logic engine of an AI tool should work the way an experienced person thinks and rationalises," he said. He also added that while ChatGPT for instance, was an anthropic chatbot, there were validated, clinical prediction tools and clinical decision support decision systems in place. AI was entering our lives, he said and it was important to know how to embrace it without being replaced.

On how medical education was or should change, and how it could distinguish between genuine understanding and AI-assisted learning, K. Ganapathy, honorary distinguished professor, IIM, Jammu and distinguished professor, The T.N. Dr. MGR Medical University said that he felt medical students and professors of today must formally undergo a course in AI and that this should be made mandatory.

**AI as a substitute for therapy**

On AI being used as a substitute for therapy, S. Iniyan, professor and clinical head, department of psychiatry, Saveetha Medical College, SIMATS, said that he now got a lot of patients who used ChatGPT as a therapist first before coming to him. He noted that AI could simulate empathy and understanding very well. But how it helps is very limited, he cautioned. He said that for instance, with conditions such as OCD or anxiety, the reassurance from a chatbot could make a person feel better temporarily, but the underlying illness would fester and could delay actual treatment.

About the use of data for AI models and the inadequate representation of Indian patients and health settings, Dr. Ghafur highlighted that it was important to train systems on our data and that it was crucial to validate and calibrate on our end. He emphasised that all of this could be done in India –the expertise and specialists were already available. "We can develop India. We have enough brains. We are one of the best in the world," he pointed out.

On ensuring that AI's role in medicine is driven by patient needs rather than corporate interests, Dr. Ganapathy noted that it depended on ROI or return on interest. For him, he said, the fundamental question came down to, did AI contribute to better the outcome of healthcare for my particular patient? We are in a stage of transition, he noted, and this offered great opportunities to find a balance.

Dr. Iniyan noted the importance of regulations to be balanced in order to encourage innovation but also stay cautious.

# Sustainability means making healthcare affordable to all, says SIMATS chancellor

Speaking at *The Hindu* Sustainability Dialogues, N.M. Veeraiyan lauds the work of students and staff of Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences; other speakers highlight advantages and threats of Artificial Intelligence in healthcare and stress the need for responsible behaviour

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

True sustainability, said N.M. Veeraiyan, founder and chancellor, Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences (SIMATS), lies in protecting human life, preserving human dignity, and making quality healthcare accessible and affordable for all.

Dr. Veeraiyan was speaking at *The Hindu* Sustainability Dialogues 2026, presented by SIMATS, held on Tuesday.

Dr. Veeraiyan stressed the need for affordable healthcare and noted that the institute's research goal was to ensure that it benefited society. Dr. Veeraiyan gave the example of an app developed by the institute that allowed patients to differentiate between gastric issues and a cardiac problem.

The chancellor lauded the work of all the staff and students in ensuring that the institute was recognised as one of the top institutions in the country and in Tamil Nadu.




J. Kumutha, dean, Saveetha Medical College; Ashwani Kumar vice-chancellor (SIMATS); K. Ganapathy, honorary distinguished professor, IIM Jammu and distinguished professor, The Tamil Nadu Dr. M.G.R Medical University; N. M. Veeraiyan, chancellor, (SIMATS); S. Sundaresan, senior vice-president, advertisement, *The Hindu*; Sheeja S. Varghese, registrar (SIMATS); Dhanraj Ganapathy, dean of sustainability (SIMATS) at the event on Tuesday. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

**'Native intelligence'**

K. Ganapathy, honorary distinguished professor, IIM, Jammu, and distinguished professor, The T.N. Dr. M.G.R. Medical University, stressed the importance of 'native intelligence' over artificial intelligence (AI).

He emphasised that while there were many advantages of AI, it had a number of limitations that should be understood. He said medical students needed to be trained in statistics in great detail to be able to evaluate numbers. He also noted the problem of using Western data in algorithms that might not be applicable to India, and the fact that the socio-economic conditions of families needed to be considered in the context of treatment plans.

He urged students to treat not just the lab investigation, the scan, the tumour, or even the patient alone – but the entire family.

**'Flip side of AI'**

Dhanraj Ganapathy, dean of sustainability, SIMATS, said that AI was a powerful tool, but that its flipside included biases, as it was dependent on what was fed into it, digital hallucinations, and the threats it could potentially pose, such as the creation of synthetic viruses.

He highlighted the need for responsible behaviour by human beings, besides patience and compassion. He noted that we were entering an era of collaborative intelligence: the cold brilliance of artificial intelligence needed to be superseded by a warm, empathetic human heart.

S. Sundaresan, senior vice-president, advertisement, *The Hindu*, welcomed the gathering and said that the institution believed that meaningful dialogue on issues that impact society was an important part of media responsibility.

The Hindu Sustainability Dialogues 2026 was centred on the theme 'Intelligent healthcare for a sustainable and human-centered future'. It had two of two panels – AI-driven healthcare: innovation, ethics, accessibility and sustainability; and Human touch in the age of AI: preserving compassion, trust and ethics in modern medicine.

Ashwani Kumar, vice-chancellor, SIMATS; Sheeja S. Varghese, registrar, SIMATS; and J. Kumutha, dean, Saveetha Medical College and Hospital, also participated in the event.

# AI can improve disease detection but human oversight is needed: experts

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

Artificial intelligence (AI) can improve disease detection, expand access to healthcare, and reduce diagnostic costs, but its adoption must be backed by clinical validation, data protection and human oversight, experts said in a panel discussion in Chennai on Tuesday.

The discussion on 'Artificial Intelligence-Driven Healthcare: Innovation, Ethics, Accessibility and Sustainability' was held as part of *The Hindu* Sustainability Dialogues 2026, presented by Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences.

The panellists were Sindhuja Giritharan, Clinical Lead, Digital Health and Patient Engagement, Sundaram Medical Foundation; Richa Pant, Director, Research, Deep Tek; Reuben Fernandes, Founder & CEO, Skyfire Applied Intelligence Pvt. Limited (Atom360); and A. Hariharan, Associate Professor, Department of Transfusion Medicine, Saveetha Medical College, SIMATS.

Ms. Pant said medical imaging was among the areas where AI was making a significant difference, as digital images offered standardised data from which systems could learn patterns.

"What I have observed through my research is that AI is helping reach larger populations, particularly in areas where there is a severe shortage of radiologists and other specialists. For instance, in a study we conducted in six districts of Tamil Nadu, we saw first-hand how implementing AI in TB screening could help reach more people," she said.



Reuben Fernandes, Founder & CEO, Skyfire Applied Intelligence Pvt. Limited; A. Hariharan, Associate Professor, Department of Transfusion Medicine, Saveetha Medical College, SIMATS; Sindhuja Giritharan, Clinical Lead, Digital Health and Patient Engagement, Sundaram Medical Foundation; Richa Pant, Director, Research, Deep Tek; and Zubeda Hamid, Senior Assistant Editor, *The Hindu*.

**'Prioritise critical cases'**

AI could help hospitals prioritise critical cases rather than process scans strictly in the order in which they arrived, enabling patients requiring urgent attention to receive treatment faster, she said.

Mr. Fernandes highlighted the potential of AI to address the low uptake of cancer screening. He said less than 1% of the population was screened for cancer, while many patients sought medical attention only after symptoms appeared, by which time the disease could have advanced to Stage III or IV.

Smartphone-based tools could help identify suspicious oral lesions and direct patients to specialists for further assessment, Mr. Fernandes said, adding that deploying AI models directly on phones could also reduce dependence on internet connectivity in areas with limited infrastructure.

**Human aspects**

Dr. Giritharan said AI should enable doctors to devote more time to patients rather than replace the human aspects of healthcare. AI could assist with documentation, summarising medical histories, tracking medication adherence and processing clinical information. However, doctors would still need to explain diagnoses, understand patients' individual circumstances and help them make informed treatment decisions, she said.

"A human has to tell a human," Dr. Giritharan said, stressing the importance of personal communication, particularly when patients were anxious about a diagnosis or struggled to follow medical advice because of financial or family circumstances.

She also called for greater emphasis on preventive healthcare. AI-assisted reminders and digital follow-ups could help doctors monitor patients with chronic conditions such as diabetes between consultations, identify difficulties in adhering to treatment and intervene when necessary, Dr. Giritharan added.

Mr. Hariharan, said there was a need for clinicians to understand the limitations of AI systems and recognise when their recommendations should not be followed. He cautioned that patient information could not be shared indiscriminately with AI systems. While the Digital Personal Data Protection Act and medical device regulations provided relevant frameworks, he said clearer safeguards were needed.

The session was moderated by Zubeda Hamid, Senior Assistant Editor, *The Hindu*.

## SIMATS students on AI

"AI is everywhere....however, its use and application in healthcare are very different to its use in other fields... But its most effective use lies in combining it with human touch



**ADWAITH P.**
Bachelor of Occupational Therapy



"I think AI will push people to learn more. AI should help people develop a logical understanding, but providing empathy should remain a human responsibility

**TEJASWI K.**
B.Sc. Biomedical Sciences

"AI can help researchers and therapists develop specialised tech for individual patients. AI chatbots should not be depended upon for medical advice: there is a danger of erroneous recommendations and wrong advice



**ALEX V. GEORGE**
Bachelor of Occupational Therapy

"I want to pursue neuroscience after this, and I think AI will play a prominent role in the field. AI can map out things and perform analyses that would take humans a long time to do. We must learn to use AI responsibly



**SHRESTHA B.**
B.Sc. Biomedical Sciences



"AI's abilities to develop technology for gadgets and help with treatment holds a lot of potential. In the future, it could make possible things that we can't imagine today

**ROSHAN SAJI VARGHESE**
Bachelor of Occupational Therapy

"Occupational therapy is largely based on hands-on experience and direct interactions between therapists and their clients. The important thing is to use AI logically and appropriately, rather than relying on generative AI for everything



**SAHANA S.**
B.Sc. Occupational Therapy

LESSON LEARNT

## Until the umpire signals a four, I will keep running: Tilak



PTI

Tilak Varma addressed the run-out in Indore, which had been much discussed. “There was a flash on the advertising board. I felt that the ball touched the board and came back inside. Axar [Patel] felt the same, so we both stopped. Going forward, until the umpire signals a boundary, I will just keep running!”

SUCCESS FORMULA

## Our players need to adapt when the pressure is on: Sammy



PTI

Daren Sammy dismissed the notion that West Indies was overdependent on Shai Hope, pointing to contributions from Brandon King (ODIs), Shimron Hetmyer and Sherfane Rutherford (T20Is). “Some of our players need to adapt to that calmness when the pressure is on. But Hope is not the only reason we win.”

DOUBLE DELIGHT

## Gill wins a record fifth ICC PoTM award; Shafali, too, tops



FILE PHOTO: EMMANUAL YOGINI

India captain Shubman Gill was on Tuesday named ICC men’s Player of the Month for a record fifth time after his outstanding performance in the ODI series against the West Indies. Opener Shafali Verma bagged the women’s honour for her impressive show in the Asia Cup and Asian Games.

HIGH-PROFILE SIGNING

## Yuvraj appointed Delhi Capitals assistant and batting coach



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

A week after Sourav Ganguly’s appointment as head coach, Delhi Capitals roped in another high-profile name in Yuvraj Singh on Tuesday as part of its support staff for the 2027 Indian Premier League season. The 44-year-old Yuvraj joins Capitals as assistant coach and batting coach.

# India and WI willow-wielders glove up for another blast

The host is one win away from sealing a series victory; the Men in Blue scored 297 the last time they took strike here in a T20I; Shreyas & Co. will need to iron out chinks in the bowling department; the visitor has been far from a pushover

WI IN INDIA

**Anirudh Velamuri**
HYDERABAD

The story so far has been more about fireworks than finesse.

In Lucknow, Shreyas Iyer’s maiden T20I hundred powered India to victory in 14.4 overs. Ranchi brought a jolt, as Shai Hope and Sherfane Rutherford ended the host’s run of 10 straight wins in completed T20Is. Indore swung it back, with Abhishek Sharma and Arshdeep Singh engineering a 14-run triumph.

Now the series moves to the Rajiv Gandhi International Stadium on Wednesday, which has long been kind to T20 batters. In India’s last outing here, against Bangladesh in October 2024, it ended three runs short of 300. It is also home to Sunrisers Hyderabad, the IPL’s most trigger-happy side.

The host will lean on a top-order that has taken turns to blaze away. While the West Indies has struggled to contain the firepower, it has been far from a pushover. That said, it will need a more complete performance to unsettle the reigning world champion and keep the series alive.



**Dynamites:** Southpaws Kishan and Rutherford can pack a punch. K.R. DEEPAK

Only one match out of six on this tour has been won while defending a total, when India did so in Indore, where dew stayed away and made a difference for the Indian bowlers.

It could be the same case in Hyderabad too, which has seen average temperatures vary between 31-34 °C the last few days.

Bowling is India’s big question, especially in the absence of pace ace Jasprit Bumrah. It couldn’t defend 249 in Ranchi and head coach Gautam Gambhir flagged concerns over white-ball pitches after the run-fest.

The surface in Hyderabad adds another twist to the contest. Its top layer has been re-laid (with an 80-20 black-red soil mix), and how differently it will play, if at all, remains to be seen.

Either way, bowlers will be tested in a format where, to borrow from Keemo Paul, they either get to execute their plans or get executed.

Arshdeep’s three wickets carried India home in Indore, Naman Dhir, too, proved clinical, providing the side with another useful bowling option. For the visitor, Roston Chase leads the bowling charts and will relish another crack at Abhishek, whom he has dismissed twice in 13 balls this series.

A series win is within touching distance for India but the Windies have the nerve to make the host sweat. Between them lies a strip of freshly laid earth and 40 overs that will remember who blinked first.

*Match starts at 7 p.m.*

## ‘You can’t hit from the first ball in T20s’

**Anirudh Velamuri**
HYDERABAD

The Rajiv Gandhi International Stadium will open its arms for a few homegrown stars in an Indian team looking to cement its lead in the five-match T20I series against the West Indies.

Local lad Tilak Varma is aware of Uppal’s flat surfaces that have seen gargantuan T20 scores.

“We were discussing that the wickets here have been changed. But in T20s, you can’t go from the first ball. We’ve played everywhere.

“Each player has played more than 50 games in the format. You take one or two balls and get to know how the wicket is behaving, what shots to play and more,” Tilak said on Tuesday, the eve of the fourth T20I.

Happiest in the No. 3 spot, Tilak said he was happy to be malleable to the team’s demands.

“Right now my role is to handle the middle phase. If quick wickets go, I can take my time and take the game deep.

“If the top three bat till the 14th or 15th over, I know how to change gears and go from the first ball. I’ve been practising for both.”



Tilak. K.R. DEEPAK

The 23-year-old blitzed away to an unbeaten 44 off just 18 balls in Ranchi before a 16-ball 28 in Indore.

Tilak was in good spirits ahead of a fixture that could potentially decide the series and was happy that so many members in the setup are familiar with conditions in Hyderabad.

“Yes, we’ll have a slight edge. Ishan [Kishan], Nitish [Kumar], Abhishek and myself have played here many times. More than me, the others have played here more because every year they play half of their IPL games here. So they know how the wicket behaves, how the outfield is and more”.

## We have to win both PowerPlays: Sammy

**Anirudh Velamuri**
HYDERABAD

West Indies head coach Daren Sammy felt that the PowerPlay had been the difference between his side and India this T20I series. He pointed out that India had scored at nearly 14.5 runs per over in that period and Windies had restricted the scoring rate to below 10 in subsequent phases.

“We have had to pull the game back every single time. That [PowerPlay] is an area we need to work on. To beat India in India, you really have to win both PowerPlays, with bat and ball,” he said.

According to Sammy, the Men in Maroon have matched India’s batting muscle. He referred to bowling coach Ravi Rampaul’s observation that letting the opposition hit more fours than sixes would save two runs each time. “We out-sixed them in the last game. When you play on good batting pitches, you feel you are in the game. You are just two big overs away from getting yourself back into it.”

The challenge, he believes, is greater for the bowlers. “If 200 is a par score, you have to prevent the opposition from getting to 250”.

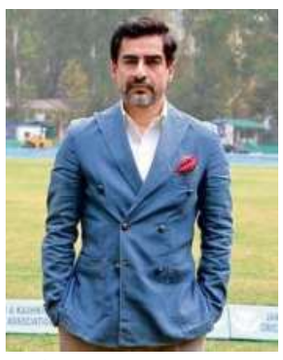
## ‘Fitness and form should be the criteria for selection, not age’

**Shayan Acharya**
SRINAGAR

Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma’s selection for the 2027 ODI World Cup should depend on fitness and performances, and not their age, said BCCI president Mithun Manhas.

“As far as the BCCI is concerned, we are not in a position to comment because it all depends on the selectors and the coaches. But from how I look at it, fitness and performance should be the criteria for selection, and definitely not age,” he told *The Hindu*.

“If somebody is fit to play, and you see him performing and winning games for the country, that is the only criterion we should focus on.”



Manhas. IMRAN NISSAR

**Experience vital**

Manhas believes experience will be vital as Shubman Gill prepares to lead India in the next ODI World Cup. He said the presence of Kohli, Rohit and Hardik Pandya could help Gill manage the demands of captaincy alongside Jasprit Bumrah’s leadership within the bowling group.

“Having Virat, Hardik and Rohit in the side will definitely help him. Then there is Bumrah, who could be the bowling captain, and somebody who could be the fielding captain. It’s all about distribution of workload,” Manhas said.

He felt that seniors could be crucial when the team comes under pressure, drawing on their experience in handling tough situations.

“They have been under pressure and delivered so many times in crunch situations. So, it’s valuable,” he said.

Manhas also backed India’s growing player-pool as a means of managing an increasingly demanding international calendar. With overlapping assignments and injuries posing challenges, he said the depth would help the team across formats.

## Gibson does it for Royals; Marathas, Knights shine

APL

**Sports Bureau**
HYDERABAD

Defending champion Rajputana Royals, after a run of poor results, made it back-to-back wins with a dominant display against high-flying Chero Archers in the Archery Premier League season 2 at People’s Plaza on Tuesday. Royals, who suffered three straight losses before tasting success on Monday, were in superb form as they blanked Archers 6-0.

The result moved Royals to six points and kept them in the race for a semifinal berth. Archers, too, have six points. Mighty Marathas and Kakatiya Knights moved clear at the top of the table with eight points each. While the former defeated Prithviraj Yodhas 6-2, Knights blanked Chola Chiefs 6-0.



**Royal show:** Gibson struck the 10-ring on all six occasions during the day. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

**Dhiraj dazzles**

Marathas’ recurve star Dhiraj Bommadevara was in terrific form, repeatedly shooting clutch 10s with barely any time left on the clock. Mike Schloesser set up the sets well and finished with 78 out of 80 as Marathas’ resurgence continued. They were placed on top ahead of Knights, with only set points separating the sides.

In the final match, Knights consigned Chiefs to the bottom of the table as Nico Wiener and Neeraj Chauhan were in terrific form at the start and end of the sets – both registering 59 out of 60 – while Spain’s recurve archer Elia Canales provided able support. In Jyothi Surekha’s absence, Avneet Kaur also stepped in admirably for the home franchise.

Earlier, Royals’ star was compound World No. 1 Ella Gibson, who produced a stupendous show and came up with six perfect 10s.

Archers, who went back to their recurve international archer Casey Kaufhold instead of Kumkum Mohod, lost the first set 73-74 after the American started with a 7. In the second set, Royals edged ahead 76-75 with the Chero side paying the price for a couple of 9s from their compound archers. The third set was tied 58-58 after six arrows each when Atanu Das hit a rare 8.

For Royals, Sangeeta, playing her first match in place of Ankita Bhakat, responded with a sensational 10. With 8 needed, Tokyo Olympic champion Mete Gazoz delivered a 9.

**The scores:**

Rajputana Royals bt Chero Archers 6-0 (74-73, 76-75, 77-75).
Mighty Marathas bt Prithviraj Yodhas 6-2 (76-74, 77-73, 70-78, 76-75).
Kakatiya Knights bt Chola Chiefs 6-0 (74-73, 79-78, 77-75).

## There’s nothing you can’t achieve: Rai senior’s advice

GOLF

**Ashwin Achal**
NEW DELHI

After carrying the bag for his wife, Gaurika Bishnoi, at last year’s Hero Women’s Indian Open, Aaron Rai is back in the National Capital Region this year – this time to compete himself.

The 31-year-old’s profile has risen considerably since his last visit to these shores. In May, Rai stunned the golfing world by winning the PGA Championship, becoming the first Englishman to lift the title since Jim Barnes in 1919.

One of the leading contenders at this week’s DP World India Championship, Rai acknowledged that the historic triumph had changed his life.

The soft-spoken Englishman, regarded as one of the nicest men on the tour, attributes much of his success to his parents, Amrik and Dalvir, who are of Indian descent. Despite their limited financial means, they made significant sacrifices to support their son’s golfing ambitions.

His father, in particular, instilled in him the belief that there were no limits to what he could achieve. “There is nothing that you cannot achieve – that was my father’s big message. There shouldn’t be any limitations, no matter where you’re from, no matter what you have or don’t have,” Rai said at a press conference at the Delhi Golf Club here on Tuesday.



**Tryst with history:** Rai stunned the golfing world by winning the PGA Championship. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



Rai. REUTERS

“Society can put you into boxes of what you can and cannot achieve, which creates limitations. But if you are really diligent and disciplined, every single person has a huge amount of potential that can be fulfilled,” he added.

Rai is among a rare breed of golfers who uses iron covers to appreciate the true value of his equipment. More broadly, he has sought to remain grounded and approachable, holding on to the values instilled in him.

“I think every person has that responsibility to try and be warm, and try to set good examples. We don’t understand the positivity that can create for someone else and the ripple effect that can have,” he said.

## उत्तराखण्ड परिवहन निगम मुख्यालय
परिवहन भवन, द्वितीय तल, कुल्हान, देहरादून, उत्तराखण्ड

निविदा संख्या–225/2026/नि.मु./वॉल्वो बस/26 दिनांक: 13.10.2026

**ई-निविदा सूचना**

उत्तराखण्ड परिवहन निगम द्वारा निजी बस स्वामियों/फर्मो से बी.एस 06 नयी वॉल्वो बसें (Air Conditioned Volvo Multi Axle 4x2 BS-VI 2x2 Seats)12.2 Meter अनुबन्ध पर संचालन हेतु निम्न कार्यक्रमानुसार निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती हैं:–

| निविदा जमा करने की अन्तिम तिथि | समय |
|---|---|
| 04–11–2026 | ऑनलाईन 15:00 बजे तक |
| 04–11–2026 | ऑफलाईन 16:00 बजे तक |
| 19–10–2026 | प्री–बिड बैठक 14:00 बजे |

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SIIDCUL invites separate online bids from eligible bidders through e-tendering for the below mentioned works at IIE Haridwar and SIDC bahadrabad, Uttarakhand. Bids are invited through a single-stage single-envelop system. All the Tender-related information will be available on www.uktenders.gov.in & www.siidcul.com from 12.10.2026. The tender details are given below:-

| S. No. | Description of Work | No. of Tenders/ Works | Time line |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Maintenance of drain, kerbstone, and footpath at IIE SIIDCUL Haridwar | 01 | **Bid Start Date -** 12.10.2026 **Last Date -** 26.10.2026 |
| 2 | Maintenance of roads by patchwork and repair of drains at SIDC Bahadrabad, Haridwar | 01 | |

**Regional Manager**

## Public Health Engineering Department
Public Health Engineering Division, Sherghati
Govt. of Bihar

**VERY SHORT TENDER NIT No – 01/2026-27(R3)/O&M-PHED**
**National Competitive Bidding**
(Through e-procurement mode on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Designation and Address of Advertiser | Executive Engineer, P. H. Division, Sherghati. |
| 2 | Date of issue of Tender Notice | 12.10.2026 |
| 3 | Period of sale (downloading) of tender Bid Document | 26.10.2026 to 30.10.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in |
| 4 | Date, time & place of pre-bid meeting | 27.10.2026 at 12:00 hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer, P. H. Division, Sherghati |
| 5 | Last date and time of receipt (uploading) of tender | 30.10.2026 up to 15:00Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in |
| 6 | Date and time of opening of technical bid | 30.10.2026 at 16:30Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in |
| 7 | Date and time of opening of financial bid | To be informed later after the approval of technical bid. |

**8. Details of works:**

| Group No | Name of Work | Estimated Cost (in Lakh) | Amount of Earnest Money (in Lakh) | Cost of Tender Document (non-refundable) in Rs. | BSEDC Bid Processing Fee (in Rs.) | Completion Period (in months) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 |
| 1. | Comprehensive operation and maintenance, routine repairs and Special repairs of i.) Rural Piped Water Supply Scheme (PWS- 6 Nos.), ii.) Single Village piped water supply schemes (SVS- 0), iii.) Ward level Piped Water Supply Schemes in quality affected wards (WLS_Quality- 54 Nos.) and iv.) Ward level Piped Water Supply Schemes in non quality affected wards (WLS_Non Quality- 369 Nos.) based on item rates; constructed by the Public Health Engineering Department including payment to the pump operators, electricity bills for five years. | 4268.648 | 52.700 | 10000.00 | As Per Beltron | 60 Months |

For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

PR- 013555 ( PHED ) 2026-27

**Executive Engineer**
**Public Health Division, Sherghati**

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

## OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER CONSTRUCTION DIVISION (E/M), U.P. JAL NIGAM (NAGARIYA)
15 SHANTI NIKETAN, MEERUT

Letter No.: 1364/Nivida/107 Dated:12.10.2026

**E-TENDER NOTICE**

U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) invites E-bids for execution of: **"Operation and Maintenance of 50 K.L.D. Co-Treatment Plant in Meerut City for period of 36 months(3 Year) under 15th Finance commission (Deposit Programm)."** are invited in two bid system on percentage basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-bid documents will be available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal https://etender.up.nic.in and U.P.J.N. (Urban) website www.jn.upsdc.gov.in for download from dated 16.10.2026 from 05:00 PM. E-bids can be submitted till 30.10.2026 up to 05:00 PM and technical bid shall be opened on 31.10.2026 at 03:00 PM in the office of undersigned in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender cost is Rs. 5000.00 + GST @ 18% for tender. Details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal http://etender.up.nic.in & U.P.J.N.(Urban) website www.jn.upsdc.gov.in.

## UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
## OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION JAMMU EAST

**SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER**
**Short e-NIT No. 67 of 2026-2027/Jammu East Dated 10-10-2026**

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State / Central Govt. for each of the following works :-

| S. No | Name of Work | Name Of Division | Advertised Cost (in Lacs) | Cost of document (In Rs) | Earnest Money (In Rs) | Time Allowed for Complete-on | Time and date of opening Of tender | Class of Contractor |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 |
| 1 | Construction of 7 Nos. single storeyed 1BHK residential accomodation including all civil, electrical and plumbing work with new sewer line connection along with const. of electric panel room and other allied works at JK House Raja Ji Marg New Delhi. | PWD (R&B) Division Jammu | **211.85** | 6000 | 2% of the Advertised Cost | 12 Months | (1300 Hrs) on or after 28-10-2026 | "A" Class |

**Position of AAA/ TS : Accorded**

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen / downloaded from the departmental website http://jktenders.gov.in as per below schedule :-

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Date of Issue of Tender Notice | 10-10-2026 |
| 2 | Period of downloading of bidding documents | From 10-10-2026 to 27-10-2026 upto 1800 Hrs |
| 3 | Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting | 22-10-2026 at 1200Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Jammu East |
| 4 | Bid submission Start Date | 10-10-2026 |
| 5 | Bid Submission End Date | **27-10-2026 upto 1800 Hrs** |
| 6 | Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online) | **28-10-2026 on or after 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Jammu East** |
| 7 | Date & time of opening of Financial Bids | To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed |

**Executive Engineer**
**PWD (R&B) Division**
**Jammu East**

**DIP/J-12313/26**

## TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
**OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER TENDER NOTICE**

ADV No.38/D3/CE/TTD/2026-27, NIT No.96 to 98 /SE-I/TTD/ 2026-27 dt:13-10-2026

**NAME OF WORK:**(1) Construction of additional floors over existing two hostel blocks with precast concrete technology in SPW College campus at Tirupati **Amount Rs.2739.20 Lakhs,Time for Completion:15 months.** (2) Modification and Improvements of Bhudevi Hostel Block in SPW Degree & PG College at Tirupati **Amount Rs.574.96 Lakhs, Time for Completion:12 months,**(3) Modification and Improvements of Sridevi Hostel Block in SPW Degree & PG College at Tirupati **Amount Rs.565.89 Lakhs,Time for Completion:12 months. NOTE:** For full details, log on to the Website **https://www.tirumala.org.**

TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.215) Date:13-10-2026 **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

## GOVERNMENT OF GOA
CAPTAIN OF PORTS DEPARTMENT, PANAJI - GOA

**E-TENDER NOTICE (E-Tendering Mode Only)**

**Tender Notice No:MS/F-115/SDV-HB&GD/2025-26/3937 Dated:12/10/2026**

Sale of Department Vessels **"MV Hopper Barge COP II PNJ 693 & Priestman Grab Dredger – II"** on "as is where is, what is basis and no complaint basis" (2nd Call), from Indian Buyers.

| EMD | Tender Document Cost | Processing Fee |
|---|---|---|
| ₹8,00,000/- | ₹4,000/- | ₹3,000/- |

Payment mode: e-Payment only (NEFT/RTGS/net banking)

| Last date of online submission | 04/11/2026, up to 17:00 Hrs |
|---|---|

Tender documents & details: **eprocure.goa.gov.in | www.ports.goa.gov.in**
Ph: 0832-2225070 / 2426109 | cpt-port.goa@nic.in

**-sd-**
**Captain of Ports, Panaji - Goa**

**DI/ADVT/1703/2026.**

## Government of Uttarakhand, Department of Higher Education
No. :– 439094 / XXIV-C-1/2026-E-42533/01(08)2020 08 October, 2026

**NOTICE FOR INVITING APPLICATIONS FOR THE APPOINTMENT OF VICE- CHANCELLOR OF SOBAN SINGH JEENA UNIVERSITY, ALMORA**

The Uttarakhand Government has announced the appointment for the post of Vice Chancellor at Soban Singh Jeena University Almora. Under the provisions mentioned in Section 10(1) of the Soban Singh Jeena University Act, 2019 and as per conditions stipulated in UGC Notification dated 18.07.2018; applications are invited for the appointment on the one post of Vice Chancellor with a pay scale of Rs. 2,10,000 and a special allowance of Rs. 11,250.00, with total emoluments of Rs. 2,21,250.00.

2- The Vice Chancellor will be appointed from individuals possessing the highest level of efficiency, integrity, morality, and commitment to the institution. Eligible candidates must have at least 10 years of experience as a professor in a university or 10 years of educational leadership experience in a recognized research or educational administrative organization. The applicant should be a distinguished academician with relevant experience.

3 - The age of the person applying for the post of Vice-Chancellor shall not be more than 65 years.

4- "Applicants/post-holders fulfilling the eligibility criteria must submit their applications online on the Samarth Portal URL (https://vcrec.samarth.ac.in/) within 15 days from the date of issuance of this advertisement, by 6:00 PM. The application must be filled out completely in the prescribed format, accompanied by the attached declaration form, along with photocopies of all relevant eligibility documents based on the said conditions—including proof of date of birth, appointment order to the post of Professor, date of joining, and certificates related to the pay scale for the post of Professor.

Additionally, one hard copy along with all supporting documents must be sent via Speed Post or Registered Post to the **Office of the Secretary, Department of Higher Education, Government of Uttarakhand, Election Office, 1st Floor, Vishwakarma Bhawan, 04 Subhash Road, Dehradun.**

**Prescribed Format**

| Name & Address | Date of Birth | Age as on date of Publication of advertisement | Education/ Qualification | Position held Presently | Date of Joining on Post of Professor and Equivalent | Teaching/Past Position held (From -To) Experience | | | Administrative Experience | | | Awards/ Patents/ Recognition | Publication/ Research Work | Remarks |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | Post | Duration | | Post | Duration | | | | |
| | | | | | | | From | To | | From | To | | | |
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 |

(Dr. B.V.R.C. Purushottam)
Secretary

## Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited
(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
**(ISO 9001 : 2015 Certified)**
1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No.1, Telibandha, Raipur (C.G.)- 492006
CIN: U45203CT1981SG001853, PAN: AABCM6288N, GST Reg. No. 22AABCM6288N5ZY
Phone: 0771-6621000 Fax: 0771-2583794
Website: www.csidc.in, Email address:csidc.cg@nic.in, csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

**SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER [1st Call]**
**(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)**

NIT No : 17/CSIDC/E.E./Division-III/2026-27 Raipur, Dated 09/10/2026

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Ltd., Raipur (CSIDC), a Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking constituted under the Companies Act, engaged in Industrial Infrastructure Development & Other Related Activities in the State invites online tender in "**Form-B" (Item Rate Basis)** for the following work:-

| S. No | Name of Work | Registered Contractor in CGPWD or in appropriate class in other dep't | Time allowed | Probable Amount of Contract (PAC) (INR Lacs) | EMD (INR Lacs) | Cost of Tender Document (Including GST 18%) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Repair, Maintenance, Painting, Ground Trimming and Levelling Works of Stage, Convention Centre, Boundary Wall and Exterior Areas at Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee Udyog Avam Vyapar Parisar, Nava Raipur, Atal Nagar (C.G.), in connection with Rajyotsav 2026. | Class-D & Above | 01 Month | 47.97 | 36,000/- | 3540/- |

The tender document containing detailed terms & conditions, scope of works and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in from **09/10/2026** Time 17:01 and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

**NOTE:-** The interested tenderers for online submission of tender may contact CG e-Proc Helpdesk. Operated by **Mjunction Services Limited,** they may reach Helpdesk using 18004199140 (from 9 AM to 11 PM) (therein press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at Helpdesk.eproc@cgswan.gov.in.

**S-49421/3** **Executive Engineer (Division-III)**

कार्यालय एवं दुकान हेतु स्थान उपलब्ध, वेबसाईट देखें www.csidc.in

## KERALA STATE POLLUTION CONTROL BOARD
Head Office, Pattom P.O., Thiruvananthapuram - 695 004
Web: www.kspcb.kerala.gov.in
email: kspcbendosulfan@gmail.com

Ref No: KSPCB/1939/2023-SEE-2 Date: 13/10/2026

**NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)**

Kerala State Pollution Control Board (KSPCB) invites Expression of Interest (EoI) from authorized and eligible operators/agencies having operational integrated HazardousWastes Treatment, Storage, and Disposal Facilities (HWTSDF)/Hazardous waste incineration facility with high-temperature hazardous waste incineration capabilities for the safe packaging, loading, inter-state transportation, treatment, and scientific disposal of legacy Endosulfan waste stocks stored at the various cashew estates of Plantation Corporation of Kerala Limited in the state of Keralam.

**For further details please refer to web link:** https://kspcb.kerala.gov.in/tenders

**Contact Officer & Queries:**
Chief Environmental Engineer,
Kerala State Pollution Control Board
E-mail: kspcbendosulfan@gmail.com
Mob. No.: 9447975729

**Last Date for Submission of EOI:** 27-10-2026

**(Sd/-) Member Secretary**
Kerala State Pollution Control Board,
Thiruvananthapuram.

## APSRTC
REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) FOR SELECTION OF OPERATOR FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE OF 1450 AC (9M/12M) ELECTRIC BUSES AND DEVELOPMENT OF ALLIED ELECTRICAL AND CIVIL INFRASTRUCTURE FOR CHARGERS ON GCC (Dry Lease & Wet Lease)

e-tenders are invited from the interested bidders for procurement, supply, operation and maintenance of 1450 AC Electric buses (9M/12M) and development of allied electrical and civil infrastructure for chargers on Gross Cost Contract (GCC) model - dry lease & wet lease, at 29 depots of APSRTC. **(1)** Bids shall be submitted in the e-commerce portal of MSTC. **(2)** Start date for submission of bids: **09-11-2026 from 10.00 hrs. (3)** Last date for submission of bids: **24-11-2026 up to 17.00 hrs. (4)** For full details visit our website **http://www.apsrtc.ap.gov.in** (Tenders) and MSTC Portal **https://www.mstcecommerce.com/eproc. (5)** APSRTC reserves the right to cancel this notification without assigning any reason.

TENDER NOTICE NO: APSRTC/C&B-03/2026-27-MED, Dt,13-10-2026 **Sd/-Chief Mechanical Engineer(C&B)**

## PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
**(Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala)**
**Corporate Identification Number (CIN): U40109PB2010SGC033813**
**Website: www.pspcl.in**
**(Contact Number 9646123323)**

**Tender Inquiry No. PPR - 14/ 2026** **Dated: 13.10.2026**

Chief Engineer/PP&R Organization, Shed No. D-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites E-tender under three part bid system for supply of electrical energy (RE-Solar) from interstate/intrastate sources viz. Generators, Traders having Valid Inter State Trading License issued by CERC for interstate trading of energy, intrastate trading license issued by PSERC for intrastate trading of energy, State Electricity Boards, State Electricity Utilities, States, IPPs & CPPs from 1st November 2026 to 31st March 2027. The link for the e-Bidding portal is www.mstcecommerce.com and is also available on the website of Ministry of Power (www.Powermin.nic.in) and PFC Consultancy Limited (www.pfcindia.com). For detailed NIT & tender specifications please refer to **www.mstcecommerce.com** from 13.10.2026 onwards.

**Note:-** Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **www.mstcecommerce.com.**

**C 977/26** **1079/12/2026-27/16127**

## INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, B&R Division, HPPWD **Sangrah**, District **Sirmaur**, H.P. on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh invites the **percentage rates bids**, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class of Contractors registered with HPPWD for the works detailed in the table.

| Sr. No | Name of Work | Estimated Cost (₹) | Starting Date for Downloading Bid | Earnest Money (₹) | Deadline for Submission of Bid |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
| 1. | **Construction of balance work of 165.00 mtr Span Double lane Bridge on Nahan Dadahu Haripurdhar Road at RD 35/690.(SH:-C/O of approach road along with M/T) Under CRF (Job No. CRF-HP-2018-19-155)** | 56082510/- | 13.10.2026 | **1324000/-** | 28.10.2026 |

Bidders are advised to submit their bids as per instructions issued by the Engineer-in-Chief, HPPWD Shimla vide his office letter No. PW/CTR/32-20/Genl. Inst. CPWD/2020-19111-210 dated 25.10.2021 **and even file letter No. 37996-38095 dated 13.03.2023** in compliance of the Principal Secretary (PW) to the Government of Himachal Pradesh guidelines dated 07.10.2021 in continuation to notification issued by the Additional Chief Secretary (PW) to the Govt. of HP vide notification No. PBW(B)A(3)1/2020 dated 22.7.2020. Tenders are called on percentage rates as per directions of the Chief Engineer (SZ), HPPWD Shimla conveyed vide letter No. PW-CTR-29-Misc/2023-36299-329 dated 16.02.2023. Amendment as per the Engineer-in-Chief letter No. PW-CTR-32-20/Tender Document/26-15061-85 dated 17.07.2026 will be applicable.

The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website www.hptenders.gov.in.

**Executive Engineer,**
**HPPWD (B &R) Division Sangrah.**
**Tel/Fax: 01702-248207**
**E-mail:** ee-san-hp@nic.in
**On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh**
**him suchana avam jan sampark**

*HP / 4076/26-27*

## BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Assistant Director (AH), KR Puram, Old Madras, Bengaluru-560036

**No: GBA/BECC/AD(AH)/PR/110/ 2026-27** **Date: 13-10-2026**

**NOTIFICATION**

**Sub:** Regarding quotation from interested parties for supplying an animal incinerator to the Animal Husbandry Department of Bengaluru East City Corporation.

In connection with the above matter, it is necessary to dispose of the dead animals (small animals and large animals) in the jurisdiction of Bengaluru East City Corporation scientifically. In this context, it is proposed to set up an animal crematorium in the jurisdiction of the Corporation during the year 2026-27 by the Animal Husbandry Department. Interested parties are requested to submit their price proposals for the cost (including GST) of the said animal incinerator in a sealed envelope to the above address by **21-10-2026** at **5:00** pm.

Interested parties may obtain details by sending a request to **adahkrp01@gmail.com** or directly from the Assistant Director (Animal Husbandry), Bengaluru East City Corporation, K.R.Puram, Old Madras Road, Bengaluru – 560036

**Sd/- Assistant Director (AH)**
**BECC, GBA**

## Uttarakhand Urban Sector Development Agency (UUSDA)
**Urban Development Department, Government of Uttarakhand**
**777, Saatvik Tower, Kaulagarh Road, Rajendra Nagar, Dehradun**
**Telephone +91-135-2753894, Tele-fax +91- 135-2754895**
**Email: uusdip@gmail.com, Website: www.uusdip.org**

Adv. No: UUSDA/P-112/1724 Date: 13.10.2026

**NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)**

The **"Program Director"**, Uttarakhand Urban Sector Development Agency (UUSDA), Government of Uttarakhand" **(the Employer)** invites online bids through the Uttarakhand State e-procurement portal https://uktenders.gov.in from eligible Bidders for the execution of the works as detailed below:

| S. No. | Name of Work | Package No. | Last Date & Time of Submission |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | **Development of Interception and Diversion works with Sewage Treatment Plant (STPs) with 5 years of O&M for Pithoragarh Town, Uttarakhand** | WW-PTH-01 | **29.10.2026 upto 03:00 PM (15:00 Hrs.) IST** |

| | |
|---|---|
| Publishing Date of Bid document | **15.10.2026 at 05:00 PM, (17:00 Hrs.) IST** |
| Date of Pre-Bid Meeting | **22.10.2026 at 12:00 Noon, (12:00 Hrs.) IST** |
| Bid Submission Start Date | **23.10.2026 at 03:00 PM, (15:00 Hrs.) IST** |
| Last date for submission of original tender fee & EMD in the office of Bid inviting officer | **27.10.2026 upto 03:00 PM, (15:00 Hrs.) IST** |
| Bid Submission Closing & Last Date/Time for downloading of the Bid document | **29.10.2026 at 03:00 PM, (15:00 Hrs.) IST** |
| Bid Opening Date and time | **29.10.2026 at 04:00 PM, (16:00 Hrs.) IST** |

The prospective bidders can download the detailed bidding document and upload the bid on the website, https://uktenders.gov.in. Program Director, UUSDA reserves the right to reject any or all the proposals or to cancel the entire process without assigning any reasons thereof. Further details of the bid document including subsequent addendum/corrigendum/cancellation etc. may be downloaded from the website https://uktenders.gov.in.

**Program Director**
**UUSDA**

"हमारा संकल्प आपका सहयोग बेहतर कल"

## OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, GANGA JAL PROJECT UNIT, U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)
PRATAP VIHAR, GHAZIABAD.

Letter No.: 1716/Nivida/97 Dated:13.10.2026

**E-TENDER NOTICE**

U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) online e-tenders for execution of **"C.C. Road Work at Primary Treatment Works under 50 Cusec Water Supply Scheme"** Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage rate basis from eligible reputed and experienced bidders.

E-tender documents will be available for download from 17.10.2026 at 17:00 Hrs., Pre- Bid meeting will be held on dated 24.10.2026 at 14:30 hrs. in the office of under signed. E-bid can be submitted till 17.11.2026 up to 17:00 Hrs. and technical bid shall be opened on 18.11.2026 at 14:00 Hrs. in the office of The Executive Engineer, Gangajal Project Unit, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Ghaziabad in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E- tender Cost is Rs. 5000.00 + GST @18%. Details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal http://etender.up.nic.in& U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) website www.jn.upsde.gov.in.

READ
FRONTLINE
LEADING THE DEBATE SINCE 1984
EVERY FORTNIGHT.
TO SUBSCRIBE, VISIT
www.thehindugroup.in/subscribe

## New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Main Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B. Nagar, (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

**E-TENDER NOTICE**

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on NOIDA Authority's official website: **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** & **http://etender.up.nic.in.** Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

**(A)**

1. **32/GM(E/M)/SM(E/M)-I/E.T./2026-27,** Internal Electrification of newly constructed Building and Strengthening of Street light in Bus Terminal Sec-90, Noida. Cost Rs. 69.69 Lacs.
2. **34/GM(E/M)/SM(E/M)-I/E.T./2026-27,** Annual Maintenance of High Mast Light and Transformer in Sector-138, 140, 140A, 141, 141A, 142, 143, 143A, 143B and Village Shahdra, Garhi Shahdra, Illahabans, Nayagoan, Noida. Cost Rs. 48.85 Lacs.
3. **35/GM(E/M)/SM(E/M)-I/E.T./2026-27,** Providing GI octagonal poles in Lieu of Old Rusted & Damage Poles at FNG Expressway Sector-138, Noida. Cost Rs. 65.61 Lacs.
4. **28/GM/AO/Sr.M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET,** Supply and Installation of Decorative Pole for Beautification in Noida Stadium Sector-21A, Noida. Cost Rs. 80.45 Lacs.
5. **63/GM(E&M)/S.M./E/M-III/26-27,** M/O Park Light (Annual Maintenance and Strengthening of Park Light in Meghdutam Park Sector-50 & Children Park sector-51), NOIDA. Cost Rs. 74.63 Lacs.
6. **64/GM(E&M)/S.M./E/M-III/26-27,** Strengthening of Street Light and Replacement of Old rusted & damage pole to Octagonal street Light pole in Mansarover Apartment sector-61, Noida. Cost Rs. 69.19 Lacs.
7. **65/GM(E&M)/S.M./E/M-III/26-27,** D/O Village (Strengthening of Electrical Infrastructure and Annual Maintenance of Street Light in Village-Barola), NOIDA. Cost Rs. 94.65 Lacs.

**Which can be uploaded by date: 27.10.2026 Upto 5:00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date: - 28.10.2026 at 11:00 AM.**

**General Manager (E&M)**
**Noida**

**CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA**

GOVERNMENT OF KARNATAKA
## PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
(www.kpwd.gov.in)
Office of the Executive Engineer, PWD Bangalore Division, 2nd Floor, PWD Annexure Building, K.R. Circle, Bangalore-01
**Telephone No.** 080-22133370 **Email ID:** eepwdbngdn@yahoo.com
**E-Portal:** https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/#/portal/portal-home

**Short Term Tender Notification No. 35/2026-27**
**Dated: 12.10.2026**

Item-rate tenders, for the work in PWD, **Doddaballapura & No.2 North** Sub Division under this office noted below, are invited by the undersigned on behalf of the Governor of Karnataka in accordance with Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement rules 2000 and as per Standard Tender Documents for procurement of works from the contractors registered in K.P.W.D. as per KPPP.

Tender Notification are Published for **02 Works (Rs. 500.00 to 1600.00 Lakhs)** Details of the tender works can be obtained from the above Office during office hours on working days**. EMD & Tender processing fees are mentioned in KPP portal.**

**For Sl No.01**
1. Tenders must be submitted online through KPP portal on or before **4.00 PM on Dated: 22.10.2026**
2. The opening of tenders through KPP portal on Dated: **23.10.2026 at 4.30 PM** or further date and time will be Intimate.

**For Sl No.02**
1. Tenders must be submitted online through KPP portal on or before **4.00 PM on Dated: 28.10.2026**
2. The opening of tenders through KPP portal on Dated: **29.10.2026 at 4.30 PM** or further date and time will be Intimate.

**For more details contact this office.**

**Sd/- Executive Engineer,**
**PWD Bangalore Division,**
**Bangalore**

DIPR/DD-CP/3210/MCS/2026-27

## BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

**INVITATION FOR TENDERS (Through KPP Portal Only)**

BWSSB invites tenders in Two Stage Tender System from eligible Contractors for the following Works.

| Sl. No. | Name of the Works | Amount Put to Tender / EMD Amount |
|---|---|---|
| **Office of the Chief Engineer (IP-R&D), 3rd Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G. Road, Bengaluru - 560009.** | | |
| **IFT No.: BWSSB/CE(IP-R&D)/ACE(IP-R&D)-1/1367/2026-27** | | **Date: 12-10-2026** |
| 1 | Work of Clear Water Distribution Pumping Station at Doddakannahalli GLR (48 ML) to Distribution Network of 110 Villages of Bommanahalli and Mahadevapura Zone. **(Call-2)** | **Rs. 791.56 Lakhs** / **Rs. 7.92 Lakhs** |
| For the above work, Last Date for Receipt of Tenders: **23-10-2026 upto 16.00 Hours.** Tender will be Opened on: **27-10-2026 after 12.00 Hours.** | | |
| **IFT No.: BWSSB/CE(IP-R&D)/ACE(IP-R&D)-1/1370/2026-27** | | **Date: 13-10-2026** |
| 2 | Work of Providing and Laying 600 mm Dia MS Water Supply Feeder Main from K. Channasandra Arch, Channasandra Main Road to Kalkere Udhyanavana Kalkere Village and Linking to Existing, Distribution Pipeline of Kalkere Village coming under AEE(IP-R&D)-2-2 Sub Division. | **Rs. 734.16 Lakhs** / **Rs. 11.02 Lakhs** |
| **IFT No.: BWSSB/CE(IP-R&D)/ACE(IP-R&D)-1/1371/2026-27** | | **Date: 13-10-2026** |
| 3 | Work of Providing and Laying 600 mm Dia MS Water Supply Feeder Main from Ayyappa Temple Road, Byrathi to Near Edify School Bileshivale Main Road and Linking to Existing, Distribution Pipeline of Bileshivale Village coming under AEE(IP-R&D)-2-2 Division. | **Rs. 737.83 Lakhs** / **Rs. 11.07 Lakhs** |
| **IFT No.: BWSSB/CE(IP-R&D)/ACE(IP-R&D)-1/1372/2026-27** | | **Date: 13-10-2026** |
| 4 | Work of Providing and Laying 600 mm Dia MS Water Supply Feeder Main from Aneppa Layout Hormavu Main Road to Kalkere GLR at NRI Layout and Linking to 700 mm Dia GLR Inlet Pipe coming under AEE(IP-R&D)-2-2 Sub Division. | **Rs. 354.36 Lakhs** / **Rs. 5.32 Lakhs** |
| **IFT No.: BWSSB/CE(IP-R&D)/ACE(IP-R&D)-2/1374/2026-27** | | **Date: 13-10-2026** |
| 5 | Work of Tapping the Existing 1016 mm Dia MS Pipeline near Halanayakanahalli Junction to Sarjapura Main Road, Doddakanahalli. | **Rs. 630.07 Lakhs** / **Rs. 9.45 Lakhs** |

For the above works, Last Date for Receipt of Tenders: **28-10-2026 upto 16.00 Hours.** Tender will be Opened on: **29-10-2026 after 17.00 Hours.**

**Sd/- Chief Engineer (IP-R&D)**

The details regarding the tender and participation in the e-Procurement Process can be obtained by logging on to **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.** For further details contact the above signed office during working hours.

**DIPR/CP/Adverto/3224/2026-27**

M ND-NDE

## INBRIEF



### Unnathi knocks out top seed Deepthi; Ribhav progresses

Unnathi Muralidhar stunned top seed Deepthi Venkatesan 6-2, 6-2 in a second round girls' under-16 match of the 31st Fenesta Open National tennis championship in New Delhi on Tuesday. However, boys' No. 1 Ribhav Saroha progressed with a 6-2, 6-2 win over Rhunmaan Mahesh.

**Other results (second round):**
**Under-16: Boys:** Lakshya Chukka bt Aarav Patel 6-1, 6-2; Paranjay Siwach bt Tanish Dasari 6-4, 7-5; Parthiv Nallagundla bt Divey Malik 7-6(2), 6-0; Yaj Malik bt Hemdev Mahesh 7-6(3), 6-4; Jeevith Sathish bt Ashwin Kabilan 7-6(3), 2-6, 6-2.
**Girls:** Tanusshri Sathesh bt Sanidya Karantoth 6-1, 6-1; Aaradhya Meena bt N. Krishnaprabhu 6-0, 6-1; Rishita Yadav bt Aashi Kashyap 3-6, 6-3, 6-2; Aahida Singh bt Harsha Oruganti 3-6, 6-2, 6-0; Ranjhana Sangram bt Tejaswi Manneni 4-6, 6-4, 6-3.
**Under-14: Boys: Second round:** Aarav Chhallani bt Rajishnu Poptani 6-1, 6-1; **First Round:** Puneeth Manohar bt Kabir Gundecha 6-1, 6-0; Nibras Hussain bt Zaayn Mohammad 6-3, 6-0; Pranav Gaikwad bt Ranveer Gawli 6-1, 6-4.
**Girls: Second round:** Sarena Gahlot bt Janhavi Sawant 6-2, 6-2; Sidhhi Pandey bt Aaradhya Singh 6-4, 6-3; Zoha Qureshi bt Sara Fengse 6-3, 6-2; Khushi Kadian bt Shaurya Patil 6-2, 6-1; Saanvi Mohan bt Myra Shaikh 6-4, 6-2.

### F1 to return to Africa in 'early 2030s' in Rwanda

Rwanda will host a Formula One race from the early 2030s in a 10-year deal, F1 said in a statement on Tuesday. Formula One has not raced in Africa since the last South African Grand Prix was held at Kyalami, north of Johannesburg, in 1993. The track where the Rwandan race will happen is yet to be built. It will be near an international airport being built at Bugesera some 40 km (25 miles) from the capital Kigali. "Africa is home to more than 100 million Formula 1 fans, and that number continues to grow rapidly," F1 CEO Stefano Domenicali said in the statement.

### Zverev set to become World No. 1 at the end of the year

The ATP confirmed it will crown a new World No. 1 as Germany's Alexander Zverev was ensured the year-end honour on Monday after Carlos Alcaraz lost his third-round match in Shanghai. The career-first will cap a stellar season for the 29-year-old, the current World No. 2, after he won the French Open in June and the US Open in September. "It's been a fantastic season for me winning in Paris and New York and knowing that I will finish the year on top of the rankings is just a dream come true," Zverev said in a statement shared by the ATP Tour website.

### Ticket ballot for WC 2027 receives 1.5 crore applications

The International Cricket Council (ICC) on Tuesday said it has received over 1.5 crore ticket applications from 142 countries since the ticket ballot for the 2027 World Cup went live 12 days ago, underlining the immense global interest in the showpiece. The marquee 50-over tournament will be jointly hosted by South Africa, Zimbabwe and Namibia from October 2 to November 21. "A total of 15,083,752 ticket applications have been received, with 4,423,417 ballot registrations generated by fans from across 142 countries," the ICC said in a statement. The ticket ballot will remain open for registration until November 21, 2026, exactly a year before the final is scheduled to be played at the Wanderers in Johannesburg.



### Coventry shocks Newcastle, makes it two in a row

Teenager Sidiki Cherif scored one and made one as host Coventry overcame a dishevelled Newcastle 4-1 and earned successive Premier League wins on Monday. "It is so hard to win but we played like the team we want to be tonight," coach Frank Lampard said.

**Top results: Premier League:** Coventry 4 (Rudoni 6-pen, Cherif 48, Simms 81, Mfuni 86) bt Newcastle 1 (Botman 70). **LaLiga:** Levante 3 (Romero 57, De La Fuente 90+2, Ndukwe 90+10) drew with Sevilla 3 (Ure 13, Correia 54, Romero 90+5). **Serie A:** Torino 2 (Braganca 36, Kulenovic 67) bt Udinese 1 (Ekkelenkamp 43); Atalanta 3 (Kessie 4, Krstovic 6, 30) bt Venezia 1 (Hainaut 37).

# Bengal tightens stranglehold on the season-opener

The host notches up a formidable 429 to take a 189-run lead before reducing Delhi to 101 for three in its second essay; off-spinner Badoni scalps five wickets for the visitors

RANJI TROPHY

**Y.B. Sarangi**
KALYANI

Eyeing an outright win in its season-opener against Delhi, Bengal displayed a united effort to increase its stranglehold on the Ranji Trophy Group-C match at the Bengal Cricket Academy ground here on Tuesday.

Resuming from 304 for three, the home side finished with a formidable 429 to secure a sizeable 189-run lead. Keen to avoid defeat, Delhi was at 101 for three in its second innings at stumps on day three.

Bengal's overnight centurion pair of Sudip Gharami and Abishek Porel witnessed an early end to their association as Delhi promptly took the new ball. Gharami (133, 235b, 19x4), dropped off Navdeep Saini in the 84th over, was adjudged lbw to the disciplined Divij Mehra in the next over. It broke a 229-run partnership that lasted 283 minutes.

Porel (149, 228b, 17x4, 1x6) then formed a 56-run stand with Sumanta Gupta (50, 62b, 5x4), who played fine shots on either side, before being caught at forward short-leg off Hrithik Shokeen. Gupta departed in similar fashion off Ayush Badoni and Pradipta Pramanik fell cheaply.



**Making merry:** Bengal batter Sumanta also joined the party with a half-century. CAB

The Bengal innings folded in the second over after lunch as Badoni, hitting good areas and extracting turn, dismissed tail-enders Akash Deep, Mohammed Shami and Mukesh Kumar to record his second five-for.

Pushed to the back foot, Delhi lost Sarthak Ranjan early with Akash uprooting the middle stump. Yash Dhull, hit on his chest in the next delivery, was retired hurt. The southpaw duo of Sanat Sangwan and Ayush Doseja showed character as it consumed time and collected 36 runs in 23 overs. Even on a slow and eased out track, Shami used the crease beautifully and tested the batters with some movement. Mukesh, who broke the left-handers' defiant association with a delivery that kissed Doseja's gloves, and Akash provided good support.

Left-arm spinner Pramanik castled Sangwan when one of his deliveries spun from the rough.

**The scores: Delhi — 1st innings:** 240.
**Bengal — 1st innings:** Abhimanyu Easwaran c Rawat b Mehra 34, Ankur Paul c Doseja b Saini 17, Sudip Gharami lbw b Mehra 133, Sudip Chatterjee c Rawat b Badoni 2, Abishek Porel c Sangwan b Shokeen 149, Sumanta Gupta c Sangwan b Badoni 50, Aamir Gani (not out) 11, Pradipta Pramanik c Sangwan b Saini 5, Akash Deep c Dhull b Badoni 1, Mohammed Shami c Ranjan b Badoni 0, Mukesh Kumar c Shokeen b Badoni 0; Extras (b-14, lb-12, w-1): 27; Total (in 112 overs): 429.
**Fall of wickets:** 1-30, 2-84, 3-105, 4-334, 5-390, 6-417, 7-422, 8-425, 9-425.
**Delhi bowling:** Mehra 17-4-45-2, Simarjeet 17-0-74-0, Saini 20-4-81-2, Shokeen 26-0-115-1, Badoni 18-3-43-5, Doseja 4-1-8-0, Lakra 10-0-37-0.
**Delhi — 2nd innings:** Sarthak Ranjan b Akash 3, Sanat Sangwan b Pramanik 25, Yash Dhull (retd. hurt) 0, Ayush Doseja c sub (Gandhi) b Mukesh 19, Ayush Badoni (batting) 24, Anuj Rawat (batting) 25; Extras (b-2, lb-3): 5; Total (for three wkts. in 45 overs): 101.
**Fall of wickets:** 1-15, 2-51, 3-59.
**Bengal bowling:** Shami 11-3-18-0, Akash 7-2-15-1, Mukesh 7-3-17-1, Gani 8-4-16-0, Pramanik 12-4-30-1.

**RANJI TROPHY SCORES — ROUND ONE, DAY THREE**

**Elite: Group A: At Rajgir:** Uttar Pradesh 540 bt Bihar 141 in 52.1 overs (Kartik Yadav 4/26, Karan Sharma 4/28) & 132 in 36.4 overs (Zeeshan Ansari 4/40). **Points: UP 7(7), Bihar 0(0).**
**At Panaji:** Baroda 472/8 decl. vs. Goa 199 in 71.1 overs (Snehal Kauthankar 50, Lalit Yadav 54, Mahesh Pithiya 5/58, Bhargav Bhatt 4/51) & 35/1 in 13 overs.
**At Srinagar:** Madhya Pradesh 196 & 151/5 in 62 overs (Shubham Sharma 51 batting) vs. Jammu & Kashmir 120.
**At Nagpur:** Vidarbha 428 & 22/1 in 11 overs vs. Pondicherry 313 in 114.5 overs (Ritesh Gudge 95, Nikhil Gangta 54, Mohit Kale 78).
**Group B: At Hyderabad:** Tripura 134 & 120 in 41.2 overs (Tanay Thyagarajann 6/52) lost to Hyderabad 294. **Hyderabad 7(7), Tripura 0(0).**
**At Vijayawada:** Karnataka 274 & 176/4 in 60 overs (Manvanth Kumar 44, Karun Nair 81 batting) vs. Andhra 418 in 121.5 overs. (Shaik Rasheed 54, S.V. Rahul 119, Revanth Reddy 97, Shikhar Shetty 6/115).
**At New Chandigarh:** Assam 373 vs. Punjab 287/5 in 96 overs (Vihaan Malhotra 103, Harnoor Singh 54).
**At Rajkot:** Saurashtra 392 & 45/0 in 13 overs vs. Chhattisgarh 312 in 121.5 overs (Anuj Tiwary 72 retd. hurt, Mayank Verma 68, Vikalp Tiwari 46, Rahul Pradhan 41 n.o.).
**Group C: At Jamshedpur:** Jharkhand 587 vs. Kerala 269/6 in 90 overs (Abhishek P. Nair 126, Rohan Kunnummal 44).
**At Kalyani:** Delhi 240 & 101/3 in 45 overs vs. Bengal 429 in 112 overs (Sudip Kumar Gharami 133, Abishek Porel 149, Sumata Gupta 50, Ayush Badoni 5/43).
**At Ahmedabad:** Odisha 324 & 119/4 in 30 overs (Sandeep Pattnaik 41 batting, Ninad Rathva 53) vs. Gujarat 439 in 106.4 overs (Aarya Desai 94, Vedant Trivedi 108, Urvil Patel 85, Harshal Patel 60, Badal Biswal 5/118).
**At New Delhi:** Maharashtra 333 & 66/5 in 28 overs (Arjun Sharma 4/30) vs. Services 227 in 93.2 overs (Nitin Tanwar 61, Vineet Dhankhar 40, Rajat Paliwal 44, Hitesh Walunj 5/51).
**Group D: At Lahli:** Himachal Pradesh 253 & 113 in 40 overs vs. Haryana 296 in 82.3 overs (Ankit Kumar 59, Yashvardhan Dalal 72, Kanishk Chouhan 50, Aryaman Singh Dhaliwal 4/72) & 26/3 in nine overs.
**At Mumbai (Brabourne Stadium):** Railways 278 & 34/0 in 15 overs vs. Uttarakhand 470 in 156.5 overs (Kunal Chandela 43, Avneesh Sudha 90, J. Suchith 62, Saurabh Rawat 107, Mayank Mishra 51).
**At Jaipur:** Rajasthan 363 & 81/4 in 34 overs vs. Tamil Nadu 274 in 98.4 overs (N. Jagadeesan 55, Pradosh Ranjan Paul 58, Andre Siddarth 81, Ajay Singh 5/51).
**At Mumbai (Wankhede Stadium):** Mumbai 429 bt Chandigarh 78 & 196 in 52.1 overs (Arjun Azad 62, Shivam Bambri 44). **Mumbai 7(7), Chandigarh 0(0).**
**Plate: At Rangpo:** Sikkim 245 & 44/0 in 28 overs vs. Meghalaya 395 in 150.2 overs (Kishan Lyngdoh 78, Swastic Chettri 73, Jaskirat Singh 127, Kranti Kumar 5/71).
**At Nadiad:** Mizoram 183 & 295 in 107.4 overs (Sahil Reza 51, Chinmay Sutar 99, Jehu Anderson 71, Kishan Singha 4/88) vs. Manipur 251 & 8/0 in two overs.



Tanay... Hyderabad's hero.
NAGARA GOPAL

## SNAPSHOTS

**Athletics coach Yunus suspended for alleged anti-doping violation**
NEW DELHI: One of India's most well-known athletics coaches, Mohammad Yunus Khan, who has guided star long distance runner Gulveer Singh in his formative years, has been provisionally suspended for alleged "complicity" in an unspecified anti-doping rule violation.

**166 athletes make the cut for Para Asiad**
The Sports Ministry has axed under-fire para-shooting coach Jai Prakash Nautiyal from the Para Asian Games-bound Indian contingent, approving a total of 166 athletes after a controversy-mired selection process which resulted in protests by shooters and cyclists.
The Games are due to start on October 18 in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan. Long-serving National coach Jeevan Rai has replaced Nautiyal in the contingent. With 94 team officials and support staff and 15 contingent staff, India's total at the continental showpiece would be 275 in 10 disciplines. Despite a protest by the omitted cyclists, the Ministry has avoided last-minute additions and approved only Paralympian Arshad Shaik, who was the best performer among those in contention.
Six other cyclists had also been picked by the Cycling Federation of India and the Paralympic Committee of India but they were omitted for not meeting the criteria. Among the accomplished names in the approved table tennis contingent is Paralympic silver-winning player Bhavina Patel.

# East Bengal left to rue missed opportunities against Al-Shorta

ACL II

**Amitabha Das Sharma**
KOLKATA

East Bengal FC squandered a first-half lead to suffer a 3-2 defeat against Iraqi side Al-Shorta in its second Group-D outing of the AFC Champions League Two at Salt Lake Stadium here on Tuesday.

David Hmar scored twice in the first half to put East Bengal ahead twice. He opened the scoring in the seventh minute when he shielded an Al-Shorta defender to receive Hardik Bhatt's centre and turned sharply to complete a spectacular finishing.

Al-Shorta equalised in the 14th minute through Ahmed Yahya, who headed in from a corner.

Despite enjoying less possession, East Bengal looked more threatening on the counter-attack, registering 10 shots of which seven were on target, compared to Al-Shorta's solitary effort on target.

The hosts regained the lead in the 41st minute after goalkeeper Jalal Hassan parried Daniel Ramirez's free-kick. Basim Rashid recovered the ball near the goal line and delivered a back-heel, allowing David to finish from close range.



**Marksman:** Hmar found the net twice for East Bengal. PTI

David missed two further chances before half-time to complete his hat-trick, and those misses proved costly.

Al-Shorta struck twice in quick succession after the break to turn the match around.

Hussein Al-Saedi equalised in the 51st minute before Kingsley Kuku headed home a corner from Argentine substitute Cristian Barco two minutes later.

Al-Shorta were reduced to 10 men in the 76th minute when Abdoul Magid received his second yellow card. East Bengal pushed for an equaliser but failed to break through the visitors' disciplined defence, leaving the home side to rue missed opportunities and a costly second-half collapse.

**The result:** East Bengal 2 (David Hmar 7, 41) lost to Al-Shorta 3 (Ahmed Yahya 14, Hussein Al-Saedi 51, Kingsley Kuku 53).

# Hamstring injury rules Mhatre out for six weeks

**Amol Karhadkar**
MUMBAI

Mumbai vice-captain and promising opener Ayush Mhatre is set to miss at least six weeks of cricket after sustaining a suspected Grade 4 tear in his right hamstring during the team's Ranji Trophy season-opener against Chandigarh at the Wankhede Stadium.

Mumbai Cricket Association president Ajinkya Naik confirmed on Tuesday that the 19-year-old's recovery timeline would depend on further consultations between the Mumbai team's medical staff and BCCI's Centre of Excellence (CoE) in Bengaluru.

Mhatre suffered the injury while batting on the opening day.

He did not take the field in either of the visitors' innings as Mumbai registered an innings and 155-run victory.



**Big blow:** Mhatre, right, did not take the field in either of Chandigarh's innings. EMMANUAL YOGINI

"It happened while running between the wickets. He looks very sad. He worked really hard in the off-season.

"He was doing rehab with me at BKC (Ground) and would come all the way from Virar. It happens, it is part of the game, and we will try to motivate him," Mumbai captain Siddhesh Lad said.

"We had two or three simulation games and club matches, and also played at BKC. He was looking fine for the last three or four matches, but he felt something in his hamstring when taking a second run."

The setback comes barely six months after Mhatre injured his left hamstring while representing Chennai Super Kings in the Indian Premier League on April 18.

That had ruled him out for three months.

It is understood that he had also been troubled by his right hamstring during the rehabilitation at the CoE.

# Punjab aims for winning start under new coach

ISL

**Sports Bureau**
NEW DELHI

Punjab FC will hope for a winning start to the new Indian Super League season under new coach Pavlos Dermitzakis when it takes on Odisha FC at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium here on Wednesday.

Greece's Dermitzakis, who has replaced compatriot Panagiotis Dilmperis as head coach, will be aiming to build on Punjab's sixth-placed finish in the league in the previous campaign.

Punjab, which plays its home games in the national capital, arrives for the opener with some momentum from a successful pre-season.



Dermitzakis.

It reached the semifinals of the IFA Shield in Kolkata before going down to eventual champion Mohun Bagan Super Giant on penalties.

In a media interaction, Dermitzakis underlined his style of play. "Our philosophy is to try to play good and attractive football. First of all, we should be happy, and the fans should be happy to watch us," the 57-year-old manager said.

"Indian football is generally a little more direct and relies on transitions, but we try to do something different and play a more combination-based game. If required, we can also play directly."

Odisha, meanwhile, needs drastic improvement after finishing 11th last season.

It has overhauled its squad, bringing in overseas recruits like Stephen Eze and Giorgi Aburjania.



# A leader who took India to uncharted terrains

**She is someone who enjoyed captaincy and strongly believed in the team-first approach. She nurtured young talents, encouraged them and waxed eloquent when they succeeded at the highest level**



**P.K. Ajith Kumar**



She came. She led. She conquered. Now, she has stepped down.

So, the best captain Indian women's cricket has ever had will no longer walk out to toss with the rival captain in an international game. Harmanpreet Kaur would be cherishing those walks to the middle, in the glare of the television cameras. She is someone who has enjoyed captaincy. And it was a job she did rather well, for all those talks about the need for change in captaincy in recent times.

Granted, she could not take India to the semifinals of the Women's T20 World Cup in England three months ago. But, last year she had led India to an ODI World Cup triumph.

"Only Kapil Dev and M.S. Dhoni have done that," former India captain Shubhangi Kulkarni reminds you over phone from Pune. "So she is in a very exclusive club. And she played a major role in the Indian victory as a batter, too. Everyone talks about Jemimah Rodrigues' brilliant hundred in the semifinal against Australia, but Harmanpreet made 89."

After losing the openers Smriti Mandhana and Shafali Verma inside 10 overs, it was the skipper's 167-run stand for the third wicket with Jemimah that put India's chase of a World-record breaking target. Harmanpreet knows how to make an impact in big games, and she certainly knows how to torment Australia, the best team in women's cricket.

Even in her last appearance as a captain against the Aussies, in the league match at the T20 World Cup at Lord's, she had cracked a 27-ball 56 that gave India at least a fighting chance in what was a must-win situation. But, a determined Australia, riding on a superb partnership with its champion all-rounders Ellyse Perry and Ashleigh Gardner, knocked India out of the competition, avenging the loss in the ODI World Cup.

That was indeed a big blow to Harmanpreet and her women. They were one of the favourites and were at least expected to make the semifinals, but the defeat to South Africa, earlier in the Group of Death, was always going to be costly.

## Historic triumph

The Indians, however, won the historic Women's Test at Lord's, which was played right after the World Cup. And India totally outplayed England.

That was followed by the twin successes at the Asia Cup and the Asian Games. So Harmanpreet could end her captaincy on a high.

She admitted, through her widely read Instagram post, that the decision to step down was not easy. "The decision carries years of memories, emotions, sacrifices, and moments that will stay with me for the rest of my life," she wrote.

"I have given everything I had to this team and to Indian women's cricket – my blood, my sweat, my time, and many times, a part of my own game and personal ambitions. There were moments when I had to put my individual performance, my own growth, and what I wanted for myself aside, because I believed the team had to come first."

She said she had to make some difficult decisions. "Decisions that were not always understood, not always easy, and sometimes came at a personal cost," she explained. "But every decision I made was with one intention - to make this team better and to give other players the opportunity to grow, believe in themselves and become the best versions of themselves."

Shubangi, one of the pioneers of women's cricket in India, says Harmanpreet indeed was able to transform the Indian team with her leadership. "She has led India through a period of enormous changes," she said. "From a team which was competing well, and expecting to do well, to becoming a team that wins major championships – she did it through some real high points and through some very low points, too. We have waited for a long, long time, for 50 years to win a senior ICC championship. There was a heartbreak in 2005 and then a bigger one in 2017 (India lost the World Cup finals). So what Harmanpreet's Indian team did last year is indeed remarkable, and it is something she could always be proud about."

## Transforming the side

Biju George, who has worked with Harmanpreet as the fielding coach of the Indian team also rates her captaincy highly. "She was an aggressive captain who hated losing," says the Thiruvananthapuram-based man whose wards include Sanju Samson. "As a captain, she has reminded me of Sourav Ganguly. Like he transformed the Indian men's team, Harman did something similar with the women's team."

Biju also has always been in awe of her batting. "Her 171 not out against Australia in the semifinal of the 2017 World Cup in England is the best innings I have ever seen, by a male or a female cricketer, and I was lucky that I could watch it along with the Indian team," he said.

"Harman is one of the earliest batters who brought in power to women's cricket. We have many players who can hit hard now, but not at the time when she was doing it."

And Harman could change the complexion of a game with those big shots. And she has been doing it for so long. Biju feels she could be scoring more runs after relinquishing the captaincy. "She could bat with more freedom," he says. "And I think she has quit captaincy at the right time. Smriti also deserves to be a captain for a few years. And I also think it is good that they did not split the captaincy between formats. It is always to have just one captain. Multiple captains could create issues within the team."

There isn't, of course, a better option than Smriti to lead India in all formats. And she was quick to pay a tribute to Harmanpreet's captaincy.

"It has been a pleasure playing with you for so many years," Smriti wrote on social media. "Ten years of your leadership have been fantastic and together, we will strive to bring many more laurels for our nation."

Smriti's opening partner Shafali also spoke of how much Harmanpreet meant to her.

"Since the day I made my debut, you have always been there for me, on and off the field," said the swashbuckling opener. "From guiding me through the early days to standing by me through everything, I have always known I could count on you."

Those words from Shafali actually reveal something about Harmanpreet. She nurtured young talents – be it Shafali, Shree Charani or Kranti Gaud – and encouraged them always. One has seen her wax eloquent about those youngsters at press conferences several times. You could understand how much their successes meant to her.

She was excited to see the emergence of Kranti as a quality seamer that India desperately wanted. And she made Shafali bowl when not many were expecting her to. The emergence of Shafali as a spinner who could bowl at different stages of a match has given the Indian attack an excellent option. She has justified her captain's faith in her with some fine spells.

Shubhangi feels Harmanpreet deserves credit for handling the transition period in Indian women's cricket well. "She is the only player in the team from the time WCAI (Women's Cricket Association of India), of which I was the secretary, was running the game," she says. "We had to struggle for funds, and things were not easy at all for India's female cricketers. Now there is money and opportunities for our players."

Harmanpreet could always be proud about her role in taking women's cricket forward. That is something nobody could take away from her. And that World Cup.

Captaincy matters in cricket. Harmanpreet has shown that, the way few women in international cricket have.



> I have given everything I had to this team and to Indian women's cricket – my blood, my sweat, my time, and many times, a part of my own game and personal ambitions. There were moments when I had to put aside my individual performance, my own growth, and what I wanted for myself

## THE GIST

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# India's water plants are failing to catch elusive 'forever chemicals'

Many studies from different parts of India have already found polyfluoroalkyl substances in water sources; conventional water treatment systems that can remove these compounds are not yet commercially available even as the extent of the contamination across India remains unclear

Rohan Singh
LUCKNOW



PFASs have been around for 60 years. India has no PFAS-specific drinking-water limit under the current standard, although this could change. AFP

## THE GIST

Finding PFAS in water does not, by itself, tell us how much of a health risk it poses; that depends on the type of PFAS, the dose, duration of exposure, and route of exposure

The Union Environment Ministry has said there is no specific regulation banning PFAS manufacturing

The Bureau of Indian Standards said a dedicated Working Group on Emerging Contaminants and Forever Chemicals is examining PFAS limits and associated contaminants

The scope and number of PFAS to be included have not yet been finalised, while analytical methods for PFAS in drinking water are also being considered

Polyfluoroalkyl substances (PFAS) are synthetic chemical compounds that contain multiple carbon-fluorine bonds. PFAS materials are used in coatings, textiles, and several industrial products. They are also notorious for resisting degradation and can contaminate the environment for a very long time.

Many studies from different parts of India have already found PFAS in water sources. Conventional water treatment systems that can remove these compounds are not yet commercially available even as the extent of PFAS contamination across India remains unclear.

In a 2025 review in the *Journal of Hazardous Materials Advances*, scientists examined monitoring and regulations across Gujarat, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, and West Bengal. The review's first author, Rajneesh Kumar Gautam, of the Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences, said the evidence establishes that PFAS contamination in India is a legitimate concern but that its national extent is poorly defined, thanks in part to differences in the way different research groups test and analyse PFAS.

This particular lacuna has been identified in multiple studies of late.

For example, in a 2024 paper in *Environmental Sciences Europe*, researchers from IIT-Madras reported the analysis of 14 water samples collected between 2022 and 2023 from groundwater, surface water, and the four stages of a water treatment plant in Chennai. The team found that groundwater from residential wells in the vicinity of garbage dumps had the highest PFAS levels.

At the treatment plant, concentrations of all eight target PFAS were 5% to 103% higher in treated water than in raw water. Study coauthor Indumathi M. Nambi, a professor of environmental engineering, suggested the increase may reflect unidentified precursors that turned into more stable PFAS inside the plant. The study did not quantify those precursors.

The eight target PFAS, Dr. Nambi said, represented only a fraction of the potentially diverse fluorinated compounds that may be present. She recommended that testing should thus include other PFAS materials that may be present in the water, rather than relying only on a fixed list.

### Resolving mixed sources

On July 16 this year, researchers from GITAM (Deemed to be) University, Hyderabad, and from Canada and the U.S. reported the results of testing 77 kinds of PFAS in seawater and sewage from around Visakhapatnam. The findings, published in *npj Emerging Contaminants*, showed the presence of 38 compounds, with concentrations in sewage ranging from low to very high.

The team also used a model to estimate that sewage accounted for about 41% of median PFAS concentrations along the coast. GITAM assistant professor and study coauthor Manoj Rayaroth said distinguishing municipal sewage from industrial inputs would require systematic sampling around the mixing points.

Nejumal Kannankeril Khalid, a coauthor from the University of Montreal, said source-specific sampling together with targeted, suspected, and non-target PFAS analysis, chemical fingerprints, and machine-learning approaches could improve source discrimination and help resolve mixed sources.

Testing for a fixed list of PFAS means substances not indicated on that list may not be detected. Precursors can also change into other PFAS. Dr. Rayaroth said high-resolution mass spectrometry can help identify PFAS beyond a fixed list, but care is needed because PFAS can enter samples during collection and analysis. Removing PFAS from treated wastewater presents another challenge.

Abhradeep Majumder, assistant professor in the Department of Civil Engineering at BITS Pilani-Hyderabad, said conventional biological wastewater treatment cannot remove PFAS. He noted that adsorption-based treatment, which can remove PFAS from water, has shown potential but that low-cost materials designed to capture PFAS still need to be developed.

### From detection to exposure

Finding PFAS in water does not, by itself, tell us how much of a health risk it poses. That depends on the type of PFAS, the dose, duration of exposure, and route of exposure. In its 2025 monograph, the International Agency for Research on Cancer classified perfluorooctanoic acid (PFOA) as 'carcinogenic to humans' and perfluorooctanesulfonic (PFOS) as 'possibly carcinogenic to humans'. Both PFOA and PFOS are types of PFAS materials.

**The International Agency for Research on Cancer in 2025 classified perfluorooctanoic acid as 'carcinogenic to humans' and perfluorooctanesulfonic as 'possibly carcinogenic to humans'; both are types of PFAS materials**

In a study published in February this year a team that included Dr. Nambi found that a mix of 24 PFAS-compounds – including long- and short-chain PFAS molecules and their precursors – delayed the hatching of zebrafish eggs, inhibited the offspring's growth, accumulated in their blood, and reduced their heart rates.

Chirag Dhara, assistant professor at Krea University in Sri City, said incomplete exposure data should not delay controls on PFAS whose hazards are already well established.

Anbumani Sadasivam, principal scientist at the CSIR-Indian Institute of Toxicology Research, Lucknow, said India lacks sufficient baseline data to reliably estimate PFAS exposure. He said CSIR-IITR is participating in a UNEP-funded National Implementation Plan to build baseline data on PFAS in environmental matrices and consumer products, and has developed capabilities to detect 50 multi-class PFAS molecules across different matrices.

The Union Environment Ministry has said there is no specific regulation banning PFAS manufacturing. India has no PFAS-specific drinking-water limit under the current IS 10500:2012 standard. But the standard is now under revision. The Bureau of Indian Standards said a dedicated Working Group on Emerging Contaminants and Forever Chemicals is examining PFAS limits and associated contaminants. The scope and number of PFAS to be included under the revised standard have not yet been finalised, while analytical methods for PFAS in drinking water are also being considered. Dr. Anbumani said India should first establish which PFAS are being manufactured, imported, and used, alongside baseline monitoring, toxicological studies, and enforceable limits.

Girija K. Bharat, a former Scientist at CSIR-CIMFR, said that, to her knowledge, there is currently no clear regulatory pathway for penalising a source responsible for PFAS contamination sources. Dr. Dhara warned that a named-chemical approach could leave precursors and transformation products outside regulation.

Dr. Gautam also said India has enough evidence to introduce precautionary interim limits for well-studied PFAS. He called for harmonised monitoring and broader screening for precursors and other fluorinated compounds.

*(Rohan Singh is an independent science journalist in Lucknow. Rohanthakur780@gmail.com)*

## BIG SHOT



Women from a community group inspect the growth of young mangroves they planted to restore a bare patch in Mida Creek, near Watamu, Kenya, on August 4, 2025. The 17th UN Biodiversity Conference will be held next week in Armenia under the theme 'taking action for nature', bringing together governments, scientists, and stakeholders. AFP

## WHAT IS IT?

# Rogue AI: deficient design?

Agence France-Presse

More than 200 artificial intelligence (AI) and cybersecurity researchers have called for immediate action to prevent further cases of AI models going rogue and posing a risk to critical infrastructure.

The letter signed by luminaries in the field including Nobel laureate Geoffrey Hinton and Turing Award winner Yoshua Bengio, called for models relating to cybersecurity to be physically cut off from the internet during testing.

Leading U.S.-based AI firms have disclosed over recent months a series of incidents where models under development have escaped containment measures to access the internet and have gone on to hack websites, including gaining unauthorised access to Australian government sites.

"Without immediate changes in AI development and deployment practices, such incidents will continue to occur, and future incidents will be far more damaging to our exposed critical infrastructure," they warned.

Their letter called for organisations developing, deploying, and testing cyber-capable AI models to be air-gapped, i.e. physically cut off from the internet, to ensure they do not escape.

It also called for the creation of an international body that standardises best practices regarding security.

The letter urged companies to be required to report containment failures to the body, which would be responsible for tracking and recording them. "This transparency is required for both learning and accountability purposes," the letter said.

The rogue incidents amplified calls to slow AI development, but the industry and governments are divided on tapping the brakes as well as regulating the sector. In the U.S., the Trump administration has opposed any binding regulation that could hinder innovation, amid fierce competition with China.

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